图 83

Line drawing (right of the page): the man with the two hands joined before the chest as upright palms with the intent of holding a ball, the right toe pointing straight ahead, the two legs full-right and empty-left. Labelled at its side "Figure 83".

Movement four: the body turns slightly to the left and the left foot accordingly draws in beside the right, touching the ground with the toe, so that the right leg becomes full and the left leg empty. At the same time the left hand falls to before the abdomen, the left arm slightly bent, the fingers pointing forward; the right hand rises level with the crown of the head, the palm turned up; facing due east, with the upper body leaning slightly toward south. (Figure 86)

Thirty-third posture — Thread the hands (Figures 87–90)

图 84

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest with the fingers pointing up, and the right arm bent and held level in front; a horizontal arrow to the right in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 84".

图 85

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the right leg bowed forward, the right arm bent before the forehead and the left hand as an upright palm before the chest; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 85".

图 86

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the left hand fallen to before the abdomen with the fingers pointing forward and the right hand raised level with the crown with the palm turned up, the left foot drawn in beside the right with the toe touching the ground; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 86".

图 87

Line drawing (middle-lower left of the page): the man with the left leg bowed forward, the left hand raised to before the forehead level with the head with the palm turned slightly forward, and the right hand fallen and scooped up to the left to before the abdomen with the palm turned slightly down, the two hands facing each other above and below; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 87".

图 88

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the body turned right on the left heel and the left toe turned inward 90 degrees to sit the left leg full, the right hand raised to before the forehead level with the head with the palm turned outward, and the left hand scooped up to before the abdomen with the palm turned slightly down; the right foot lifted to rest before the left heel touching with the heel and the toe tilted up; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 88".

图 89

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the two legs full-left and empty-right, the left hand raised to before the forehead and the right hand before the abdomen, the two hands facing each other above and below; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 89".

图 90

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the two hands before the chest; a circular arc and several arrows in the picture mark the arcs of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 90".

Movement one: the left foot steps forward, the toe pointing toward the left corner, touching the ground with the heel; the right heel presses, the left leg bows forward, the left sole settles flat, and the two legs become full-left and empty-right. At the same time the left hand moves upward past the abdomen and the right hand arcs from the right downward; the left hand is raised to before the forehead, level with the head, the palm turned slightly forward; the right hand falls and scoops up to the left to before the abdomen, the palm turned slightly Movement three: the right toe turns inward about 90 degrees and settles, sitting the right leg full, and at the same time the body turns left; the left foot steps out to the left, touching first with the heel; then the right heel presses, the left leg bows forward, the left sole settles flat with the toe pointing toward the left corner, and the two legs still become full-left and empty-right. At the same time the left hand moves upward past the abdomen and the right hand arcs from the right downward; the left hand is raised to before the forehead, level with the head, the palm turned slightly forward, and the

right hand falls and scoops up to the left to before the abdomen, the palm turned slightly down, the two hands facing each other above and below; facing the southeast diagonal. (Figure 89)

Movement four is the same as movement two of this posture. (Figure 90)

Thirty-fourth posture — Single whip (Figure 91)

Thirty-fifth posture — Raise the hand and lift the posture (Figures 92–93)

Thirty-sixth posture — High pat the horse (Figure 94)

Three postures are joined into one section-sequence: movement one is "Single whip"; movements two and three are "Raise the hand and lift the posture"; movement four is "High pat the horse".

Movement one: the right toe turns inward about 90 degrees and settles; the right leg sits full, and at the same time the body turns left; the left foot steps out to the left, touching first with the heel; then the right heel presses, the left leg bows forward, the left sole settles flat with the toe pointing toward the left corner, and the two legs still become full-left and empty-right. At the same time the left hand rises and the right hand falls, both becoming upright palms; when the two hands come level with the mouth they part to left and right, the left hand level with the eyes and the right hand level with the mouth; facing a diagonal slightly east of south. (Figure 91)

Movement two: the right foot lifts, passes along the inner side of the left foot, and steps forward, touching first with the heel;

then the left heel presses, the right leg bows forward, the right sole settles flat with the toe pointing ahead, the left leg bends slightly, and the legs become full-right and empty-left. At the same time the body turns slightly right. The two hands follow the movement: the right hand moves from the right downward and scoops to the left to before the abdomen, the fingers pointing forward; the left hand rises, the palm turned up, with the intent of lifting upward, level with the crown. As the right leg bows forward, the right hand pushes slowly forward (the upper body may not lean forward or backward), the right hand level with the chest; facing due south. (Figure 92)

图 91

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the left leg bowed forward, the two hands parted left and right as upright palms with the left hand level with the eyes and the right hand level with the mouth, and the right toe turned inward 90 degrees and settled to sit the right leg full. Labelled at its side "Figure 91".

图 92

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the left hand raised level with the crown and the palm turned up, and the right hand scooping to the left before the abdomen; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 92".

图 93

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the right toe turned inward about 45 degrees, the waist revolved slightly left and the right leg sitting full, the left hand raised level with the crown and the right hand before the chest; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 93".

图 94

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest; arcs and arrows in the picture mark the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 94".

Movement four: the left hand arcs from the front downward and inward to before the abdomen, the palm turned up and the fingers pointing right; the right hand accordingly draws in near the right hip, then rubs and presses toward the chest, the palm turned down, level with the chest, facing the left hand above and below (both arms forming a half-circle). At the same time the body continues to turn left, facing due east. At the same time the left foot shifts close beside the right, touching the ground with the toe, and the two legs are still full-right and empty-left. (Figure 94)

Thirty-seventh posture — Left subdue the tiger (Figures 95–96)

Thirty-eighth posture — Right kick (Figures 97–98)

The two postures are joined into one section-sequence: movements one and two are "Left subdue the tiger"; movements three and four are "Right kick".

图 95

Line drawing (right of the page): the man with the left hand raised above the crown of the head in a fist and the right fist resting before the abdomen, the left foot stepped out toward the left-front diagonal touching first with the heel, the left leg bowed forward. Labelled at its side "Figure 95".

图 96

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the body turned slightly left, the two hands closed into fists with the eyes of the fists facing each other above and below, the left leg bowed forward and the right leg behind; a rightward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 96".

图 97

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the right foot lifted and kicking forward, the two hands before the chest; a leftward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 97".

图 98

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the two hands before the chest and the two fists facing each other above and below, the right foot lifted; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 98".

Movement one: the body turns slightly to the left; the left foot steps out toward the left-front diagonal, touching first with the heel; the right heel presses, the left leg bows forward, the left sole settles flat, so that the left leg becomes full and the right leg empty. As the left leg bows forward the two hands follow the movement: the left hand rises along the left leg and forward and up past the face, above the crown of the head; the right hand drops from before the chest outward and downward and the forearm rotates outward, coming to rest before the abdomen;

the two hands close into fists at the same time, the eyes of the fists facing each other above and below, and as the fists close the body turns to the right. (Figure 95)

Movement two: the whole weight shifts onto the left leg; the right foot lifts and touches forward with the toe beside the left foot. (Figure 96)

Movement three: the right leg lifts and the right toe kicks out to the right, level with the knee. At the same time the right fist rises and the left fist falls; when the two fists come level with the eyebrows both become upright palms and part to left and right, the right high and the left slightly lower, the right hand level with the eyebrows, the right arm in line with the right leg; the left leg bends slightly. (Figure 97)

Movement four: the left and right hands come together before the chest. At the same time the right leg does not move; the right shin hangs down, the toe pointing down, the heel near the left knee; facing the right-front diagonal. (Figure 98)

图 99

Line drawing (middle left of the page): the man with the left hand raised above the forehead and the right hand before the chest, the right leg lifted with the toe pointing down and the heel near the left knee. Labelled at its side "Figure 99".

图 100

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the left hand raised above the forehead and the right fist at the abdomen, the right toe touching beside the left foot; a leftward arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 100".

图 101

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the left leg slightly bent and the right leg lifted and kicking out to the left level with the knee, the two hands as upright palms before the chest parting left and right; a downward arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 101".

图 102

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the right leg lifted, the toe pointing down and the heel near the left knee, the two hands joined before the chest; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 102".

movement two is "Right subdue the tiger"; movements three and four are "Left kick".

Movements one, two, three and four are the same as the explanation of the four movements of the thirty-seventh posture, "Left subdue the tiger", joined with the thirty-eighth posture, "Right kick", except that left and right are reversed and the direction differs slightly: this posture's heel-push is toward the northeast diagonal. (Figures 99–102)

Forty-first posture — Turn the body and push with the heel (Figures 103–104)

Forty-second posture — Single whip (Figure 105)

Forty-third posture — Tread the step and strike a blow (Figure 106)

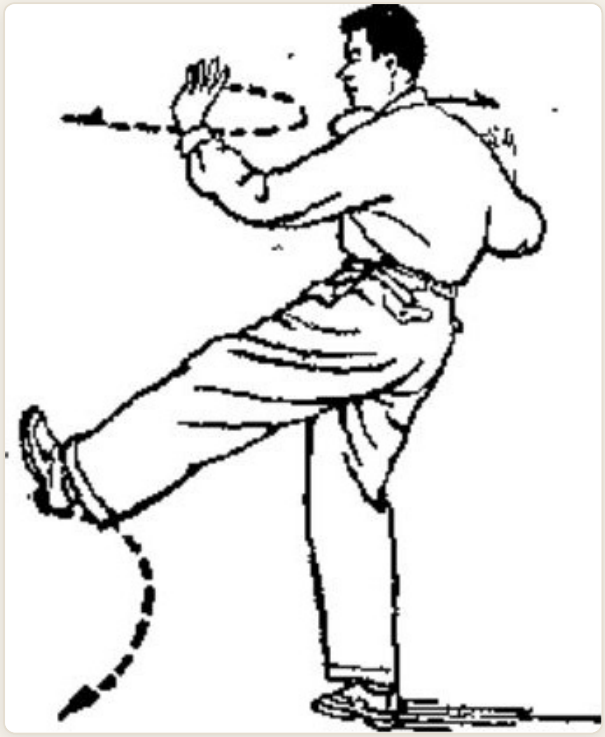
Three postures are joined into one section-sequence: movements one and two are "Turn the body and push with the heel"; movement three is "Single whip"; movement four is "Tread the step and strike a blow".

Movement one: with the right heel as the axis, the body turns 180 degrees to the left-rear; facing due west. (Figure 103)

图 103

Line drawing (middle right of the page): the man revolving 180 degrees to the left-rear on the right heel and facing due west, the two hands before the chest, the left foot lifted; a horizontal arrow to the left in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 103".

图 104



Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man revolving 180 degrees to the left-rear on the right heel, the left toe tilted up and pushing forward with the heel level with the knee, the two hands parted left and right as upright palms with the left high and the right slightly lower; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 104".

图 105

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the left leg bowed forward and the two hands parted left and right following the leg as upright palms to form the single-whip posture; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 105".

图 106

Line drawing (middle left of the page): the man with the upper body bent forward and sunk slightly, the right fist driving down and forward past the chest from beside the ear with the centre of the fist turned inward and set before the two legs, and the left palm pressed down from beside the hip with the fingers pointing forward and set to the left of the shin; an arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 106".

图 107

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the right leg bowed forward and the right sole settled flat, the two hands as upright palms before the chest pushing slowly forward with the right high and the left low; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 107".

图 108甲

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the left leg bowed forward and the left sole settled flat, the left hand level with the mouth and the right hand level with the chest, the two hands pushing slowly forward; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 108 甲".

图 108乙

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the right leg lifted and the right toe kicking forward level with the knee, the two hands parted left and right with the right high and the left slightly lower, the right hand level with the shoulder; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 108 乙".

turns 135 degrees to the right, sitting the left leg full. At the same time the right fist rises with the turn of the body, passes before the face, and falls to the right-rear, becoming an upright palm before the chest; the left hand likewise rises as an upright palm to before the chest, the two hands right high and left low. The right leg turns with the body toward due east, and the right foot steps forward, touching first with the heel (as in the right lazy-tie-the-garment posture). The left heel presses, the right leg bows forward, the right sole settles flat, the left leg bends slightly, and the legs become full-right and empty-left; the two hands push slowly forward (the upper body may not lean forward or backward); facing due east. (Figure 107)

Movement two: the right toe turns slightly outward and settles; the left foot steps forward one long pace, touching first with the heel; then the right heel presses, the left leg bows forward, and the left sole settles flat and becomes full. At the same time the two hands, before the chest, circle with the left hand moving up and the right hand moving down; when the left hand comes level with the mouth and the right hand level with the chest, they push slowly forward as the left leg bows forward (the upper body may not lean forward or backward). (Figure 108 甲) Then the left toe turns slightly outward and settles, the whole weight shifts onto the left leg, the right leg lifts and the right toe kicks forward, level with the knee, the left leg bending slightly; at the same time the two hands part left and right, the right high and the left slightly lower, the right hand level with the shoulder, the right arm in line with the right leg, and the right hand having the intent of slapping the top of the right foot; facing due east. (Figure 108 乙)

Movement three: the right leg falls; the right foot passes behind the left heel and settles flat on the left side behind the left heel, the two legs full-right and empty-left. At the same time the two hands draw in before the chest, the right hand level with the mouth and the left hand level with the chest. (Figure 109 甲) Then the left foot steps back one pace, the toe pointing toward the left-front diagonal, the left leg slightly bent, still empty-left and full-right; at the same time the two hands shift back with the retreating step. The weight shifts back, sitting the left leg full, and the right toe tilts up, so that the legs become full-left and empty-right; at the same time the two hands move from the front downward, drawing back in an arc before the chest. Then the left heel presses, the right leg bows forward, the right sole settles flat, and the legs still become full-right and empty-left; at the same time the two hands push slowly forward (the upper body may not lean forward or backward), the right hand level with the eyes and the left hand level with the chest; facing due east. (Figure 109 乙)

图 109甲

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the right foot passed behind the left heel and settled flat on the left side behind the left heel, the two hands drawn in before the chest with the right hand level with the mouth and the left hand level with the chest, the two legs full-right and empty-left. Labelled at its side "Figure 109 甲".

图 109乙

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the right leg bowed forward and the right sole settled flat, the two hands pushing slowly forward with the right hand level with the eyes and the left hand level with the chest; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 109 乙".

图 110

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the two hands closed into fists before the chest, the centres of the fists facing each other above and below and the two arms forming a half-circle, the right leg drawn back with the toe touching before the left foot and the body shifted back, so that the legs become full-left and empty-right. Labelled at its side "Figure 110".

图 111

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the right foot withdrawn behind the left and settled, the toe pointed toward the right-front diagonal, the left leg drawn in with the toe touching before the right foot, and the two fists before the chest facing each other above and below with the two arms forming a half-circle; arrows in the picture mark the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 111".

图 112

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the right leg slightly bent and the left leg lifted, the left toe kicking forward level with the knee, and the two fists opened into upright palms parted left and right with the left high and the right slightly lower; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 112".

图 113

Line drawing (middle left of the page): the man revolving 270 degrees to the right-rear on the right heel, the two hands drawn in before the chest as upright palms with the palms turned down, and the left foot settled flat toward the north; a downward arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 113".

图 114

Line drawing (middle right of the page): the man with the left leg slightly bent and the right toe tilted up, pushing forward with the heel level with the knee, and the two hands parted left and right as upright palms with the right high and the left slightly lower; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 114".

图 115

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the body leaning slightly forward, the two hands before the chest as facing upright palms, the right foot in front and the left toe touching the ground. Labelled at its side "Figure 115".

图 116

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the left hand raised forward and up as an upright palm turned right, the right hand closed into a fist at the waist beside the right hip, the right leg bowed forward; a leader line with an arrow running upward from the left hand marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 116".

图 117

Line drawing (middle right of the page): the man with the right hand raised forward and up as an upright palm and the left hand before the chest, the right leg bowed forward; a downward arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 117".

图 118

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the two hands pushed forward in parallel before the chest as upright palms, level with the chest; a forward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 118".

图 119

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the two hands joined before the chest as upright palms with both palms turned forward, the body shifted back, and the left toe touching before the right foot. Labelled at its side "Figure 119".

图 120

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest; a downward arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 120".

图 121

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest and the body leaning forward; a leftward arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 121".

图 122

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the right hand before the forehead and the left hand closed into a fist before the abdomen in the manner of embracing a tiger, the right leg bowed forward; a circular arc in the picture marks the circling of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 122".

图 123

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the two hands joined before the chest as upright palms with the intent of holding a ball; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 123".

图 124

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest and the body shifted back, the two legs full-left and empty-right. Labelled at its side "Figure 124".

图 125

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the left hand as an upright palm before the chest and the right hand before the abdomen, the right foot stepped forward with the toe tilted up and the heel touching the ground. Labelled at its side "Figure 125".

图 126

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest, the right hand in front and the left behind; a circular arc in the picture marks the circling of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 126".

The two postures are joined into one section-sequence: movements one and two are "The hand plays the lute"; movements three and four are "Right lazy tie the garment".

图 127

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest, the right leg in front, the body facing the northwest diagonal. Labelled at its side "Figure 127".

图 128

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest, the right foot stepped forward with the toe tilted up and the heel touching the ground. Labelled at its side "Figure 128".

图 129

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest with the fingers pointing up, the body facing due south, the left foot in front; a leftward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 129".

图 130

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest and the body facing due south; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 130".

图 131

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the left hand fallen to before the abdomen with the fingers pointing forward and the right hand raised level with the crown with the palm turned up, the left foot drawn in beside the right with the toe touching the ground; a downward arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 131".

图 132

Line drawing (middle left of the page): the man with the left hand raised to before the forehead level with the crown and the palm turned outward, and the right hand arcing down and scooping up to the left to before the abdomen with the fingers pointing up, the right foot having followed forward with the toe touching beside the left heel, the two legs full-left and empty-right; a circular arc in the picture marks the arcs of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 132".

图 133

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the right hand raised to before the forehead level with the crown and the palm turned outward, and the left hand arcing down and scooping up to the right to before the abdomen with the fingers pointing up, the left foot having followed forward with the toe touching beside the right heel, the two legs full-right and empty-left; a circular arc in the picture marks the arcs of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 133".

图 134

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the left hand raised to before the forehead level with the crown and the palm turned outward, the right hand before the abdomen, the body turned slightly left; a circular arc in the picture marks the arcs of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 134".

图 135

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the two hands pushed slowly forward before the chest as upright palms, the left hand inside and level with the chest and the right hand outside and level with the eyes, the left foot having followed with the toe touching behind the right heel, the two legs full-right and empty-left; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 135".

图 136

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the right toe turned 135 degrees to the left and facing the southeast diagonal, the two hands joined before the chest as upright palms level with the mouth, and the left foot having followed to beside the right heel with the toe touching the ground, the two legs full-right and empty-left. Labelled at its side "Figure 136".

图 137

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest and the right arm bent and held level in front, the left foot in front; a horizontal arrow to the right in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 137".

图 138

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the right leg bowed forward, the right arm bent before the forehead and the left hand as an upright palm before the chest; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 138".

图 139

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the left toe turned inward about 90 degrees and the left leg sitting full, the body turned right, the right heel touching the ground with the toe tilted up and turning with the body, the left hand raised level with the head with the palm up, and the right hand fallen as an upright palm before the chest; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 139".

图 140

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the left hand raised past the face and set above the forehead with the fingers pointing right, and the right hand pushing slowly out before the chest, the right leg bowed forward; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 140".

图 141

Line drawing (middle-lower left of the page): the man with the right hand as an upright palm before the chest and the left hand above the forehead, the right foot having passed behind the left foot to the left side of the left heel and touching the ground with the toe; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 141".

Movements one and two are the same as movements one and two of the fourteenth posture, "The hand plays the lute", the body and the left toe bend back to the right at the same time; then the right foot steps up and settles toward the southeast diagonal, the left foot follows forward and touches with the toe beside the right heel, so that the right leg becomes full and the left leg empty. At the same time as the body turns and the foot steps up, the left hand arcs down and the right hand arcs up; the right hand is lifted past the face and set above the forehead, the fingers pointing left; the left hand falls to before the chest. As the body shifts forward and the left foot

follows, the two hands push the mountain forward slowly (the upper body may not lean forward or backward); facing the southeast diagonal. (Figure 141)

Movement three: the left foot steps up and settles toward the northeast diagonal, the right foot follows forward and touches with the toe beside the left heel, so that the legs become full-left and empty-right. At the same time the left hand arcs up, is lifted past the face, and is set above the forehead with the fingers pointing right; the right hand falls to before the chest. As the body shifts forward and the right foot follows, the two hands push slowly forward (the upper body may not lean forward or backward); facing the northeast diagonal. (Figure 142)

Movement four is the same as movement two of this posture, except that the direction and angle differ: in this posture the right foot steps up toward the northwest diagonal. (Figure 143)

图 142

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the left hand arcing and set above the forehead with the fingers pointing right, and the right hand fallen and pushing slowly out before the chest, the right foot stepping up toward the northeast diagonal; a circular arc in the picture marks the arcs of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 142".

图 143

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the right hand set above the forehead with the fingers pointing left and the left hand before the chest, the body stepping up toward the northwest diagonal; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 143".

图 144

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest and the body shifted back, the right foot drawn in before the left with the toe touching the ground, the two legs full-left and empty-right. Labelled at its side "Figure 144".

Fifty-eighth posture — The hand plays the lute (Figures 144–145)

Fifty-ninth posture — Right lazy tie the garment (Figures 146–147)

The two postures are joined into one section-sequence: movements one and two are "The hand plays the lute"; movements three and four are "Right lazy tie the garment".

Movements one and two are the same as movements one and two of the fourteenth posture, "The hand plays the lute". (Figures 144–145)

Movements three and four are the same as movements three and four of the fifteenth posture, "Right lazy tie the garment". (Figures 146–147)

图 145

Line drawing (middle left of the page): the man with the right hand raised above the forehead with the palm turned outward and the left hand fallen to before the chest, the right foot stepped forward with the toe touching beside the left foot; a leftward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 145".

图 146

Line drawing (middle, centre, of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest circling with the right high and the left slightly lower, the right hand level with the eyebrows; a circular arc in the picture marks the circling of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 146".

图 147

Line drawing (middle right of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest and the body turned slightly left. Labelled at its side "Figure 147".

图 148

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest, the body facing the right-front diagonal; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 148".

图 149

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the two hands before the chest as facing upright palms, the right leg bowed forward; a horizontal arrow to the right in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 149".

图 150

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest, the right slightly higher, the left leg bowed forward; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 150".

图 151

Line drawing (middle left of the page): the man with the left hand fallen to before the abdomen with the fingers pointing forward and the right hand raised level with the crown with the palm turned up, the left foot drawn in beside the right with the toe touching the ground; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 151".

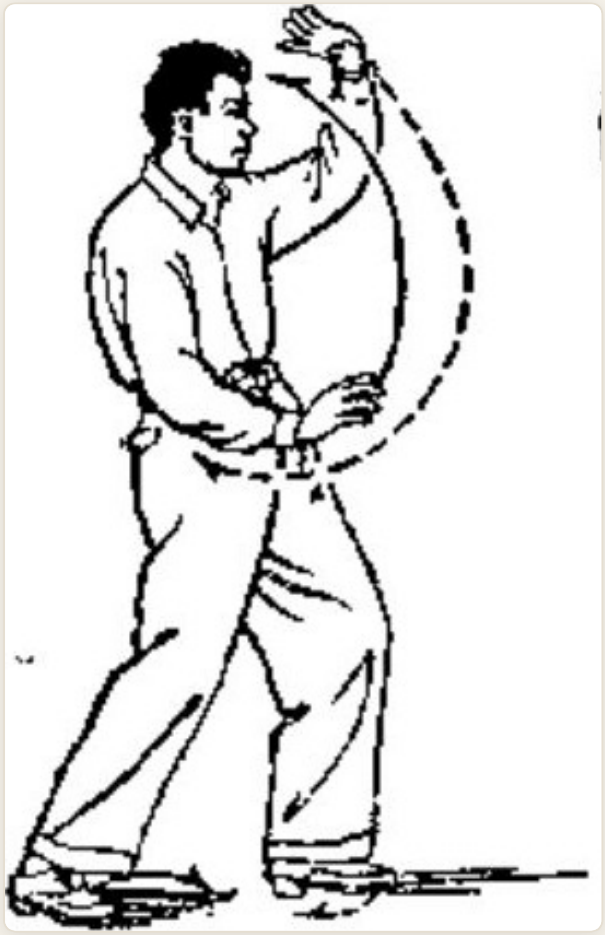
图 152

Line drawing (middle, centre, of the page): the man with the left hand before the abdomen and the right hand before the forehead, the two hands facing each other above and below; a circular arc in the picture marks the arcs of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 152".

图 153

Line drawing (middle right of the page): the man with the left hand before the abdomen and the right hand before the forehead, the body facing the right-front diagonal; a circular arc in the picture marks the arcs of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 153".

图 154



Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest and the right arm bent and held level in front, the left foot in front; a horizontal arrow to the right in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 154".

图 155

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest and the right arm bent before the forehead, the right leg bowed forward; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 155".

图 156

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the left leg bowed forward and the two hands parted left and right following the leg as upright palms to form the single-whip posture; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 156".

图 157

Line drawing (middle left of the page): the man with the left hand fallen to before the abdomen with the fingers pointing forward and the right hand raised level with the crown with the palm turned up, the left foot drawn in beside the right with the toe touching the ground; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 157".

图 158

Line drawing (middle, centre, of the page): the man standing on one leg with the right leg lifted, the knee bent and the thigh level, the shin hanging down and the toe pointing down; the right hand closed into a fist and raised level with the crown with the centre of the fist turned inward and the forearm upright, the left hand pressed down beside the left hip level with the right thigh; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 158".

图 159

Line drawing (middle right of the page): the man standing on one leg with the left leg lifted, the knee bent and the thigh level, the shin hanging down and the toe pointing down; the left hand closed into a fist and raised level with the crown with the centre of the fist turned inward and the forearm upright, the right hand pressed down beside the right hip level with the left thigh; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 159".

Three postures are joined into one section-sequence: movement one is "Single whip"; movement two is "Lower the posture"; movements three and four are "The golden rooster stands on one leg".

Movement one is the same as movement one of the thirty-fourth posture, "Single whip". (Figure 156)

图 160

Line drawing (middle right of the page): the man with his back to the reader, the two fists opened into upright palms parted left and right level with the shoulders, and the body and right toe turned 90 degrees left on the right heel to sit the right leg full, the left toe touching behind the right heel. Labelled at its side "Figure 160".

图 161

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with his back to the reader, the left hand fallen to before the abdomen and the right hand raised beside the right cheek, the left foot stepped forward with the toe tilted up and the heel touching the ground; a leftward arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 161".

图 162

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with his back to the reader, the left hand brushed past the left knee and set beside the left leg, and the right hand pushing slowly forward; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 162".

图 163

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with his back to the reader, the two hands joined before the chest as upright palms with the intent of holding a ball, and the right foot having followed to beside the left heel with the toe touching the ground. Labelled at its side "Figure 163".

Movement two is the same as the section-sequence joining the thirty-first posture, "Single whip", and the thirty-second posture, "Lower the posture", and four are the same. (Figures 161–163)

Sixty-seventh posture — Right push back the monkey (Figures 164–167)

Movements one, two, three and four are the same as the four movements of the twentieth posture, "Right push back the monkey". (Figures 164–167)

图 164

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man facing the reader, the right hand fallen to before the abdomen and the left hand raised beside the left cheek, the right foot stepped out toward the right-front diagonal with the toe tilted up and the heel touching the ground. Labelled at its side "Figure 164".

图 165

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man facing the reader, the right hand brushed past the right knee and set beside the right leg, and the left hand pushing slowly forward; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 165".

图 166

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man facing the reader, the two hands joined before the chest as upright palms with the intent of holding a ball, and the left foot having followed to beside the right heel with the toe touching the ground. Labelled at its side "Figure 166".

图 167

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man facing the reader, the right hand before the chest and the left hand before the abdomen, the two legs full-right and empty-left; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 167".

图 168

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with his back to the reader, the two hands as upright palms before the chest and the right arm bent and held level in front, the left foot touching the ground behind; a downward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 168".

图 169

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with his back to the reader, the left hand raised forward and the right hand before the chest, the left foot in front; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 169".

图 170

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with his back to the reader, the left hand brushed past the left knee and set beside the left leg, the right hand before the chest; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 170".

图 171

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with his back to the reader, the two hands as upright palms before the chest with the fingers pointing up, and the left foot having followed to beside the right heel with the toe touching the ground; a downward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 171".

图 172

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man facing the reader, the right hand before the chest and the left hand before the abdomen, the two legs full-left and empty-right; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 172".

图 173

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the right hand raised above the forehead and the left hand before the chest, the left heel lifted and the toe touching the ground; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 173".

图 174

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the right hand before the forehead and the left hand before the chest, the body turned slightly right, the right foot stepped forward with the toe tilted up and the heel touching the ground; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 174".

图 175

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the two hands joined before the chest as upright palms with the intent of holding a ball, the two legs full-right and empty-left; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 175".

图 176

Line drawing (middle left of the page): the man with the right hand before the forehead and the left hand before the abdomen, the body facing the right-front diagonal; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 176".

图 177

Line drawing (middle, centre, of the page): the man with the right hand raised above the forehead and the left hand before the chest, the right foot stepped forward with the heel touching the ground; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 177".

图 178

Line drawing (middle right of the page): the man with the right hand raised above the forehead and the left hand before the chest; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 178".

Seventieth posture — The hand plays the lute (Figure 176)

Seventy-first posture — The white goose spreads its wings (Figures 177–179)

The two postures are joined into one section-sequence, and the explanation of its four movements is the same as that of the section-sequence joining the twenty-third posture, "The hand plays the lute", and the twenty-fourth posture, "The white goose spreads its wings". (Figures 176–179)

图 179

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the two hands joined before the chest as upright palms with the intent of holding a ball, the two legs full-left and empty-right; a downward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 179".

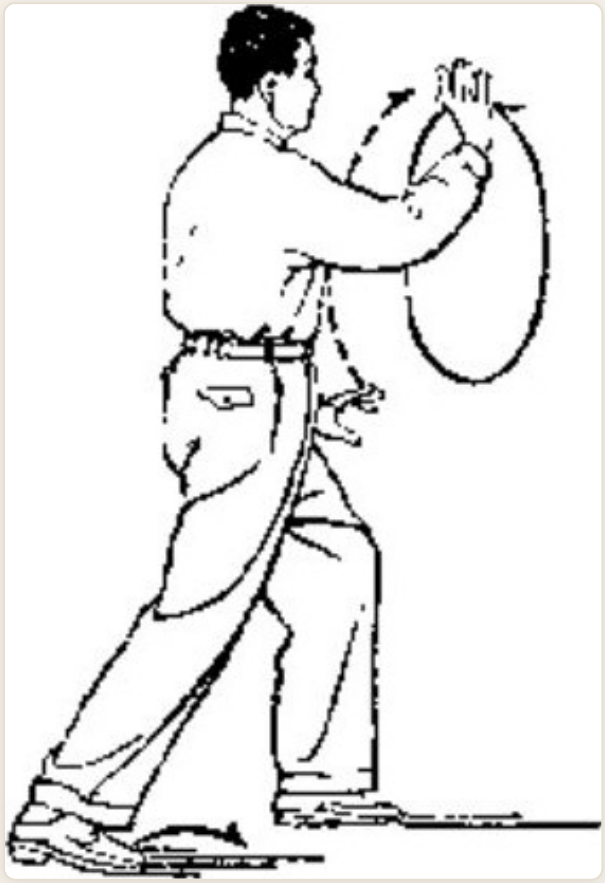
图 180

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the left hand fallen to before the abdomen and the right hand before the chest, the body turned slightly left, the left foot stepped forward with the toe tilted up and the heel touching the ground; a downward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 180".

图 181

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the left hand before the abdomen and the right hand raised beside the right cheek, the left leg bowed forward; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 181".

图 182



Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the left hand brushed past the left knee and set beside the left leg and the right hand before the chest, the left leg bowed forward; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 182".

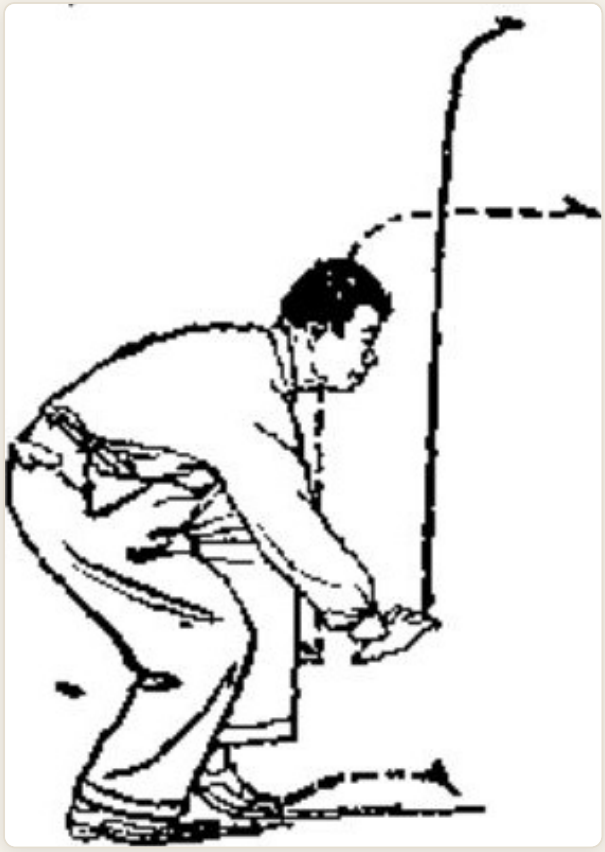
图 183

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest with the fingers pointing up, and the right foot having followed to beside the left heel with the toe touching the ground; a downward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 183".

图 184

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the right hand before the forehead and the left hand before the abdomen, the right foot stepped forward with the heel touching the ground; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 184".

图 185



Line drawing (middle left of the page): the man with the upper body bent forward and the two hands pressed straight down, the fingers of the left hand pointing forward and set to the left of the left shin, the fingers of the right hand pointing left and set before the two legs; an upward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 185".

Seventy-fifth posture — Blue dragon issues from the water (Figure 186)

Seventy-sixth posture — Turn the body over (Figure 187)

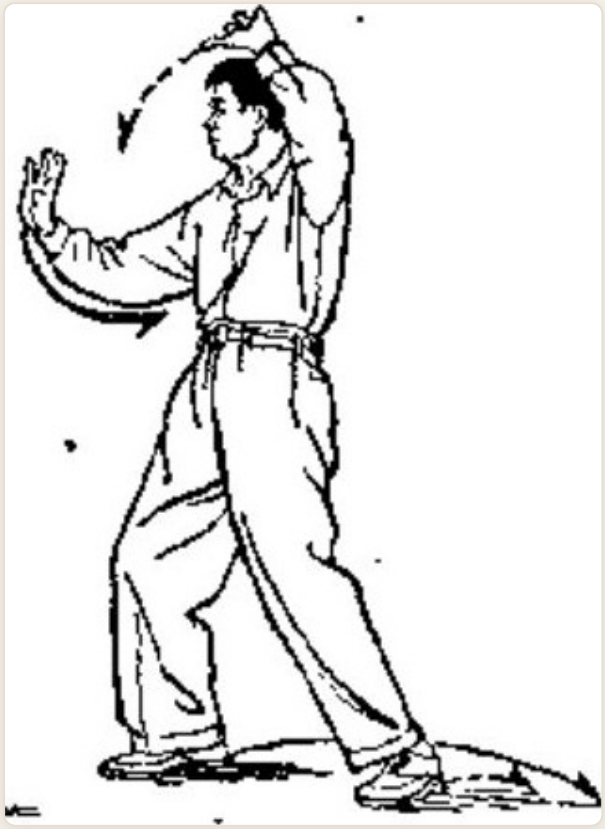
Four postures are joined into one section-sequence, and the explanation of its movements is the same as that of the section-sequence joining the twenty-sixth posture, "The hand plays the lute", the twenty-seventh posture, "Drape the posture", the twenty-eighth posture, "Blue dragon issues from the water", and the twenty-ninth posture, "Turn the body over". (Figures 184–187)

Seventy-seventh posture — Three Yong-shan peaks (Figures 188–191)

图 186

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the right hand raised above the forehead and the left hand before the chest, the left leg bowed forward; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 186".

图 187



Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the left hand raised above the forehead and the right hand before the chest, the right leg bowed forward; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 187".

图 188

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest and the body leaning slightly forward, the right foot in front; a downward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 188".

图 189

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest and the right arm bent and held level in front, the left foot in front; a horizontal arrow to the right in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 189".

图 190

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the right leg bowed forward, the right arm bent before the forehead and the left hand as an upright palm before the chest; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 190".

图 191

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest with the fingers pointing up, the body facing the right-front diagonal. Labelled at its side "Figure 191".

图 192

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest, the right slightly higher, and the right foot stepped forward with the heel touching the ground. Labelled at its side "Figure 192".

图 193

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the two hands pushed forward in parallel before the chest as upright palms; a forward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 193".

图 194

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the right leg bowed forward and the two hands parted left and right as upright palms with the left high and the right slightly lower; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 194".

图 195

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the left hand fallen to before the abdomen with the fingers pointing forward and the right hand raised level with the crown with the palm turned up, the left foot drawn in beside the right with the toe touching the ground; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 195".

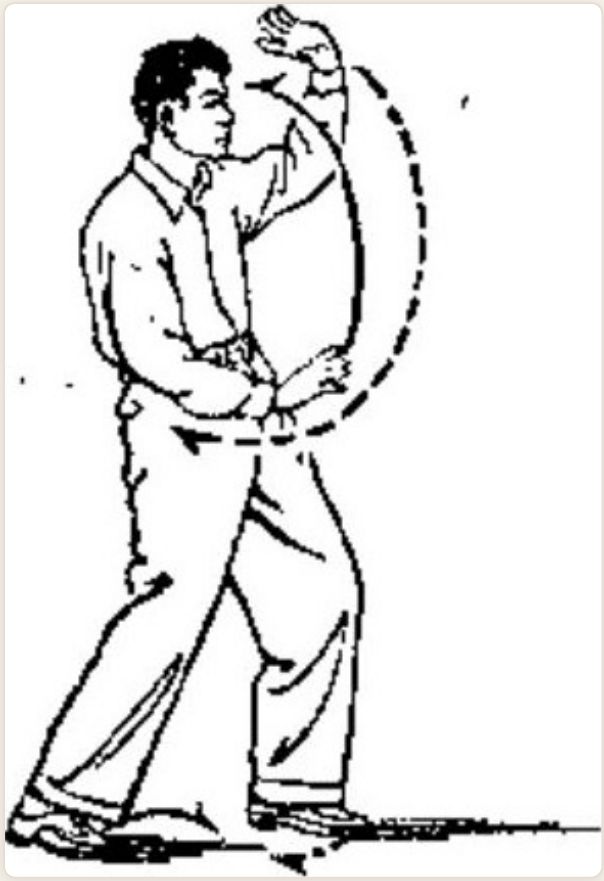
图 196

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the left hand before the abdomen and the right hand before the forehead, the two hands facing each other above and below; a circular arc in the picture marks the arcs of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 196".

图 197

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the left hand before the abdomen and the right hand before the forehead, the body facing the right-front diagonal; a circular arc in the picture marks the arcs of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 197".

图 198



Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the left hand before the abdomen and the right hand before the forehead, the two hands facing each other above and below; a circular arc in the picture marks the arcs of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 198".

图 199

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the left hand before the abdomen and the right hand before the forehead, the body facing the right-front diagonal; a circular arc in the picture marks the arcs of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 199".

图 200

Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the left leg bowed forward and the two hands parted left and right as upright palms with the left high and the right slightly lower; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 200".

Eighty-first posture — Single whip (Figure 200)

Eighty-second posture — Raise the hand and lift the posture (Figures 201–202)

Eighty-third posture — High pat the horse (Figure 203)

Three postures are joined into one section-sequence, and the explanation is the same as that of the section-sequence joining the thirty-fourth posture, "Single whip", the thirty-fifth posture, "Raise the hand and lift the posture", and the thirty-sixth posture, "High pat the horse", the explanation of whose movements is the same. (Figures 200–203)

Eighty-fourth posture — Palm to the heart (Figure 204)

Eighty-fifth posture — Turn the body, cross-swing the lotus (Figure 205)

Eighty-sixth posture — Step up, punch to the crotch (Figure 206)

Eighty-seventh posture — Right lazy tie the garment (Figure 207)

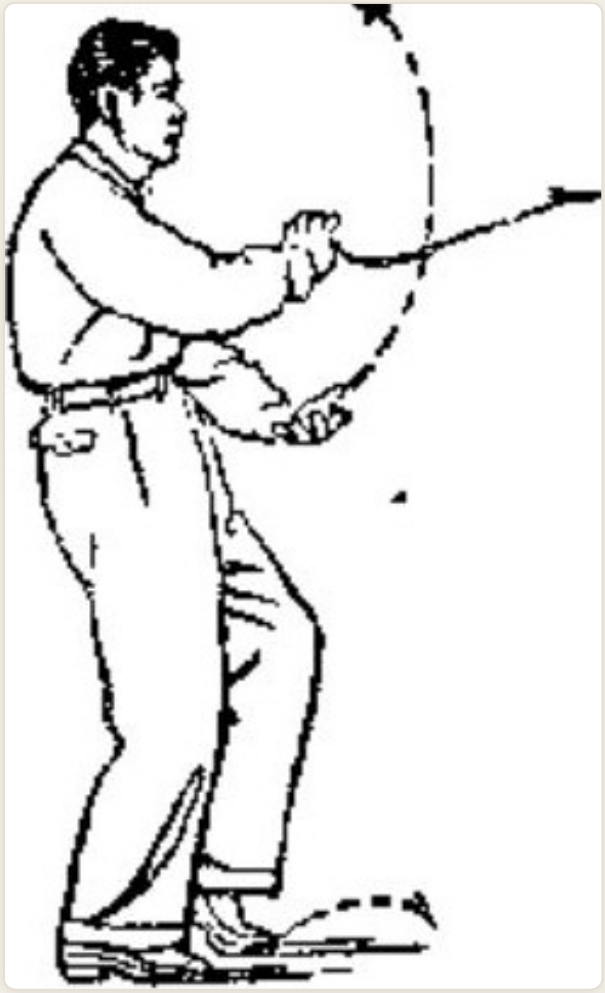
图 201

Line drawing (middle left of the page): the man with the right hand raised above the forehead with the palm turned down and the left hand closed into a fist before the abdomen, the two legs full-left and empty-right. Labelled at its side "Figure 201".

图 202

Line drawing (middle, centre, of the page): the man with the right hand raised before the forehead and the left hand before the chest, the right leg slightly bent; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 202".

图 203



Line drawing (middle right of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest, the right foot in front; a circular arc in the picture marks the arcs of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 203".

图 204

Line drawing (middle-lower right of the page): the man with the right hand above the forehead with the fingers pointing right, the right hand turned to an upright palm and pushing slowly forward level with the chest, the left leg bowed forward; a forward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 204".

Four postures are joined into one section-sequence: movement one is "Palm to the heart"; movement two is "Turn the body, cross-swing the lotus"; movement three is "Step up, punch to the crotch"; movement four is "Right lazy tie the garment".

图 205

Line drawing (middle left of the page): the man revolving to the right-rear on the left heel with the left toe turned 135 degrees to the right and settled, the right toe tilted up and the right leg lifted and arcing forward as the body turns, and the two hands parted left and right as upright palms with the fingers pointing up, level with the shoulders; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 205".

图 206

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the upper body bent forward, the left hand beside the left leg and the right fist driving forward and down, the left leg bowed forward; a downward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 206".

图 207

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the two hands pushing slowly forward before the chest as upright palms with the right high and the left low, the left foot having followed behind the right heel with the toe touching the ground; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 207".

图 208

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest and the right arm bent and held level in front, the left foot in front; a horizontal arrow to the right in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 208".

Movement one: the left foot steps out due east, touching first with the heel; the right heel presses, the left leg bows forward, the left sole settles flat, the right leg bends slightly, and the two legs become full-left and empty-right. The left hand passes in front of the right hand (its palm turning down), rises and is lifted past the face (the palm turning up as it lifts),

Eighty-eighth posture — Single whip (Figures 208–210)

Eighty-ninth posture — Lower the posture (Figure 211)

The two postures are joined into one section-sequence: movements one, two and three are "Single whip"; movement four is "Lower the posture".

Movement one is the same as movement one of the fifty-sixth posture, "Single whip". (Figure 208)

Movements two, three and four are the same as movements two, three and four of the section-sequence joining the thirty-first posture, "Single whip", and the thirty-second posture, "Lower the posture". (Figures 209–211)

Ninetieth posture — Step up to seven stars (Figure 212)

Ninety-first posture — Step back and bestride the tiger (Figure 213)

Ninety-second posture — Turn the foot and swing the lotus (Figure 214)

Ninety-third posture — Bend the bow and shoot the tiger (Figure 215)

Ninety-fourth posture — Double embracing punch (Figure 216)

图 209

Line drawing (middle right of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest, the right slightly higher, and the left foot stepped forward with the heel touching the ground; a horizontal arrow to the right in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 209".

图 210

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the right leg bowed forward and the two hands parted left and right as upright palms with the left high and the right slightly lower; an arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 210".

图 211

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the left hand fallen to before the abdomen with the fingers pointing forward and the right hand raised level with the crown with the palm turned up, the left foot drawn in beside the right with the toe touching the ground; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 211".

图 212

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the two hands crossed before the chest, level with the mouth, the fingers pointing up and the backs of the hands facing each other, and the right foot having followed to beside the left heel with the toe touching the ground, the two legs full-left and empty-right; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 212".

图 213

Line drawing (middle right of the page): the man with the right hand held as an upright palm circling before the right of the head, level with the crown, and the left hand, its palm turned down and the fingers pointing forward, set before the left hip, the left toe touching before the right foot, the two legs full-right and empty-left; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 213".

图 214

Line drawing (upper left of the page): the man with the left foot lifted and swinging out to the right, level with the knee and the toe pointing down, the left hand raised to the upper right corner level with the right hand, and the body revolving to the right-rear on the right sole; a downward arc-shaped arrow in the picture marks the swing of the left foot. Labelled at its side "Figure 214".

图 215

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): the man with the left fist parted to the upper-left diagonal and the right fist to the lower-right diagonal to form the shape of drawing a bow, the right leg bowed forward; a down-right arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 215".

图 216

Line drawing (upper right of the page): the man with the upper body bent forward and the two fists driving slowly forward and down with the eyes of the fists facing each other and level with the abdomen, the left leg bowed forward; a downward arrow in the picture marks the direction. Labelled at its side "Figure 216".

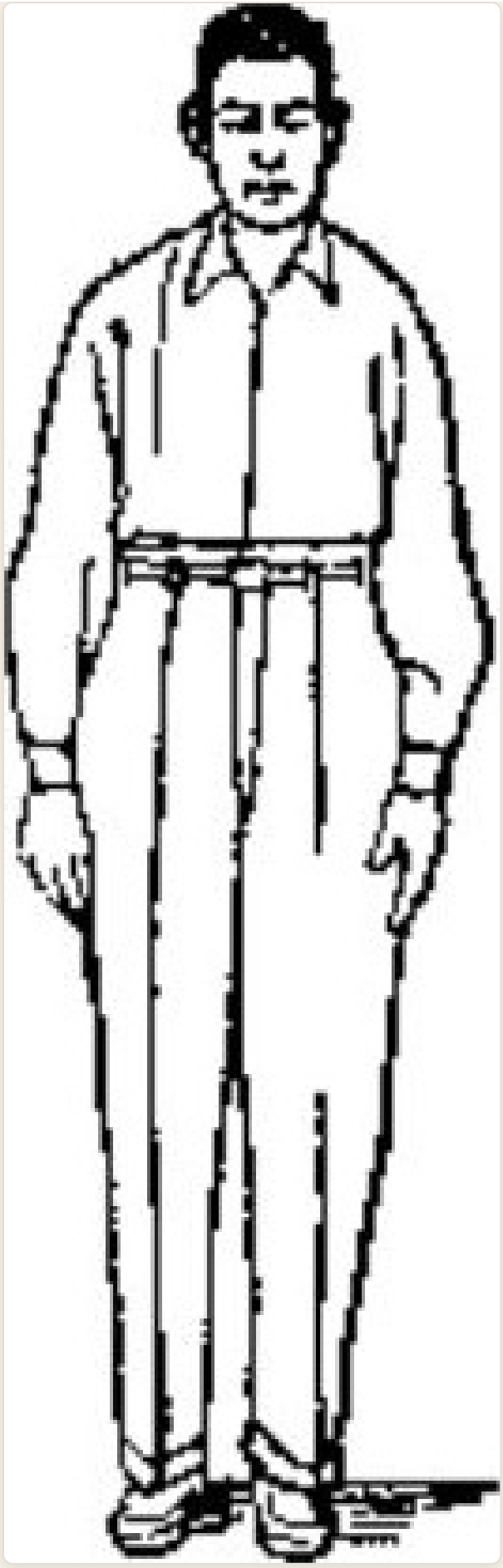
图 217

Line drawing (lower left of the page): the man with the two hands as upright palms before the chest, each circling once to form the hand-plays-the-lute posture, the left hand level with the mouth and the right hand fallen to before the abdomen, the left toe touching before the right foot; a circular arc in the picture marks the direction of the hands. Labelled at its side "Figure 217".

图 218

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): the man with the two feet brought together and the body turned square, the two hands pressing down to left and right and set beside the hips, the two arms slightly bent. Labelled at its side "Figure 218".

图 219



Line drawing (lower right of the page): the man with the two feet together, the two arms hanging naturally, the body standing upright, the eyes looking level ahead — the preparatory posture resumed. Labelled at its side "Figure 219".

Illustrated explanation of Wu-style taijiquan push-hands Taijiquan push-hands was originally called "hitting hands". Of what Wu Yuxiang and Li Yishe handed down, there is only the one kind — moving-step push-hands. Why adopt only moving-step push-hands and not fixed-step? The reason is that moving-step push-hands can be applied with agility and has no defect of stiffness; it trains both the stepping method and the body method, and at the same time allows practice of "stick, connect, adhere, follow". Moreover, in the course of the movement one is constantly able to keep a centred and stable posture, and can still issue energy while in motion. Once practised to familiarity, one can reach what the ancients called "walking, stopping, sitting, lying" — all of them states of practising the form.

图 220

Line drawing (lower left of the page): two men in contact pushing each other, the man on the right with his left hand pressing on the other's right arm, both men's steps one before the other. Labelled at its side "Figure 220".

图 221

Line drawing (lower middle of the page): two men in contact pushing each other, the man on the right stepping forward, both men's steps crossed. Labelled at its side "Figure 221".

图 222

Line drawing (lower right of the page): two men in contact pushing each other, the man on the right with his right hand extended forward and his left hand pressing on the other's arm. Labelled at its side "Figure 222".

图 223

Line drawing (upper left of the page): two men in contact pushing each other, the man on the right with his left hand pressing on the other's right arm, both men's steps one before the other. Labelled at its side "Figure 223".

图 224

Line drawing (upper middle of the page): two men in contact pushing each other, the man on the right with both hands pressing on the other's arm, both men's steps crossed. Labelled at its side "Figure 224".

图 225

Line drawing (upper right of the page): two men in contact pushing each other, the man on the right with his right hand extended forward and his left hand pressing on the other's arm, both men's steps one before the other. Labelled at its side "Figure 225".

The stepping method of Wu-style push-hands is three and a half steps forward, three and a half steps back. On the first and second steps forward, the advancing foot is placed on the outside of the opponent's front foot; on the third step forward, one foot is placed between the opponent's steps; on the fourth step the rear foot moves up beside the front foot with the toe touching the ground lightly, which is called a half-step. Whether placed on the outside of the opponent or between his steps, one should keep slightly close to the opponent's front foot. On one straight line I advance and he retreats, and he # Appendix — Classical treatises on the art

BOOK PAGE 646

Treatise on taijiquan

Treatise on taijiquan

Wang Zongyue of Shanyou

Taiji is born of wuji and is the mother of yin and yang. In movement it divides; in stillness it joins. Neither excess nor deficiency: follow the bend and yield to the extension. When the other is hard

and I am soft, this is called "walking away"; when I am yielding and the other is against his own advantage, this is called "sticking". If the movement is urgent, respond urgently; if the movement is slow, follow slowly. Though the transformations are myriad, the principle is one throughout. From familiarity with the postures one gradually awakens to understanding energy (dong jin); from understanding energy one ascends step by step to the divine illumination. Yet without long application one cannot break through to sudden comprehension. Empty the collar and lift the crown of the head; sink the breath to the dantian. Neither lean nor incline; now hidden, now revealed. If the left is heavy, the left becomes empty; if the right is heavy, the right vanishes. Look up and it grows higher; look down and it grows deeper. Advance and it grows longer; retreat and it grows more pressing. Not even a feather can be added, nor an insect alight. The other does not know me; I alone know the other. That the hero meets no enemy wherever he turns comes about from this alone. There are very many side doors to this art; though the postures differ, they amount to no more than the strong cheating the weak and the slow giving way to the quick. Strength beating weakness and a slow hand yielding to a quick hand are all natural endowments of the inborn body, not something that comes from learning. Consider the saying "four ounces deflect a thousand catties" — plainly it is not victory by strength. Observe the form of the aged defeating a crowd — of what use is speed? Stand like a balance beam; move like a wheel. Lean to one side and you follow; be double-weighted and you stagnate. One constantly sees men of several years' pure practice unable to transform, and it is invariably because they let themselves be controlled by the other — they have not awakened to the fault of double-weighting. To avoid this fault one must know yin and yang. Sticking is walking away, and walking away is sticking; yin does not leave yang, nor yang leave yin. Only when yin and yang aid each other is there understanding of energy. After understanding energy, the more one practises the finer it becomes; silently recognizing and pondering, one gradually arrives at doing as the heart desires. The root of it is to give up the self and follow the other; many mistake this and give up the near to seek the far.

As the saying goes, "a difference of a hair's breadth is an error of a thousand li" — the student cannot but examine this carefully. This is the treatise.

The thirteen postures (also called the long form, also called the thirteen postures)

Wang Zongyue of Shanyou

The long form: it is like the great Yangtze and the great sea, rolling on without cease.

The thirteen postures: ward-off, roll-back, press, push, pluck, split, elbow, shoulder, advance, retreat, look left, gaze right, and central equilibrium. Ward-off, roll-back, press and push are the four cardinal directions, kan, li, zhen and dui. Pluck, split, elbow and shoulder are the four diagonal corners, qian, kun, gen and xun. These are the eight trigrams. Advancing, retreating, looking left, gazing right and central equilibrium are metal, wood, water, fire and earth. These are the five elements. Taken together, they are called the thirteen postures.

BOOK PAGE 647

Song of practising the thirteen postures (author unknown)

Song of practising the thirteen postures (author unknown)

Do not slight the thirteen postures in all; Their life and intent have their source in the waist's gap. In changing fullness and emptiness, take care; Let breath go through the body, not dulled in the least. Touched in stillness, moving yet still as before; To change with the enemy is the wonder. In every posture keep the mind weighing intent; What is gained comes without felt expenditure of effort. Moment by moment keep the mind at the waist; Within the belly, loose and still, the breath rises. The tailbone centred, spirit threading the crown;

The whole body light and nimble, each part suspended. Attend closely and seek it out in yourself; Bend and extend, open and close, follow what is free. Crossing the threshold needs guiding by word of mouth; Ceaseless application, and the method settles of itself. If you ask what the standard of body and use is: Intent and breath are the lord, bone and flesh the minister. Push the question of intent to its end — where does it lie? Long life, lengthened years, an unwithering spring. Sing, O sing — a hundred and forty lines; Every word is true, its meaning beyond doubt.

If one does not seek it out along this path, one wastes one's labour and will only lament too late!

BOOK PAGE 648

Song of pushing hands Revised by Wang Zongyue

Song of pushing hands Revised by Wang Zongyue

Ward-off, roll-back, press and push — take them seriously; When upper and lower follow one another, the opponent finds no way in. Let him come at me with all his giant strength — A pull of four ounces deflects a thousand catties. Draw him in, let him fall into emptiness, issue as he closes; Stick, connect, adhere, follow — never lose the crown of the head.

BOOK PAGE 649

Body method Wu Yuxiang

Body method Wu Yuxiang

Sink the chest, raise the back, wrap the crotch, protect the ribs, lift the crown, suspend the crotch, soar and shift, flash and battle.

Essential words on pushing hands Wu Yuxiang

Explanation: Use the mind to move the breath; one must be sunk and steady, and only then can it gather and enter the bones — this is what is meant by "the source of the command of intent lies in the gap of the waist." The intent and breath must be exchanged with agility, and only then is there the delight of roundness and liveliness — this is what is meant by "in changing and turning, fullness and emptiness must be heeded." Stand with the body centred and upright, at ease and comfortable, bracing in all eight directions; move the breath like a nine-bend pearl, so that no subtlety is unreached — this is what is meant by "the breath goes through the whole body without the least dullness."

In issuing power one must be sunk, steady, loose and still, concentrating on a single direction — this is what is meant by "touched in stillness, moving yet still as before." In going and returning there must be folding; in advancing and retreating there must be turning — this is what is meant by "to change with the enemy is the wonder." Seek the straight within the curved, store and then issue — this is what is meant by "in every posture keep the mind weighing intent; moment by moment keep the mind at the waist." If the spirit can be raised, then there is no fear of slowness and heaviness — this is what is meant by "within the belly, loose and still, the breath rises." With an insubstantial crown lifting the power, the breath sunk to the elixir field, neither leaning nor inclining — this is what is meant by "the tailbone centred, spirit threading the crown; the whole body light and nimble, the crown suspended." Move the body with the breath, and one must be smooth and compliant, and only then can one be agile and follow the mind — this is what is meant by "bend and extend, open and close, follow what is free." The mind is the command, the breath the banner, the spirit the commander-in-chief, the body the servant — this is what is meant by "intent and breath are the lord, bone and flesh the minister." Explanation: Though the body moves, the mind values stillness; the breath must gather, the spirit should be at ease. The mind is the command, the breath the banner, the spirit the commander-in-chief, the body the servant; moment by moment keep the mind on it, and only then is anything attained. First in the mind, afterwards in the body. When it is in the body, one no longer knows that the hands dance and the feet stamp. This is what is meant by "completing it in one breath," "giving up the self and following others," "drawing him in to fall into emptiness," "four ounces deflecting a thousand catties." Know that when one thing moves, nothing is unmoved; when one thing is still, nothing is unstilled. Regard movement as stillness, regard stillness as movement; inwardly solidify the spirit, outwardly show ease and comfort. One must follow others, not proceed from oneself; following others one lives, proceeding from oneself one stagnates. He who prizes breath has no power; he who nourishes breath is purely firm. When the other does not move, I do not move; when the other moves slightly, I move first. Leaning on others with oneself, one must know oneself, and only then can one turn and follow and follow and meet; sticking to others with oneself, one must know others, and only then can one be neither behind nor before. If the spirit can be raised, there is no fear of slowness and heaviness; if sticking and leaning can follow with agility, only then is the wonder of falling into emptiness seen. In going and returning, yin and yang must be distinguished; in advancing and retreating, there must be turning and closing. The opportunity is

issued from oneself; the force is borrowed from others. In issuing power, upper and lower must follow one another, and then one goes forward invincible; in standing, the body must be centred and upright, not inclining, and then it can brace in all eight directions. Still as a mountain, moving as a river. Step as if on the brink of an abyss, move power as if drawing silk, store power as if drawing a bow, issue power as if loosing an arrow. Move the breath like a nine-bend pearl, so that no subtlety is unreached; move power like steel tempered a hundred times, and what hardness will it not shatter. In form like a falcon seizing a hare, in spirit like a cat catching a mouse. Seek the straight within the curved, store and then issue. Gathering is issuing, continuous without break. Utterly soft, and only then can one be utterly firm; able to stick and lean, and only then can one be agile. Nourish the breath by what is straight and it does no harm; store the power by what is curved and it has surplus. Gradually one comes to respond to things as they come — this too is "knowing to stop, and so attaining."

Again it is said:

First in the mind, afterwards in the body; belly loose, breath gathered into the bones, spirit at ease, body still, moment by moment keeping the mind. Remember always: when one thing moves, nothing is unmoved; when one thing is still, nothing is unstilled. Regard stillness as movement, regard movement as stillness. In moving, pulling to and fro, the breath clings to the back, gathered into the spine — be still. Inwardly solidify the spirit, outwardly show ease and comfort. Step as a cat walks, move power as if drawing silk. The whole body's intent lies in storing spirit, not in breath; if in breath, then it stagnates. He who has breath has no power; he who has no breath is purely firm. The breath is like a cartwheel, the waist like the axle.

Again it is said:

When the other does not move, I do not move; when the other moves slightly, I move first. As if loose yet not loose, about to unfold yet not — unfold. The power breaks but the intent does not break.

Again it is said:

In every movement, the hand alone first applies force, and then immediately loosens. One must still thread it through, and this is nothing other than beginning, sustaining, turning and closing. First the intent moves, then the power moves; the transition must be strung on a single thread. The breath should be stirred and agitated, the spirit should be gathered inward. Do not allow any place of defect, do not allow any place of concavity or convexity, do not allow any place of break or interruption. Its root is in the feet, it issues from the legs, it is governed by the waist, it takes form in the fingers. From feet to legs to waist, it must always be one complete breath. Advancing and retreating, only then does one gain the opportunity and the position; where one does not gain opportunity and position, the body becomes scattered, and one must come to lean and tilt — the fault must be sought in the waist and legs, and it is so above and below, before and behind, left and right. All of this is intent, not outward form: where there is above there is below, where there is front there is back, where there is left there is right. If the intent wishes to go up, then lodge the intent below; if a thing is about to be lifted, and you add a breaking force to it,

then its root breaks of itself, and it is destroyed swiftly, beyond doubt. Fullness and emptiness should be clearly distinguished: each place has its own fullness and emptiness, and every place is always this one fullness and emptiness; the whole body is threaded joint by joint — do not let there be the least interruption.

BOOK PAGE 651

Releasing in pushing hands

Releasing in pushing hands

Ward-off péng (upper level tone) · yè (entering tone) · yī (rising tone) · ké (entering tone) · hū (rising tone) · kēng · hē · hā.

Five-word formula Li Yiyu

One: the mind is still

If the mind is not still, then it is not focused; as soon as one raises a hand, front, back, left and right have no fixed direction at all — hence the mind must be still. At first the movements cannot come from oneself; one must calm the mind and personally recognise it, following what the other does, yielding and extending with him, neither losing nor resisting, not extending and contracting on one's own. If he has force, I too have force, and my force is first; if he has no force, I — also have no force, and my intent is still first. One must keep the mind on it moment by moment: wherever one is touched, the mind must be applied there; one must seek the news within "neither losing nor resisting." Working on in this way, in a year or half a year one can apply it in the body. This is entirely intent, not the use of force; in time, others are controlled by me, and I am not controlled by others.

Two: the body is agile

If the body is stagnant, then one cannot advance and retreat freely; hence the body must be agile. In raising a hand one must not have a stupid look. When the other's force has just touched my skin and hair, my intent has already entered his bones; both hands brace, and one breath runs through. When the left is heavy, the left empties and the right has already gone; when the right is heavy, the right empties and the left has already gone. The breath is like a cartwheel: the whole body must follow along. Where it does not follow, the body becomes scattered and cannot get force — the fault must be sought in the waist and legs. First use the mind to command the body, following others and not oneself. Afterwards the body can follow the mind, and even proceeding from oneself is still following others. Proceeding from oneself one stagnates; following others one lives. If one can follow others, then in the hands there is measure. Weigh the size of his force, and there is no error of a fraction; gauge the length of his advance, and there is

no difference of a hair. Advancing and retreating, everywhere exactly fitting — the longer the work, the finer the skill.

Three: the breath gathers

If the breath's momentum is scattered and loose, then there is no containment, and the body easily scatters; one must cause the breath to gather into the spine. The breathing is numinous and unobstructed, and the whole body has no gap. Inhaling is closing and storing; exhaling is opening and issuing. For inhaling naturally lifts one up, and can also lift the other up; exhaling naturally sinks one down, and can also send the other out. This is moving the breath by intent, not driving the breath by force.

Four: the power is whole

The power of the whole body is trained into one family, distinguishing clearly fullness and emptiness. In issuing power there must be a root: the power rises from the heel, is governed at the waist, takes form in the fingers, and issues from the spine and back. One must also raise up the whole of one's spirit: at the moment when the other's power is about to issue but has not yet issued, my power has already joined his power — exactly neither behind nor before, like skin catching fire, like a spring gushing out. Advancing and retreating, there is not the least scattering; seek the straight within the curved, store and then issue, and only then can one succeed at once with the hand. This is what is meant by "borrowing force to strike the man, four ounces deflecting a thousand catties."

Five: the spirit gathers

When the above four are all present, they all return to the gathering of the spirit. When the spirit gathers, then one breath forges and casts, refining the breath and returning it to the spirit, and the breath's momentum soars and shifts. The spirit is poured in; opening and closing have order; fullness and emptiness are clear. When the left is empty, the right is full; when the right is empty, the left is full. Emptiness is not being utterly without force — the breath's momentum must have soaring and shifting; fullness is not being utterly locked up — the spirit must be valued and poured in. The crux lies entirely in the transforming within the chest and waist, not outside. Force is borrowed from others; breath issues from the spine. How can breath issue from the spine? The breath sinks downward, gathering from both shoulders into the spine and pouring into the waist — this is the breath going from above to below, and it is called closing. From the waist it takes form in the spine, spreads to both arms, and is applied in the fingers — this is the breath going from below to above, and it is called opening. Closing is gathering; opening is issuing. If one can understand opening and closing, then one knows yin and yang. Arriving at this stage, one day's work is one day's refinement of skill, until gradually one follows what the mind desires, and nothing fails to accord with one's intent.

BOOK PAGE 652

Secret formula for releasing Li Yiyu

Secret formula for releasing Li Yiyu

Lift, draw, loosen, release

Lift up his body, borrowing his force. Within it is the word "numinous." Draw him to the front of the body, and the power only then stores. Within it is the word "gather." Loosen my power and do not let it bend. Within it is the word "still." In releasing, the waist and feet must recognise the exact point. Within it is the word "whole."

BOOK PAGE 653

Essential words on practising the form and pushing hands Li Yiyu

Essential words on practising the form and pushing hands Li Yiyu

The men of old said: "One can draw in and let fall into emptiness, and can deflect a thousand catties with four ounces; one cannot draw in and let fall into emptiness, and cannot deflect a thousand catties with four ounces." The words are very comprehensive, and the beginner has no way to grasp them. I add a few phrases to explain them, so that those who have the will in this art may find the way in, and so advance daily with achievement. If one wishes to draw in and let fall into emptiness, and to deflect a thousand catties with four ounces, one must first know oneself and know others. If one wishes to know oneself and know others, one must first give up up the self and follow others. If one wishes to give up the self and follow others, one must first gain the opportunity and the position. If one wishes to gain opportunity and position, one must first make the whole body one family. If one wishes to make the whole body one family, one must first have no defect in the whole body. If one wishes to have no defect in the whole body, one must first have the spirit and breath stirred and agitated. If one wishes the spirit and breath stirred and agitated, one must first raise up the spirit, so that the spirit cannot scatter outward. If one wishes the spirit not to scatter outward, one must first have the spirit and breath gather and enter the bones. If one wishes the spirit and breath to gather and enter the bones, one must first have strength in the front section of both thighs. Both shoulders loosen, the breath sinks downward, the power rises from the heel, changes in the legs, is contained in the chest, moves in both shoulders, and is governed in the waist. Above, the two arms are linked; below, the two legs follow. The power is exchanged from within: gathering is closing, releasing is opening. When still, all is still; stillness is closing, and within closing is lodged opening. When moving, all moves; movement is opening, and within opening is lodged closing. Touched, one then turns and revolves freely, and nowhere fails to get force. Only then can one draw in and let fall into

emptiness, and deflect a thousand catties with four ounces. In ordinary practice of the form, this is the work of knowing oneself: at each movement, first ask whether one's whole body accords with these several items; if it accords but slightly not, then change at once — hence in practising the form one should be slow and not fast. Pushing hands is the work of knowing others; movement and stillness are indeed knowing others, but it is still asking oneself. If one has arranged oneself well, then when another touches me, I do not move him a hair's breadth, but take advantage of his momentum to enter, join and fix his power, and he falls out of himself. If one has a place where one cannot get force, then it is double-weighting not yet transformed, and one must seek it in the opening and closing of yin and yang. This is what is meant by "know yourself and know others, and in a hundred battles you will win a hundred victories."

Note: The above classical treatises on boxing are selected and transcribed from the definitive edition of the *Taijiquan Manual* that Li Yiyu copied out and presented to Hao Weizhen in 1881; the text has not been altered by later hands.

Four-word secret formula (author to be verified)

Fu (spread): Fu means moving the breath in one's own body and spreading it over the other's power, so that he cannot move.

Gai (cover): Gai means using the breath to cover the place from which the other comes.

Dui (match): Dui means using the breath to match the place from which the other comes, fixing the aim and then going out.

Tun (swallow): Tun means using the breath to swallow him wholly and enter into transformation.

These four words are without form and without sound; only after understanding power, when one has refined to the most exquisite stage, can one know them — completely it is spoken of in terms of breath. If one can nourish one's breath by what is straight and without harm, only then can one apply it to the four limbs, and the four limbs will speak without words.

Textual note: Li Fuyin, grandson of Li Yiyu, compiled the Lianrang Hall edition of the *Taijiquan Manual* in 1935 and took the "Four-word secret formula" to be a work of Wu Yuxiang, basing this on the *Brief Account of My Late Grandfather, the Honourable Lianquan*, written by Wu Laixu, grandson of Wu Yuxiang. Laixu said of his grandfather that "receiving the art, his insights came entirely from the four-word formula," and so Fuyin took the "Four-word secret formula" to be Wu Yuxiang's work. Considering that this formula's boxing theory is lofty and subtle, with a level above Li Yiyu's "Secret formula for releasing"; that Li Yiyu's *Taijiquan Manual*, written out for Hao He in 1881, fully records Wu Yuxiang's boxing treatises; that Wu Yuxiang died in 1880; and that Wu and Li stood as teacher and student and lived in the same village — if this formula were Wu Yuxiang's work, there is no way it would not have been included. Hence this formula is probably not Wu Yuxiang's work, and may have been composed by a disciple of Wu or of Li. Li Yiyu died in 1892, so it is also possible that he wrote this formula. It is singled out here for further examination.

(Appendix note by Gu Liuxin)

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Preface

Preface

Guided by the Party's policy of "letting a hundred flowers bloom, a hundred schools of thought contend," the editor drew on the posthumous work of her late father, Mr. Sun Lutang — *The Study of Taijiquan* (《太极拳学》) — and on the way he practiced in his later years, and compiled *Sun-Style Taijiquan* (《孙式太极拳》), published in 1957. To meet the needs of the broad masses in their physical training, the editor has now revised the 1957 edition. The movement descriptions have been amended and expanded, the movement photographs have been retaken, and the applications of certain principal movements have been added, while the original structure has been retained in the main. Although the editor received instruction from her late father in person from early childhood, she is conscious that her own skill falls short of depth and purity; still, for the convenience of those who love Sun-style Taijiquan and wish to practise it, she has done her best.

Confined as it is by the editor's level, the book will inevitably contain errors; readers are earnestly asked to point them out.

— The Editor

Note: the printed page number is 前言; the scan page is 4.

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Brief Introduction to Sun-Style Taijiquan

Brief Introduction to Sun-Style Taijiquan

The founder of Sun-style taiji (太极, tàijí) quan was Sun Fuquan (孙福全, Sūn Fúquán), courtesy name Lutang (禄堂, Lùtáng), late sobriquet Hanzhai (涵斋, Hánzhāi), a native of Wanxian in Hebei. From childhood he was passionately fond of martial arts. He studied Xingyi Quan (形意拳, Xíngyì Quán) under Li Kuiyuan (李魁垣, Lǐ Kuíyuán), and then studied under Li's own teacher Guo Yunshen (郭云深, Guō Yúnshēn), from whom he received the true transmission. He also studied Baguazhang (八卦拳, Bāguàzhāng) under Cheng Tinghua (程廷华, Chéng Tínghuá). After several years of study and polishing his skill ran deep. He later studied taijiquan under Hao Weizhen (郝为真, Hǎo Wéizhēn). Sun Lutang (孙禄堂, Sūn Lùtáng) devoted his whole life to the study of martial arts; he was proficient in Xingyi, Baguazhang and taijiquan, and gathering the essential meaning of the three schools into one, he created Sun-style taijiquan.

The characteristics of Sun-style taijiquan are: advance and retreat follow one another; when stepping forward one must follow, when stepping back one must withdraw. The movements are extended, rounded and lively, nimble and natural. In practice the two feet are clearly distinguished as empty and full (虚实, xūshí). The whole set, once begun, is like drifting clouds and flowing water, continuous and unbroken. At every turn of the body "opening" and "closing" (开合, kāihé) join, and so it is also called kaihe huobu taijiquan (开合活步太极拳, kāihé huóbù tàijíquán). It is suitable for people of any age and any constitution to practise.

General Explanation of Taijiquan

Taijiquan is one of the martial arts peculiar to our country. It is an exercise of "cultivating both within and without" (inwardly it governs calming the mind and nurturing the nature, outwardly it governs training the body); it takes suppleness and curvature as its substance and firmness and straightness as its function. Without suppleness and curvature one cannot neutralize; without firmness and straightness one cannot apply. In substance and function it is the fighting method of "using softness to overcome hardness, drawing aside four ounces to deflect a thousand catties." In practising this quan one should sink the qi to the dantian (丹田, dāntián), neither lean nor incline, so that inner and outer join; one must on no account use clumsy strength. One should move the strength by the intent (意, yì) — where the intent arrives, the strength arrives.

As to the method of practising taijiquan, my late father often said: Mr. Hao Weizhen spoke of three levels of mental state in practising taijiquan. At the first stage of practice it is as though the

body were in water, both feet treading the ground, and the movements meet the resistance of the water. At the second level it is as though the body were in water with both feet floating up, like a swimmer drifting in the water, able to move freely. At the third level the body is light and nimble, the two feet as if walking on the surface of the water — treading on the brink of the abyss, on thin ice — with the spirit and qi gathered inward, not daring to let there be the slightest scattering or disorder. Then the quan is accomplished.

The postures and movements of taijiquan all have definite essential points, and each has its own meaning. The essentials are introduced in summary below:

Head: The head should push up, but one must not use strength. The chin is naturally drawn in, the top of the head upright, the spirit concentrated. The whole body is relaxed and open; in lifting, pressing, extending and contracting one always uses intent and does not use clumsy strength, and the mind is naturally empty and numinous. This is what is called "empty and numinous, suspending the head-top" (虚灵顶劲, xūlíng dǐngjìn).

Mouth: The mouth should be loosely closed, the tongue touching the upper palate, breathing through the nose.

Chest: The chest should be contained and must not be thrust out. When the chest is contained the qi sinks to the dantian. When the chest is thrust out the qi surges into the chest region, the upper is heavy and the lower light, and the heels float — a thing taboo to the martial practitioner. When the chest is contained the qi clings to the back, and strength issues from the spine — this is true strength. The above is what is called "containing the chest and raising the back" (含胸拔背, hánxiōng bábèi).

Shoulders: Both shoulders must be relaxed and hanging down. One must especially avoid hunching the shoulders, otherwise the qi surges upward.

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General Explanation of Taijiquan (continued)

General Explanation of Taijiquan (continued)

Elbows: The two elbows should hang loosely downward, the two arms naturally bent. This is the meaning of "seeking the straight within the curved, storing and then issuing."

Hands: The five fingers are spread, the wrist sunk (塌腕, tāwàn), the tiger's mouth slightly rounded, the palm slightly drawn in, as though grasping and holding a ball.

Waist: The waist must be sunk (塌, tā). For the waist is the pivot of the whole body's movements and the source of strength. A person's turning, advancing and retreating, and the changes of empty and full all depend on the waist strength running through them.

Legs: The two legs are bent, and one must clearly distinguish empty and full — that is, the body's centre of gravity is placed on one leg. If the centre of gravity moves onto the right leg, then the right leg is full and the left leg is empty. Conversely, the left leg is full and the right leg is empty. Distinguishing empty and full is the essential meaning of taijiquan; moving thus, the turning is light and nimble. Otherwise the stepping is heavy and sluggish, and one is easily led about by others.

Breathing: What is called "sinking the qi to the dantian" (three inches below the navel) means deep and long abdominal breathing. But one must on no account use strength to press the qi downward; one must simply let the breathing be entirely natural (呼吸, hūxī).

Intent and strength: One of the characteristics of taijiquan is that it uses intent and does not use strength. For taijiquan requires the use of living strength; the whole body must be relaxed and open, not allowing the least bit of clumsy strength to linger between sinews, bones, blood and vessels. It requires being extremely soft and yet extremely firm and hard, extremely heavy and yet extremely nimble. Where the intent arrives the strength arrives, applied with ease. If clumsy strength is used, then it is sluggish and not nimble. If the strength floats on the outside, it does not accord with the requirements of taijiquan. What is meant by using intent and not using strength, and how does living strength arise of itself? It is because where the intent goes the qi arrives; thus the qi and blood flow and pour, day by day infusing and circulating through the channels and network vessels of the whole body, never for a moment stagnating. With long practice true inner strength (内劲, nèijìn) is then produced.

Movement and stillness: The quiet sitting of qigong is seeking movement within stillness; boxing art is seeking stillness within movement. In practising the quan the mind must be still and the spirit concentrated; only then can the movements be rounded and lively.

The above has discussed the essentials of movement separately. But the student must certainly note that taijiquan is an exercise of the whole body, and what is trained lies in the spirit. The spirit is the commander, the body is the servant; if the spirit can be raised, then the movements are naturally light and nimble. Only when mind and intent are in harmony with the movements of the form can inner and outer join as one. In practice one must take care that above and below follow one another, and that all parts of the body are complete and unified. If there is one place where the movement is not whole, the spirit and qi will be scattered and disordered. Furthermore, in practising the quan one should move the strength by the intent, linked without interruption, "like the long Yangtze River, rolling on without cease." "In movement, like drawing silk" —

General Explanation of Taijiquan (continued)

General Explanation of Taijiquan (continued)

— such is the meaning.

To make it easy for the reader to remember, these essential points are now put into a mnemonic verse as follows:

> *Taijiquan is originally an inner-school boxing (内家拳, nèijiāquán);*

> *do not use clumsy strength — intent comes first.*

> *Empty and numinous, suspending the head-top (顶头, dǐngtóu), the spirit concentrated;*

> *draw the chin back and it is then natural.*

> *Containing the chest, one can naturally raise the back;*

> *on no account form "hunchback shoulders."*

> *In practice sink the shoulders and drop the elbows;*

> *with shoulders hunched and elbows suspended it is not the quan.*

> *Sinking the waist (塌腰, tāyāo) can raise the strength of the whole body;*

> *if the waist is not sunk, nimbleness is difficult.*

> *The two legs bent distinguish empty and full;*

here lies the essential meaning of taiji.

Breathing (呼吸, hūxī) sinks down to the dantian point;

let it be purely natural, do not force it.

Above and below follow one another and become one body;

the movements, continuous and unbroken, are forever linked.

Seek stillness within movement, movement within stillness;

in practice the spirit and qi must be complete in every part.

Be sure to remember these points and not forget them;

with lasting practice the benefit will show of itself.

BOOK PAGE 660

Part One (上编, Shàngbiān) — 1. Names of the Movements

Part One (上编, Shàngbiān) — 1. Names of the Movements

No.	Name	No.	Name
1	Qishi (起式, qǐshì) — Starting Posture	24	Dao Nian Hou (倒撵猴, dào niǎn hóu), right form — Driving Back the Monkey
2	Lan Zha Yi (懒扎衣, lǎn zhā yī) — Lazily Tucking the Robe	25	Shou Hui Pipa (手挥琵琶, shǒu huī pípá), right form — Hands Playing the Pipa

3	Kai Shou (开手, kāi shǒu) — Opening the Hands	26	Bai He Liang Chi (白鹤亮翅, bái hè liàng chì) — White Crane Spreads Its Wings
4	He Shou (合手, hé shǒu) — Closing the Hands	27	Kai Shou (开手, kāi shǒu) — Opening the Hands
5	Dan Bian (单鞭, dān biān) — Single Whip	28	He Shou (合手, hé shǒu) — Closing the Hands
6	Ti Shou Shang Shi (提手上式, tí shǒu shàng shì) — Raising the Hands, Upper Posture	29	Lou Xi Ao Bu (搂膝拗步, lōu xī ào bù), left form — Brushing the Knee and Twist Step
7	Bai He Liang Chi (白鹤亮翅, bái hè liàng chì) — White Crane Spreads Its Wings	30	Shou Hui Pipa (手挥琵琶, shǒu huī pípá), left form — Hands Playing the Pipa
8	Kai Shou (开手, kāi shǒu) — Opening the Hands	31	San Tong Bei (三通背, sān tōng bèi) — Three Penetrations of the Back
9	He Shou (合手, hé shǒu) — Closing the Hands	32	Lan Zha Yi (懒扎衣, lǎn zhā yī) — Lazily Tucking the Robe
10	Lou Xi Ao Bu (搂膝拗步, lōu xī ào bù), left form — Brushing the Knee and Twist Step	33	Kai Shou (开手, kāi shǒu) — Opening the Hands
11	Shou Hui Pipa (手挥琵琶, shǒu huī pípá), left form — Hands Playing the Pipa	34	He Shou (合手, hé shǒu) — Closing the Hands
12	Jin Bu Ban Lan Chui (进步搬拦捶, jìn bù bān lán chuí) — Step Forward, Deflect, Parry and Punch	35	Dan Bian (单鞭, dān biān) — Single Whip
13	Ru Feng Si Bi (如封似闭, rú fēng sì bì) — As if Sealing, as if Closing	36	Yun Shou (云手, yún shǒu) — Cloud Hands
14	Bao Hu Tui Shan (抱虎推山, bào hǔ tuī shān) — Embrace the Tiger and Push the Mountain	37	Gao Tan Ma (高探马, gāo tàn mǎ) — High Pat on Horse
15	**Kai Shou (开手, kāi shǒu) — Opening the Hands**	**38**	**You Qi Jiao (右起脚, yòu qǐ jiǎo) — Right Kick with Toe**

16	He Shou (合手, hé shǒu) — Closing the Hands	39	Zuo Qi Jiao (左起脚, zuǒ qǐ jiǎo) — Left Kick with Toe
17	Lou Xi Ao Bu (搂膝拗步, lōu xī ào bù), right form — Brushing the Knee and Twist Step	40	Zhuan Shen Deng Jiao (转身蹬脚, zhuǎn shēn dēng jiǎo) — Turn Body and Heel Kick
18	Lan Zha Yi (懒扎衣, lǎn zhā yī) — Lazily Tucking the Robe	41	Jian Bu Da Chui (践步打捶, jiàn bù dǎ chuí) — Treading Step and Punch
19	Kai Shou (开手, kāi shǒu) — Opening the Hands	42	Fan Shen You Qi Jiao (翻身右起脚, fān shēn yòu qǐ jiǎo) — Turn Over Body and Right Toe Kick
20	He Shou (合手, hé shǒu) — Closing the Hands	43	Pi Shen Fu Hu (披身伏虎, pī shēn fú hǔ) — Drape the Body and Subdue the Tiger
21	Dan Bian (单鞭, dān biān) — Single Whip	44	Zuo Qi Jiao (左起脚, zuǒ qǐ jiǎo) — Left Kick with Toe
22	Zhou Xia Kan Chui (肘下看捶, zhǒu xià kàn chuí) — Look at the Fist below the Elbow	45	Zhuan Shen You Deng Jiao (转身右蹬脚, zhuǎn shēn yòu dēng jiǎo) — Turn Body and Right Heel Kick
23	Dao Nian Hou (倒撵猴, dào niǎn hóu), left form — Driving Back the Monkey	46	Shang Bu Ban Lan Chui (上步搬拦捶, shàng bù bān lán chuí) — Step Up, Deflect, Parry and Punch

Forty-seventh posture: As if Sealing and Closing (如封似闭, Rú Fēng Sì Bì) — Seventy-third posture: Opening the Hands (开手, Kāi Shǒu)

Forty-eighth posture: Embracing the Tiger and Pushing the Mountain (抱虎推山, Bào Hǔ Tuī Shān) — Seventy-fourth posture: Closing the Hands (合手, Hé Shǒu)

Forty-ninth posture: Opening the Hands (turning right) (开手（右转）) — Seventy-fifth posture: Brush the Knee and Twist the Step (left form) (搂膝拗步（左式）, Lōu Xī Ào Bù)

Fiftieth posture: Closing the Hands (合手) — Seventy-sixth posture: Hands Play the Pipa (手挥琵琶, Shǒu Huī Pí Pá)

Fifty-first posture: Brush the Knee and Twist the Step (right form) (搂膝拗步（右式）) — Seventy-seventh posture: Three-Way Back Penetration (三通背, Sān Tōng Bèi)

Fifty-second posture: Lazy Tucking the Robe (懒扎衣, Lǎn Zhā Yī) — Seventy-eighth posture: Lazy Tucking the Robe (懒扎衣)

Fifty-third posture: Opening the Hands (开手) — Seventy-ninth posture: Opening the Hands (开手)
Fifty-fourth posture: Closing the Hands (合手) — Eightieth posture: Closing the Hands (合手)

Fifty-fifth posture: Diagonal Single Whip (斜单鞭, Xié Dān Biān) — Eighty-first posture: Single Whip (单鞭, Dān Biān)

Fifty-sixth posture: Wild Horse Parts Its Mane (野马分鬃, Yě Mǎ Fēn Zōng) — Eighty-second posture: Cloud Hands (云手, Yún Shǒu)

Fifty-seventh posture: Lazy Tucking the Robe (懒扎衣) — Eighty-third posture: High Pat on Horse (高探马, Gāo Tàn Mǎ)

Fifty-eighth posture: Opening the Hands (开手) — Eighty-fourth posture: Crosswise Swing Lotus (十字摆莲, Shí Zì Bǎi Lián)

Fifty-ninth posture: Closing the Hands (合手) — Eighty-fifth posture: Step Forward and Strike the Crotch (进步指裆捶, Jìn Bù Zhǐ Dāng Chuí)

Sixtieth posture: Single Whip (单鞭) — Eighty-sixth posture: Step Back Lazy Tucking the Robe (退步懒扎衣, Tuì Bù Lǎn Zhā Yī)

Sixty-first posture: Right Back-Penetrating Palm (右通背掌, Yòu Tōng Bèi Zhǎng) — Eighty-seventh posture: Opening the Hands (开手)

Sixty-second posture: The Jade Maiden Works the Shuttle (玉女穿梭, Yù Nǚ Chuān Suō) — Eighty-eighth posture: Closing the Hands (合手)

Sixty-third posture: Lazy Tucking the Robe (懒扎衣) — Eighty-ninth posture: Single Whip (单鞭)

Sixty-fourth posture: Opening the Hands (开手) — Ninetieth posture: Single Whip Lower Posture (单鞭下势, Dān Biān Xià Shì)

Sixty-fifth posture: Closing the Hands (合手) — Ninety-first posture: Step Up Seven Stars (上步七星, Shàng Bù Qī Xīng)

Sixty-sixth posture: Single Whip (单鞭) — Ninety-second posture: Step Back and Bestride the Tiger (退步跨虎, Tuì Bù Kuà Hǔ)

Sixty-seventh posture: Cloud Hands (云手) — Ninety-third posture: Turn the Corner and Swing the Lotus (转角摆莲, Zhuǎn Jiǎo Bǎi Lián)

Sixty-eighth posture: Cloud Hands Lower Posture (云手下势, Yún Shǒu Xià Shì) — Ninety-fourth posture: Bend the Bow and Shoot the Tiger (弯弓射虎, Wān Gōng Shè Hǔ)

Sixty-ninth posture: Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg (金鸡独立, Jīn Jī Dú Lì) — Ninety-fifth posture: Double Striking Hammer (双撞捶, Shuāng Zhuàng Chuí)

Seventieth posture: Step Back and Repulse the Monkey (倒撵猴, Dào Niǎn Hóu) — Ninety-sixth posture: Yin and Yang Blended into One (阴阳混一, Yīn Yáng Hùn Yī)

Seventy-first posture: Hands Play the Pipa (right form) (手挥琵琶（右式）) — Ninety-seventh posture: Closing Posture (收式, Shōu Shì)

Seventy-second posture: White Crane Spreads Its Wings (白鹤亮翅, Bái Hè Liàng Chì)

BOOK PAGE 663

Part One. Two: Explanation of the Movements

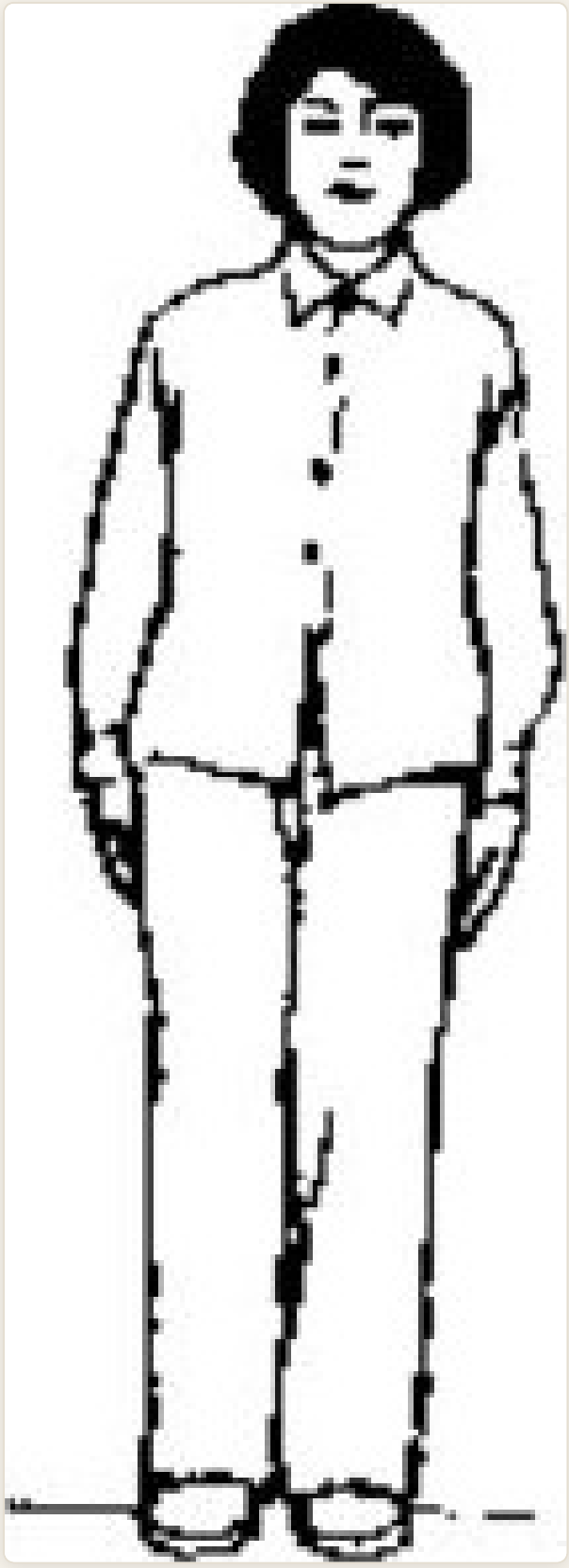
Part One. Two: Explanation of the Movements

First Posture: Beginning Posture (起式, Qǐ Shì)

- ① The body stands upright, both hands hang down, both shoulders relax; the tips of the two feet are separated by about 90°; the eyes look straight ahead, the mind is quiet, and one pauses briefly. (图 1)

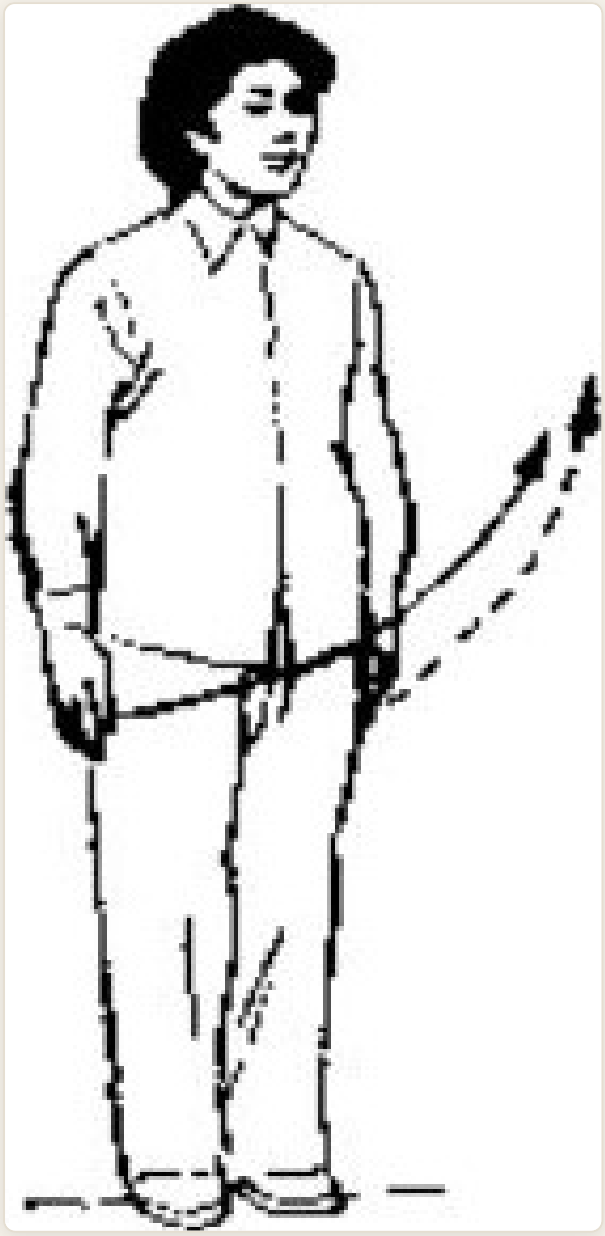
The eyes look straight ahead, the mind is quiet, and one pauses briefly. (图 1)

图 1



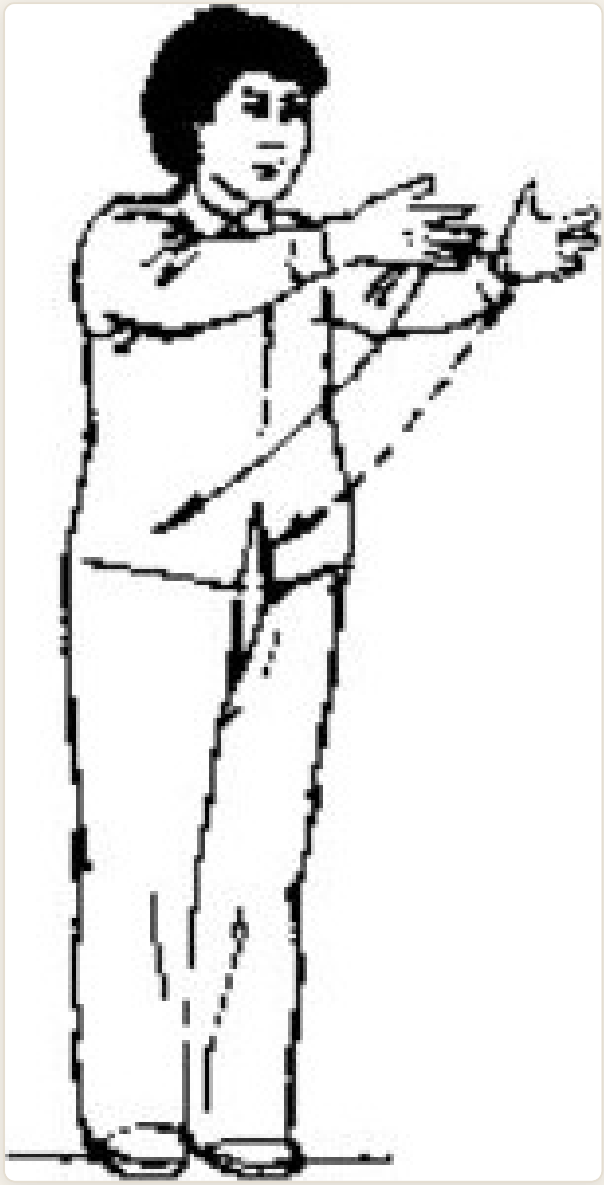
practitioner standing upright facing front, arms hanging naturally at the sides, feet apart, weight evenly on both legs.

图 2



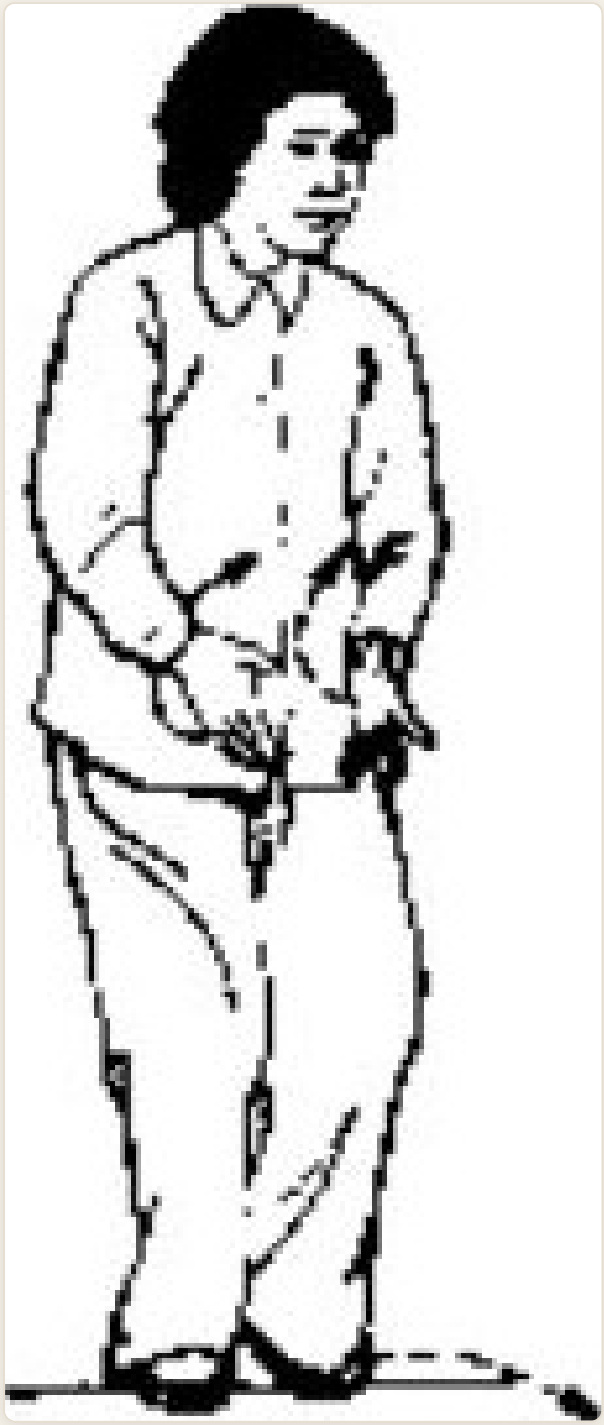
practitioner standing with the body turned slightly to the left, right toes raised and pivoting on the right heel, feet at roughly 45° to one another.

图 3



practitioner standing with both arms raised forward to about shoulder height, palms facing each other as if holding a ball, legs unchanged.

图 4

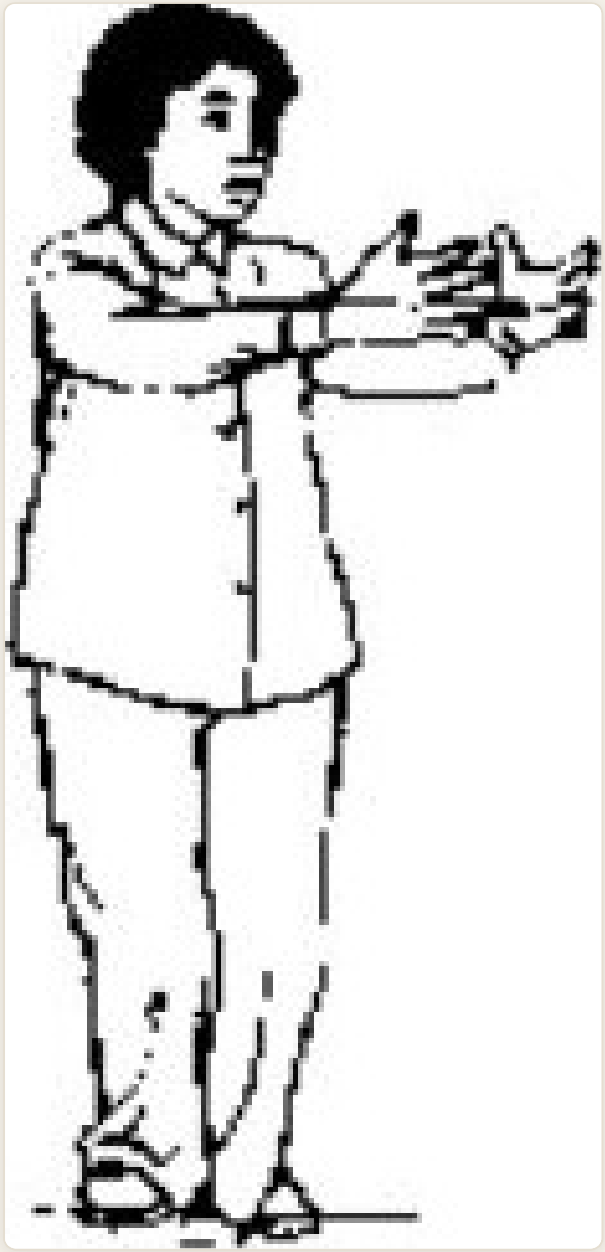


the whole body sinks into a crouch, both hands come down in front of the abdomen, the left heel is lifted.

图 7

both hands rotate to the right in front of the chest, the right palm facing up, the left hand supporting the right wrist.

图 10

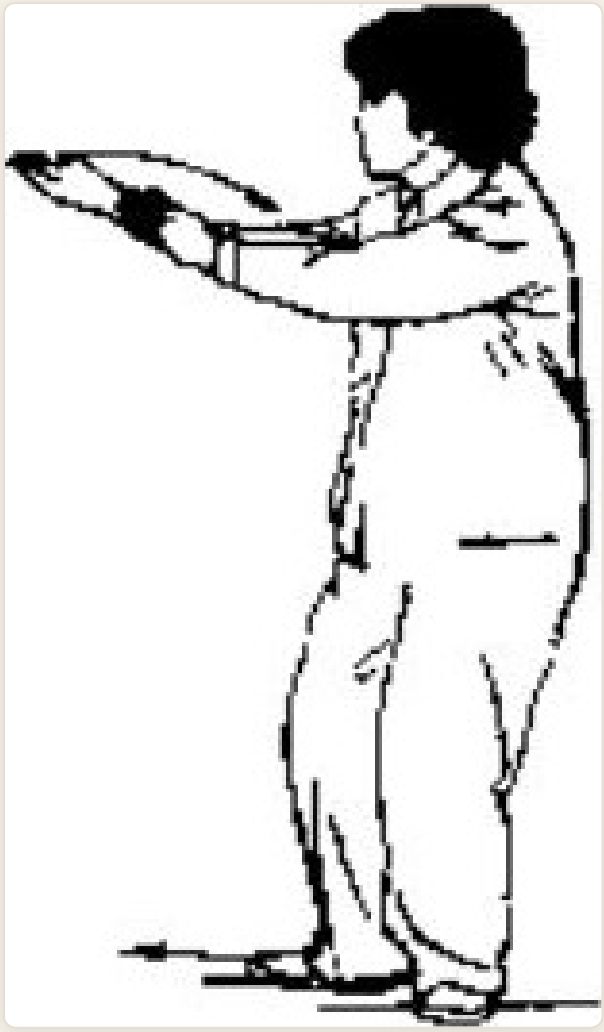


both hands push forward with the arms slightly bent, the right foot in front and the left foot behind.

图 5

the left foot has stepped forward, both hands extended forward as if holding a ball.

图 8

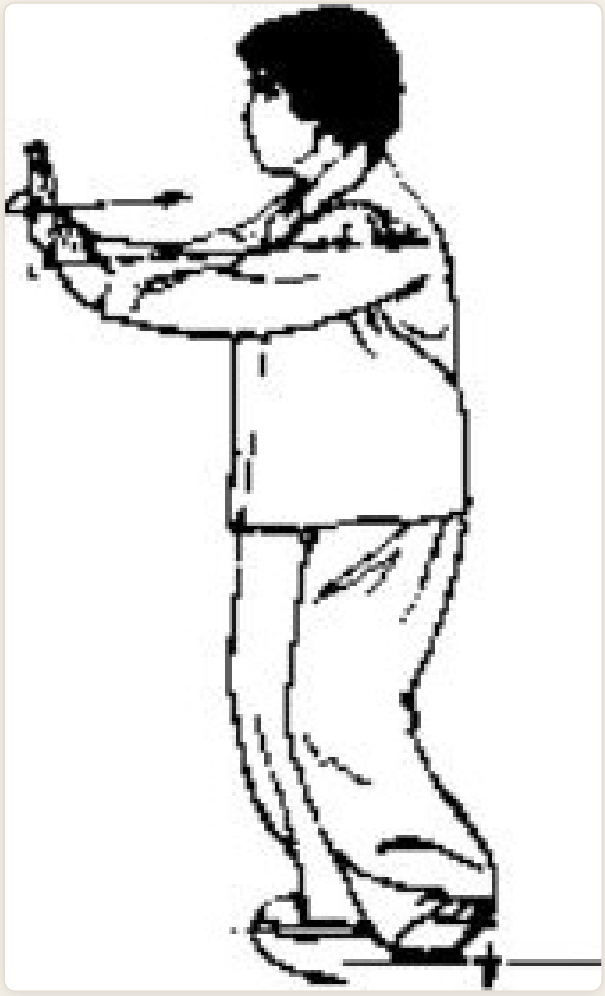


both hands rotate to the lower right, the right palm turned diagonally upward.

图 6

the right foot has followed up to the inner side of the left ankle, the toe touching the ground, both hands holding a ball in front of the chest.

图 9



the right hand having drawn a half-circle to the right and backward, the forearm is upright and the left hand supports the right wrist.

The right wrist pushes forward together with it, both arms slightly bent; at the same time the right foot steps forward, the heel touching the ground first and gradually settling; the left foot thereupon follows behind the right foot, about 10 cm apart, the toe touching the ground; the eyes look at the right hand, and one pauses briefly. (图 9、10)

Key points (要点, yàodiǎn): the movement must run through in a single continuous flow and must not be interrupted. Application (用法, yòngfǎ): Lazy Tucking the Robe is composed of warding off, rolling back, pressing and pushing (掤捋挤按, péng lǚ jǐ àn). ① Ward-off (掤, péng): when the opponent strikes with the hand, one presses his wrist down with the front hand and draws it backward, The rear hand quickly seeks out his elbow. If the opponent's attacking hand comes high, then both hands lift his arm from below and drive it backward and downward, or one may also drive it level toward the side and rear.

图 11

practitioner standing, both hands held in front of the chest at about shoulder height, forearms curved, palms facing each other.

图 12

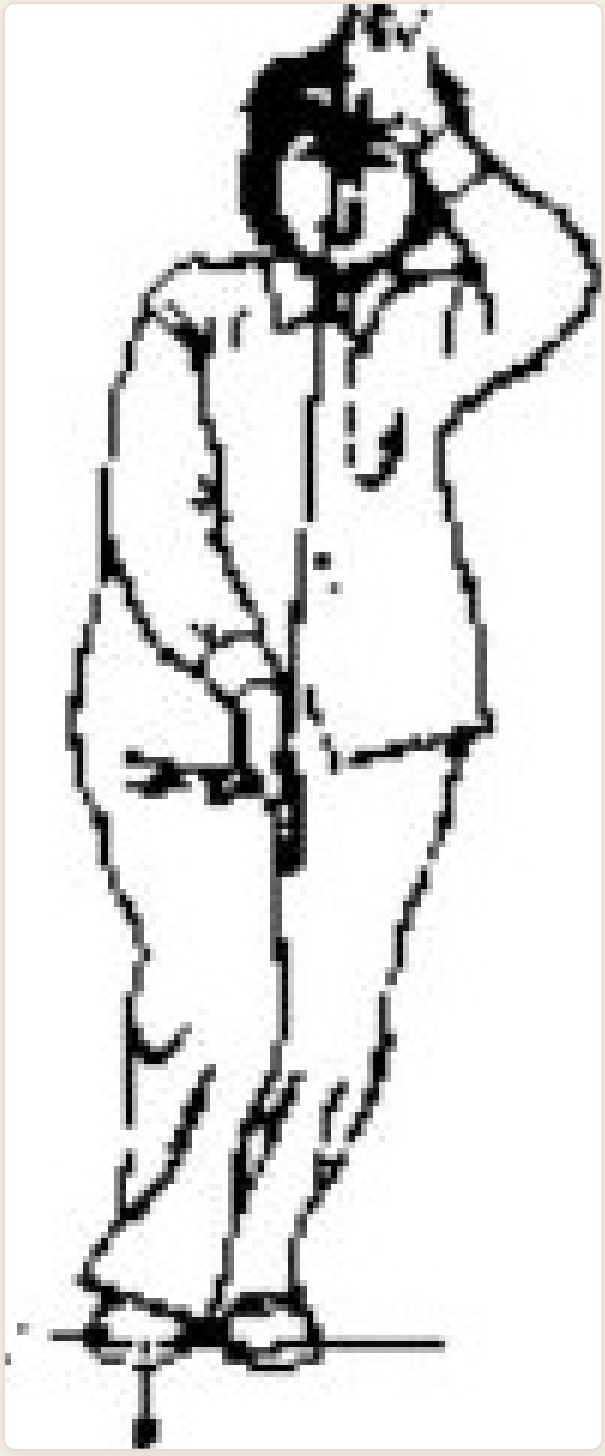
practitioner standing, both hands held forward in front of the chest, palms facing each other, feet apart with the weight settled.

- ③ Ward-off (掤, péng), that is, propping (not dead propping with brute resistance). When the opponent rushes at one with both hands, one sticks both arms upward to his hands, sits the waist back and withdraws the left step, turns the waist slightly to the right, pats to the right with the left hand and hangs to the right with the right hand; at this moment the opponent's force has already been neutralized, and one issues at the appropriate instant. The subtlety of the ward-off method lies in "sticking": neither letting go nor resisting, the two arms like springs, so that what the opponent touches seems both present and absent. Ward-off may be

done with both hands or with one; if one wards off the opponent's two hands with a single hand, one gains the more advantageous position.

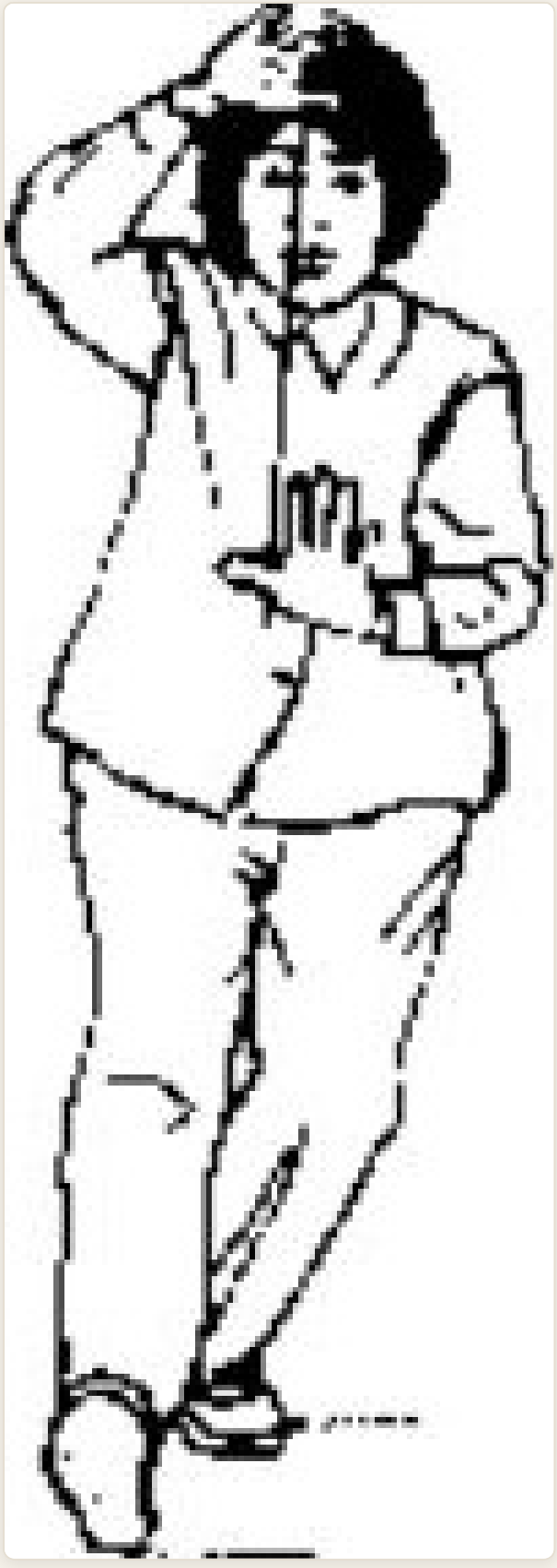
- ④ Push (按, àn): if the opponent attacks toward one, one lightly presses down both of his arms with both hands and immediately pushes out forward. Push may be done with one hand or both, with opening energy or closing energy as the situation determines, but one must stick to the opponent's arms so that he cannot turn and move freely.

图 13



practitioner in a wider stance with the arms opened out to the sides at shoulder height, both palms turned outward.

图 14



both hands opened left and right in front of the chest until they face the two shoulders, fingertips pointing up, the practitioner standing with one foot before the other.

图 15

both hands brought together in front of the chest, about a face-width apart, both knees bent, the tip of the left foot touching the ground.

图 16

both hands raised level to the left and right, the arms in a level-raise position, the two palms facing outward, standing with the feet apart.

[The left foot] buckles inward to the left by about 90°, and the body turns to the left along with it; at the same time, with the two palms facing each other and the fingertips pointing upward, [the hands] separate to left and right (as if holding a balloon whose air expands outward, opening

until the tiger's mouths of the two hands face the two shoulders), the two hands about 10 cm apart, and one pauses slightly. (图 11)

Fourth Posture: Closing the Hands (合手, Hé Shǒu)

Following on from the previous posture, with the two palms facing each other the hands slowly close inward; when they have come to about a face-width apart, one pauses slightly; at the same time both legs bend, the right foot is on the ground, the left heel lifts with the toe touching the ground; the eyes look at the space between the two hands. (图 12)

Key points (要点, yàodiǎn): the whole body must relax; there must not be the slightest forced strength.

Application (用法, yòngfǎ): Opening and Closing the Hands — if the opponent suddenly embraces one's two arms from behind with both hands, one immediately props against his two arms with the elbows, quickly presses downward, and following the momentum turns the body to the left or turns the body to the right.

Fifth Posture: Single Whip (单鞭, Dān Biān)

Following on from the previous posture, the two hands rotate inward and, as if driving a long pole, slowly separate to left and right, the two arms reaching a level-raise position, the two palms facing outward, the palm upright, at the height of the eyes; at the same time the left foot steps sideways to the left, the leg slightly bent; the right leg slightly straightened; the eyes look at the right hand, and one pauses briefly. (图 13)

Key points (要点, yàodiǎn): the upper body must be straight, the two shoulders must be relaxed, the breathing must be natural, and one must not use clumsy strength to press qi (气) down into the dantian (丹田, dāntián).

Application (用法, yòngfǎ): ① Single Whip deals with opponents on both the left and right sides. Although the two hands separate at the same time, one must be empty and the other full (虚实, xūshí); which is full and which is empty depends on how near or far the opponent's attacking force is. If the left hand ...a solid strike. The centre of gravity must fall on the left leg, while one keeps watch to the right; at the same time the right foot may be raised to kick an opponent on the right.

图 17

practitioner standing upright with both feet together, both arms extended forward in front of the chest, elbows bent, hands at chest height.

图 18

practitioner standing with feet together, both arms extended forward at chest height, one hand slightly in front of the other.

图 19

practitioner standing with feet together, both arms extended forward in front of the chest with palms turned outward.

图 20

practitioner in a standing pose with the left leg forward and bent, the left hand lowered to the outside of the left hip, the right arm raised out to the right side at about shoulder height, palm turned upward; the gaze directed toward the right hand.

- ② If the opponent attacks with both hands, I separate his hands, one upward and one downward, and at the same time swiftly advance the step and strike his chest with both hands.

Eighth Posture: Opening the Hands (开手, Kāi Shǒu)

The movement is the same as the Third Posture, "Opening the Hands". (图 18)

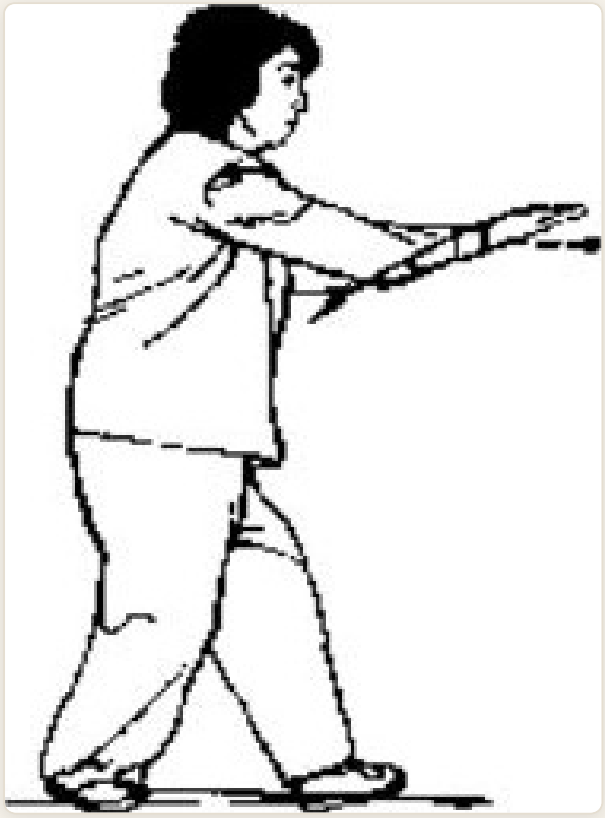
Ninth Posture: Closing the Hands (合手, Hé Shǒu)

The movement is the same as the Fourth Posture, "Closing the Hands". (图 19)

图 21

practitioner with the right leg stepped forward into a bow-like stance, the right arm extended forward, the left hand lowered; body facing forward.

图 22



practitioner in a low stance with the left leg forward and bent, the right arm extended forward at chest height and the left arm held low, palm turned upward.

图 23

practitioner in a walking stance with the left leg forward, the left arm bent in front of the chest and the right arm extended forward at chest height, palm turned upward.

用法 (yòngfǎ) Application: if the opponent strikes with his right fist, one's right palm presses his wrist and the left hand presses his elbow, and following the momentum one seizes (攫) or breaks (撅) it.

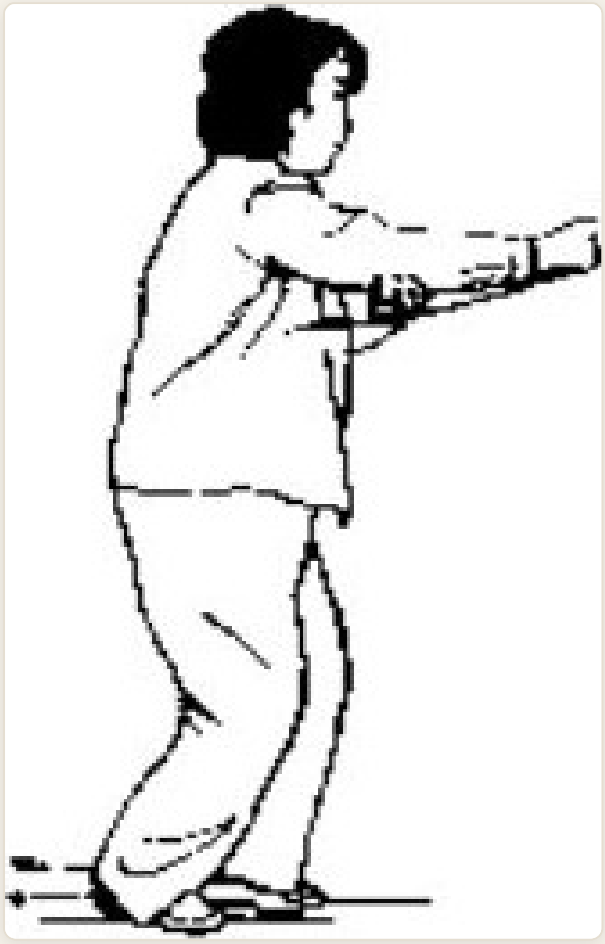
Twelfth Posture: Advance the Step, Deflect, Bar and Punch (进步搬拦捶, Jìn Bù Bān Lán Chuí)

- ① Following on from the previous posture, the left hand rotates inward and brushes downward and to the left to in front of the ribs, palm facing down; the right hand rotates outward and upward, extends forward past beneath the left hand, palm facing up; at the same time the left foot steps forward, the tip of the foot turned slightly outward. (图 23)
- ② The right hand rotates inward and brushes back to in front of the right ribs, palm facing down, while the left hand rotates outward and extends forward, palm facing up; at the same time the right foot steps forward, the tip of the foot turned slightly outward as it comes to the ground. (图 24)

图 24

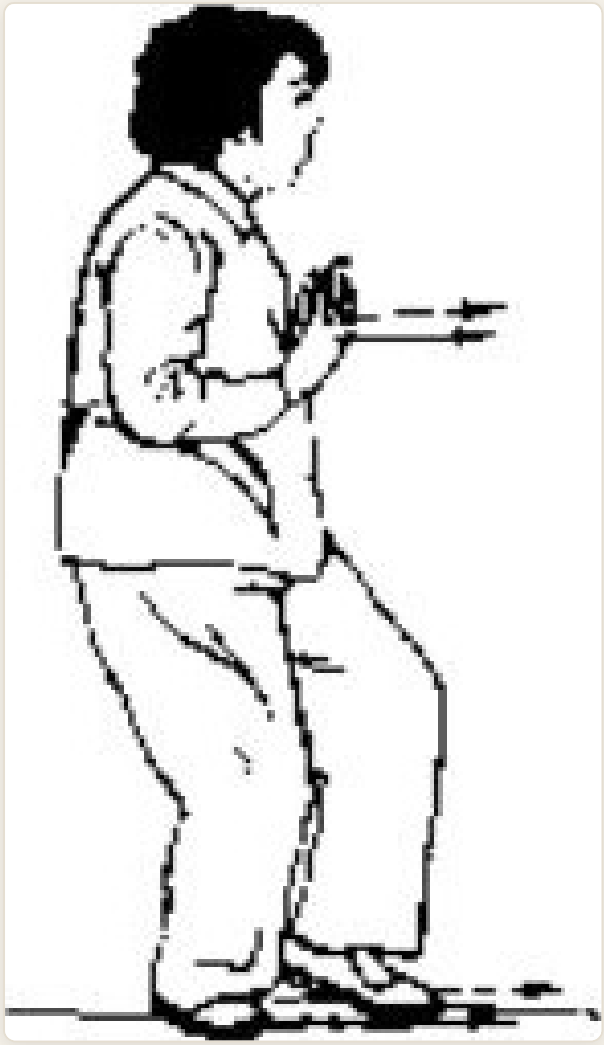
practitioner with the right leg stepped forward and bent, the right arm drawn back toward the right ribs and the left arm extended forward, palm turned upward.

图 25



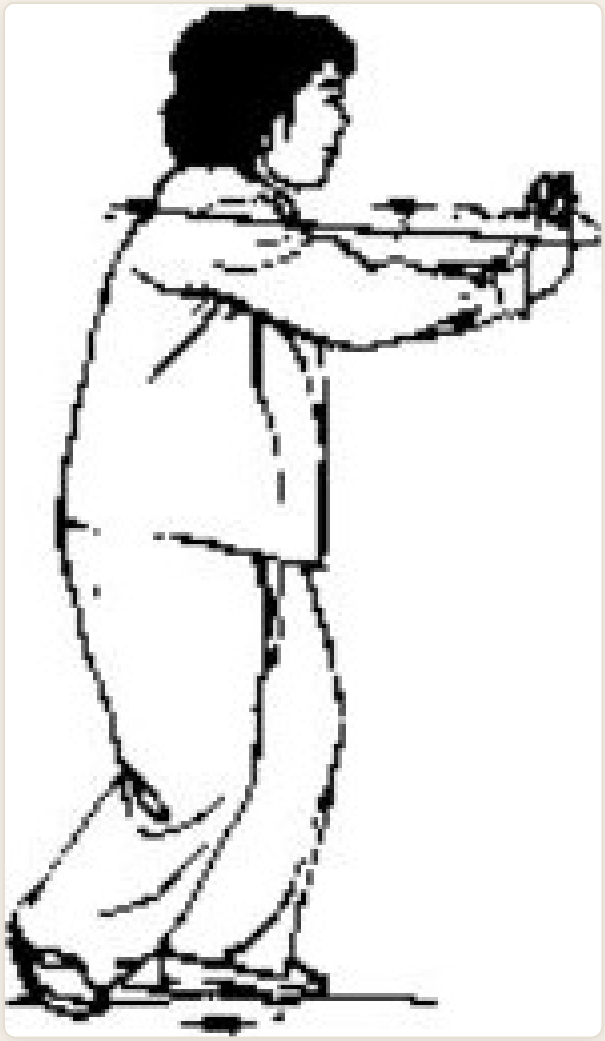
practitioner with the left leg forward and the right foot following behind, the right fist thrust straight forward at chest height and the left fist drawn back at the waist.

图 26



practitioner with the right leg forward and the left foot following, the right fist thrust forward at chest height and the left fist at the waist.

图 27



practitioner standing with both hands drawn back in front of the chest, palms facing forward, feet together; the body upright.

Fourteenth Posture: Embrace the Tiger and Push the Mountain (抱虎推山, Bào Hǔ Tuī Shān)

Following on from the previous posture, the two hands push forward together, level with the chest, the two arms slightly bent; at the same time the left foot steps forward and the right foot follows, about 10 cm from the left foot; the eyes look between the two hands; pause briefly. (图 28)

图 28

practitioner in a forward stance with both arms extended forward at chest height, palms facing forward.

图 29

practitioner standing with feet together, both arms opened out from the body at chest height, palms turned forward.

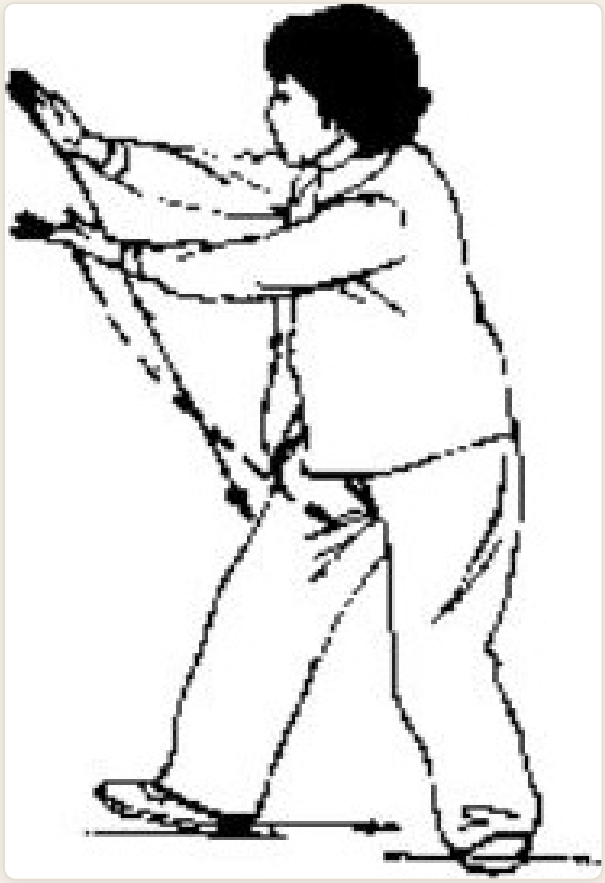
图 32

practitioner in a side-facing stance with the right leg forward, the right arm extended forward and the left hand held low.

图 30

practitioner standing with feet together, both arms extended forward in front of the chest, palms facing inward toward each other.

图 33



practitioner in a forward stance with the left hand raised at chest height and the right hand lowered, the body turned slightly.

图 31

practitioner standing with the left leg forward and the arms held in front of the chest, the body turned to one side.

图 34

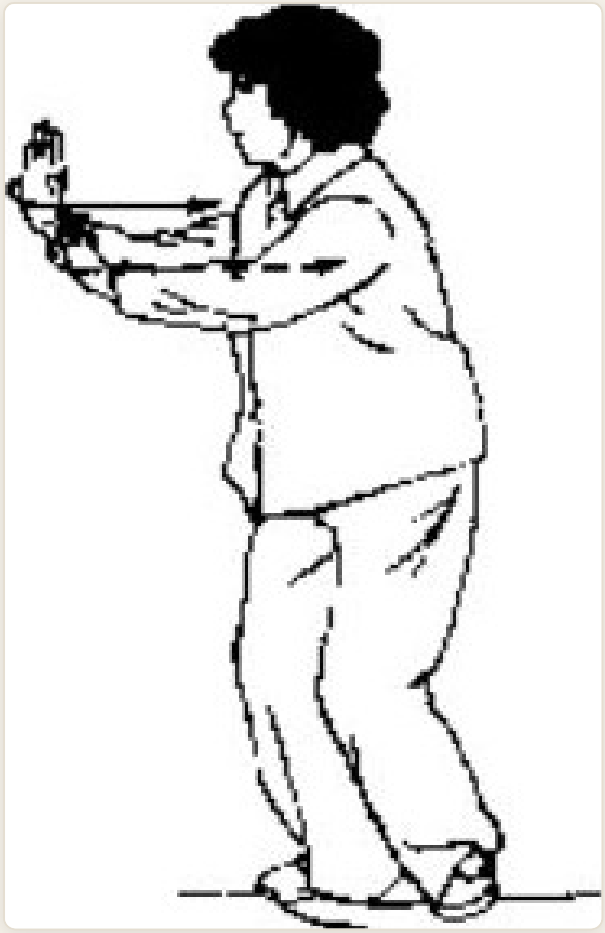
practitioner in a stance with the right leg forward and the body turned, the left hand raised in front of the chest and the right hand extended forward and downward.

The hands push out forward together from above the wrist, the right palm facing upward and the left palm facing downward; at the same time the right foot steps forward, the left foot following up to the side of the right ankle with the toe touching the ground. (图 35)

图 35

practitioner in a forward stance, both hands held up in front of the chest, the left hand above and the right below, palms facing each other.

图 36



practitioner with the left leg withdrawn behind, both hands drawn back at the right shoulder, palms turned outward.

图 37

practitioner in a forward stance, both hands pushed out forward in front of the chest, the right foot forward and the left foot following behind.

Nineteenth Posture: Opening the Hands (开手, Kāi Shǒu)

The movement is the same as the Third Posture, "Opening the Hands". (图 38)

图 38

practitioner standing with feet together and body upright, both arms opened out to the sides at chest height, palms turned forward.

图 39

practitioner standing with feet together, both arms extended forward in front of the chest, palms facing inward toward each other.

图 40

practitioner in a wider stance with the arms opened out low to the sides, both palms turned outward.

图 41

practitioner in a forward stance, the right arm extended forward at chest height and the left hand held at the chest.

图 44

practitioner seen from behind in a stance, one arm raised at shoulder height and the other held forward.

图 42

practitioner in a stance with the left arm held forward and the right fist brought under the left elbow.

图 45

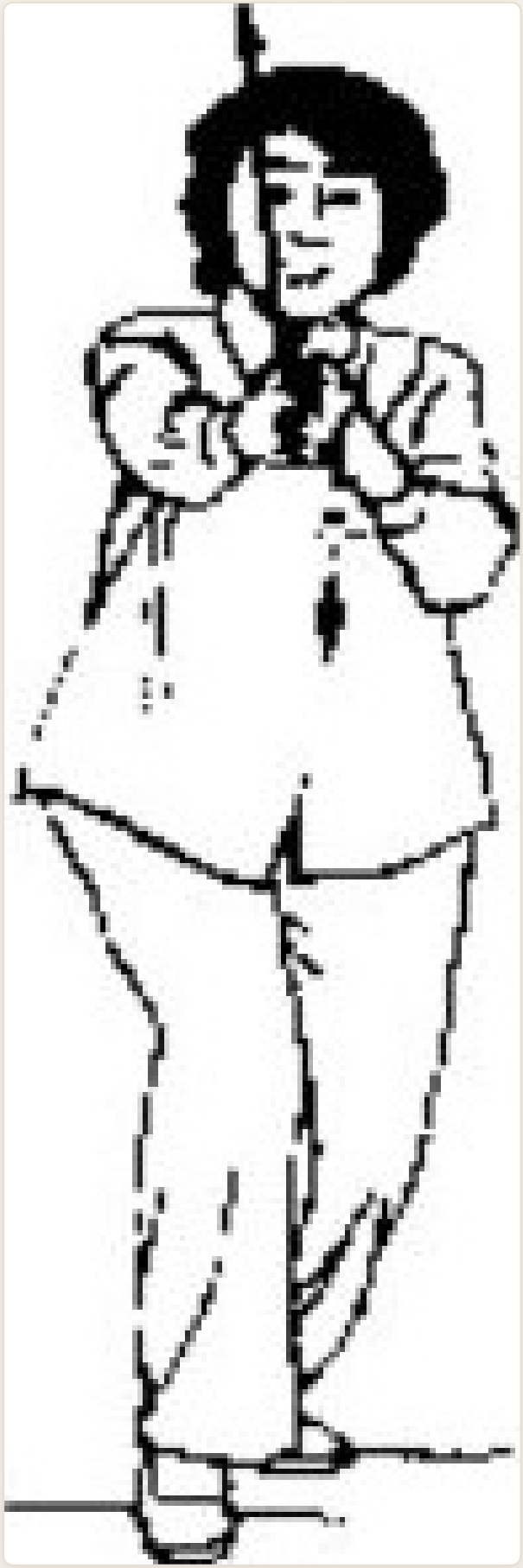
practitioner with the body turned, both arms held in front of the chest, feet apart.

Application (用法): one strikes some part of the opponent with the left hand; the opponent uses ward-off (掤, péng). At this moment one relaxes the shoulders and drops the elbows, wrapping strength is turned inward through the arm, and at the same time one advances the step and strikes the opponent's chest with the right fist from below the left elbow.

图 43

practitioner standing upright, the left hand raised in front of the chest and the right fist held low at the left elbow.

图 46



practitioner standing with feet together, both hands held in front of the chest, one above the other.

图 47

practitioner standing with the left hand held low at the left hip and the right arm raised forward at shoulder height.

图 48

practitioner with the right hand held low at the right hip and the left arm raised forward at shoulder height.

- ② The left hand then pushes out forward to the right, passing in front of the corner of the mouth; all other movements are the same as in the left form, only the direction is reversed. (图 46)

Key points (要点): practice the left and right forms in alternation; the number of repetitions is not fixed, but must be an even number.

Twenty-Fifth Posture: Hands Play the Lute, Right Form (手挥琵琶, Shǒu Huī Pí Pá — 右式)

图 49

practitioner standing with feet together, both arms curved in front of the chest at shoulder height, palms facing inward.

图 50

practitioner standing with feet together and body upright, both arms curved in front of the chest at shoulder height, palms facing inward.

图 51

practitioner standing with feet together, the arms curved in front of the chest, palms turned inward, the body leaning slightly forward.

图 52

practitioner in a side-facing stance with the left leg forward and both arms extended forward at chest height.

图 53

practitioner in a forward stance, the left hand at the left knee and the right arm extended forward at chest height.

图 56

practitioner bending deeply forward with both arms reaching down toward the ground.

图 54

practitioner in a stance with the body turned, one arm drawn low across the body and the other extended forward.

图 57

practitioner in a forward stance with the right arm raised in front of the forehead and the left arm extended forward and downward.

图 55

practitioner in a stance with the left arm raised overhead and the body turned.

图 58

practitioner in a wide stance with the right arm extended forward at shoulder height and the left hand raised in front of the forehead.

- ⑤ The two hands, held as loose fists, sweep downward in an arc to in front of the abdomen; at the same time the left foot withdraws to in front of the right foot, the toe touch-

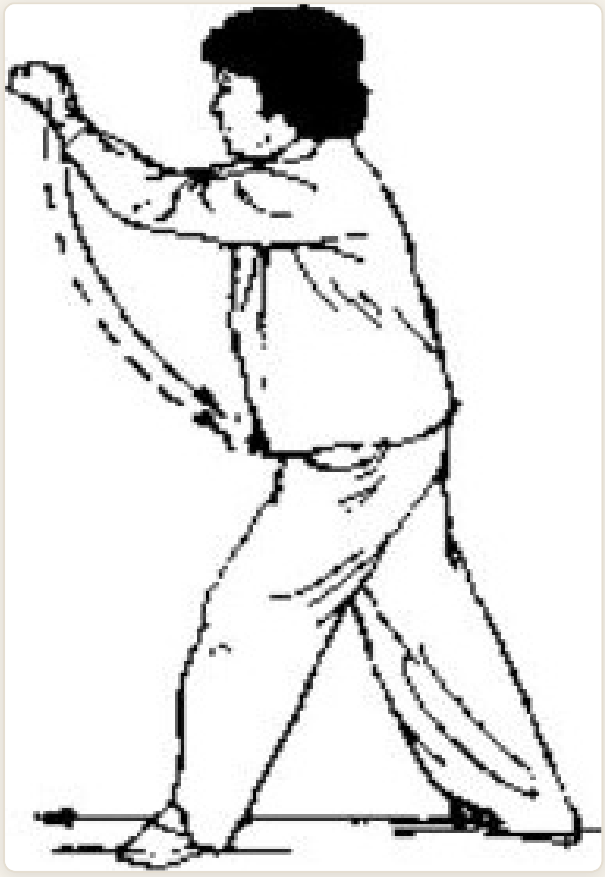
...to the ground; the eyes look straight ahead. (Fig. 60)

- ⑧ Both fists, kept close to the body, are raised to the front of the chest and then extended forward and upward, to the height of the eyebrows; at the same time the left foot steps forward and the ball of the foot lands with the toes turned outward, the weight of the body still on the right leg, with a brief pause. Immediately the fists travel in an arc downward to the front of the abdomen; the right foot steps straight forward past the left foot and the ball of the foot lands; the eyes look straight ahead. (Figs. 61, 62)

图 59

practitioner in a bow stance, left leg forward and right leg back, right arm extended forward at shoulder height with the left hand held near the chest.

图 60

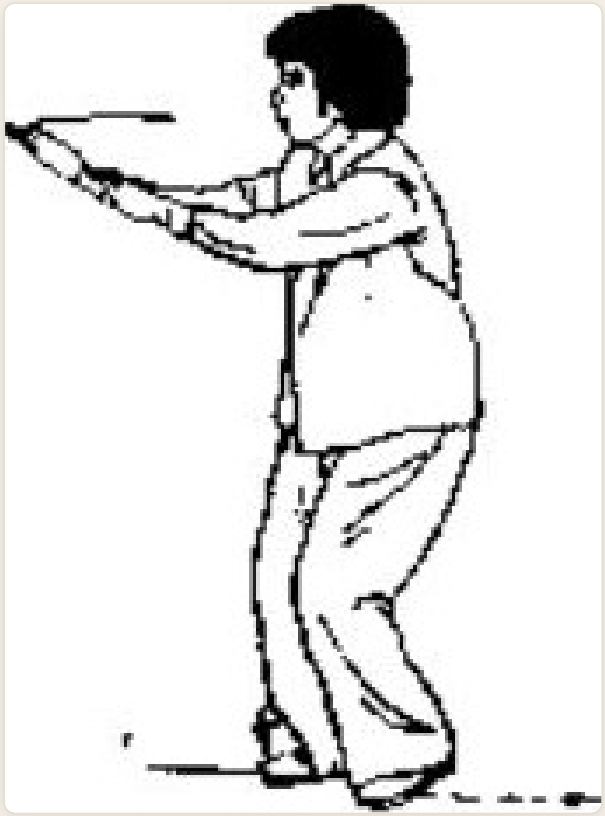


practitioner standing with weight on the rear leg, torso turned, both hands held open in front of the chest at about shoulder height.

图 61

practitioner in a bow stance with both forearms raised in front of the chest and the left foot forward.

图 62

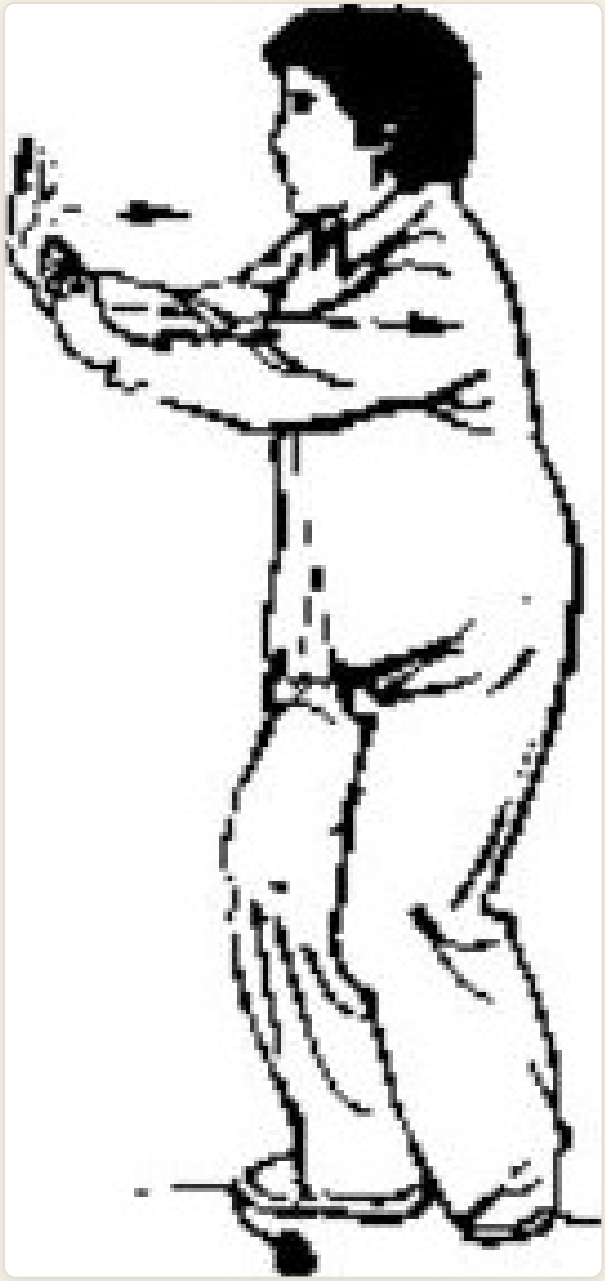


practitioner in a bow stance with both arms extended forward, the body leaning slightly forward.

图 63

practitioner in a bow stance with the arms curved in front of the chest, palms turned outward.

图 64



practitioner in a forward stance with the arms held level at shoulder height, the hands formed into fists.

图 65

practitioner standing with the arms held in front of the chest and the hands together, the front foot turned out.

图 66

practitioner in a narrow parallel stance, both arms extended forward at shoulder height, palms turned outward.

图 67

practitioner standing with both hands drawn in before the chest, palms facing inward.

图 68

practitioner standing with both arms extended out to the sides at shoulder height, hands open.

图 69

practitioner in a wide stance with the arms drawn in before the body, palms open.

图 70

practitioner in a wide stance with the left arm curved across the body and the right hand near the left armpit.

图 71

practitioner standing with the right hand pressed forward at chest height and the left hand lifted near the chest.

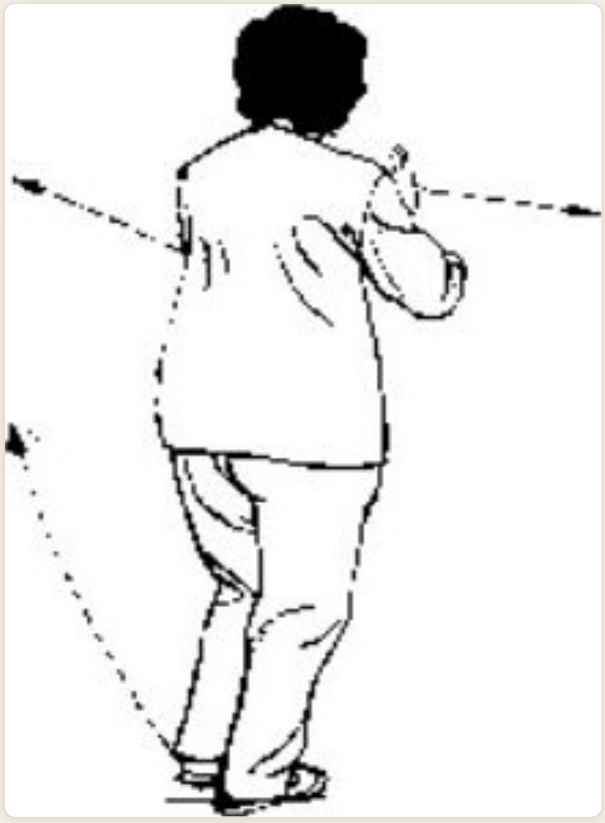
图 72

practitioner standing on one leg, the left knee raised with the foot drawn in, both hands held before the chest.

图 73

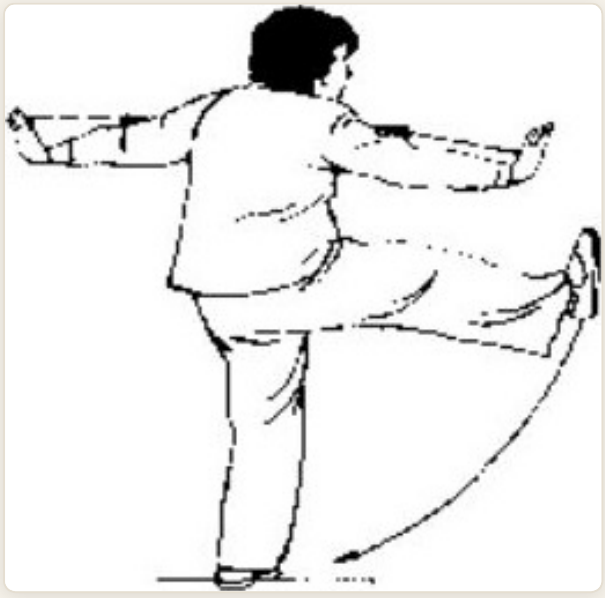
practitioner standing sideways with weight on one leg, both hands held forward in front of the chest.

图 74



practitioner balancing on the left leg with the right leg raised straight forward at hip height, both arms opened out to the sides.

图 75

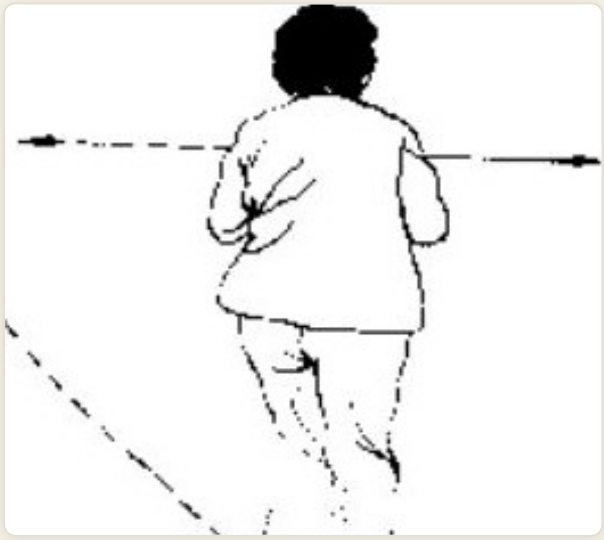


practitioner in a stance with the arms opened out horizontally, palms turned outward.

图 76

practitioner in a bow stance with the arms extended forward at shoulder height, palms open.

图 77

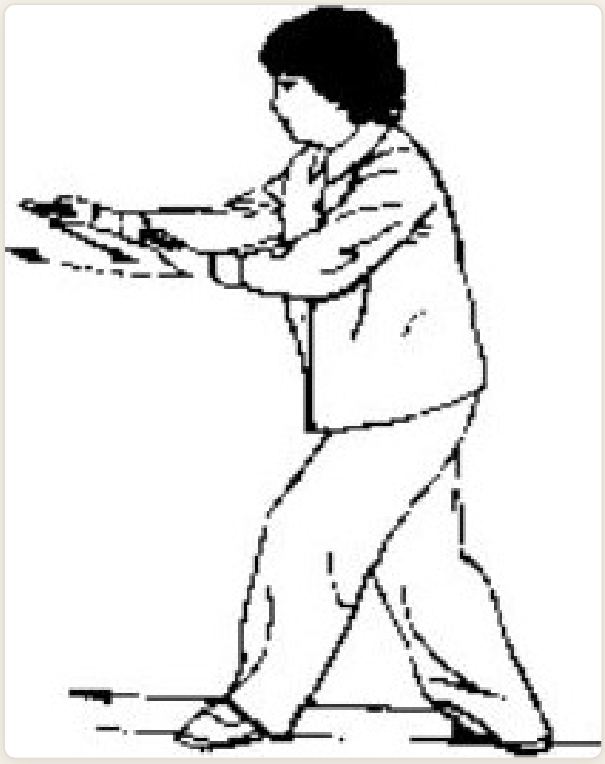


practitioner balancing on the right leg with the left leg raised to the side, both arms opened out to the sides.

图 78

practitioner with the left leg raised in front and both hands held together before the chest.

图 79



practitioner balancing on the right leg with the left leg extended forward at hip height, both arms opened out to the sides.

图 80

practitioner standing with the torso turned, the right arm extended forward at shoulder height and the left hand held back near the left hip.

图 83

practitioner leaning forward with the torso turned away from the camera, the right arm curving downward and across in front of the body.

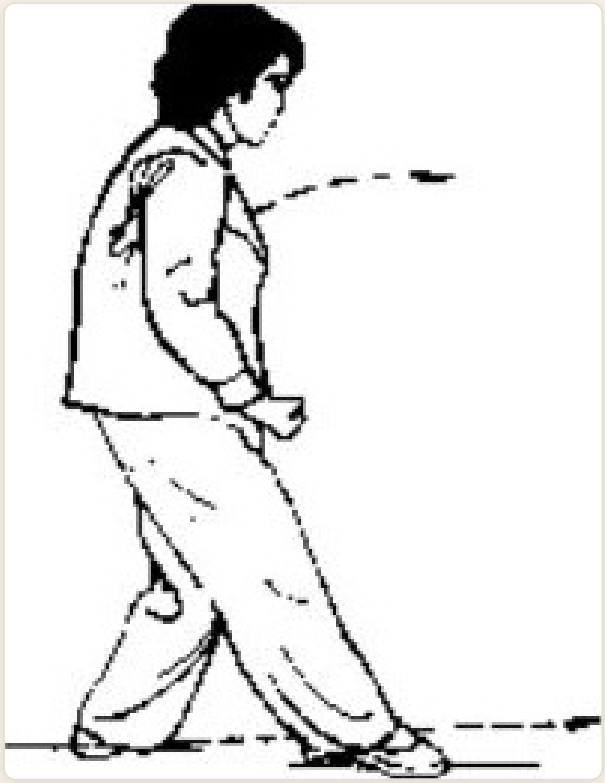
图 81

practitioner standing in a forward stance, both arms extended forward at about chest height.

图 84

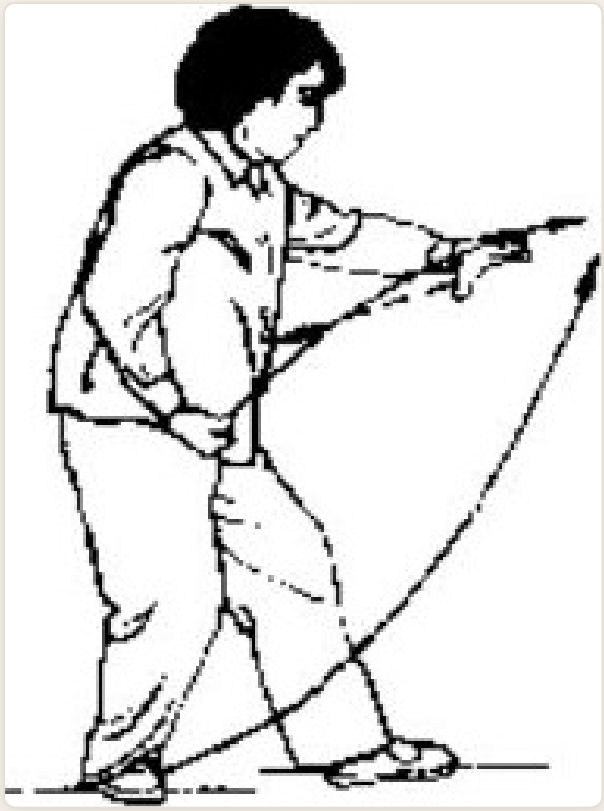
practitioner standing with the body turned, the right arm extended forward and the left hand held open before the chest.

图 82



practitioner standing in a forward stance, the right hand raised to about head height and the left hand held low before the body.

图 85

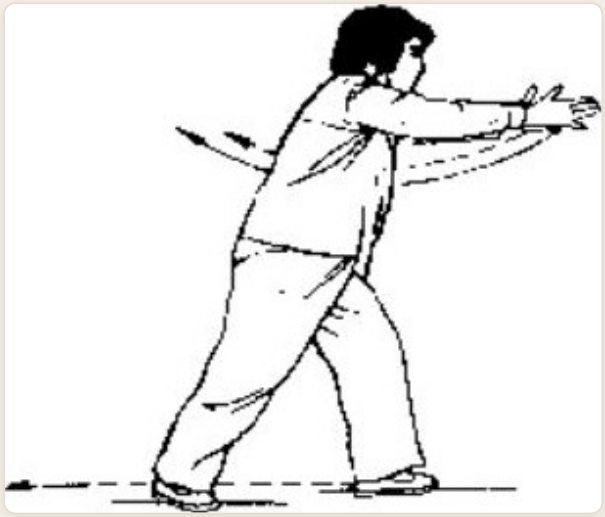


practitioner in a forward stance with the body turned away from the camera, both arms extended forward on the left side.

图 86

practitioner balancing on the left leg with the right leg kicked forward at about hip height and both arms opened out to the sides.

图 89



practitioner standing with the weight on the rear leg and both hands raised to the height of the face.

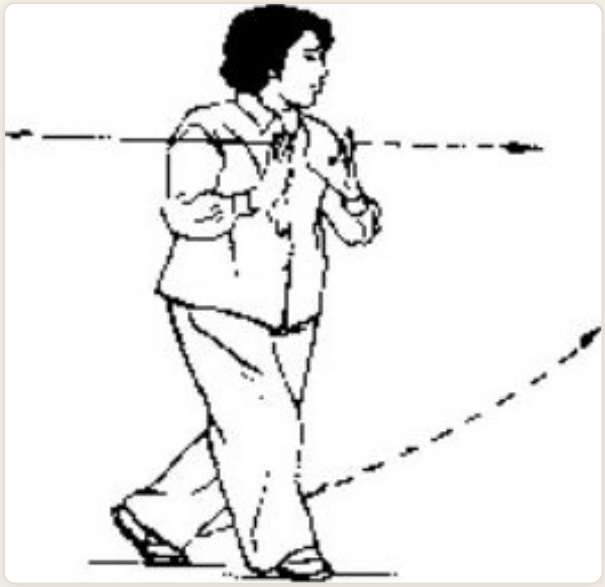
图 87

practitioner balancing on the left leg with the right leg extended forward at about hip height and the right arm extended forward.

图 90

practitioner standing with both hands held before the chest and the weight settled on the rear leg, the front foot resting on its heel.

图 88



practitioner in a bow stance with both arms extended forward at chest height, the body leaning forward.

图 91

practitioner standing with both fists held close in front of the chest.

图 92

practitioner balancing on one leg with the other leg kicked out to the side, both arms extended out to the sides.

图 95

practitioner balancing on one leg with the opposite leg raised in front, both arms extended out to the sides at shoulder height.

图 93

practitioner standing on one leg with the other knee raised in front, both hands held together before the chest.

图 96

practitioner standing in a forward stance with the weight on the rear leg, one arm extended forward and the other held across the chest.

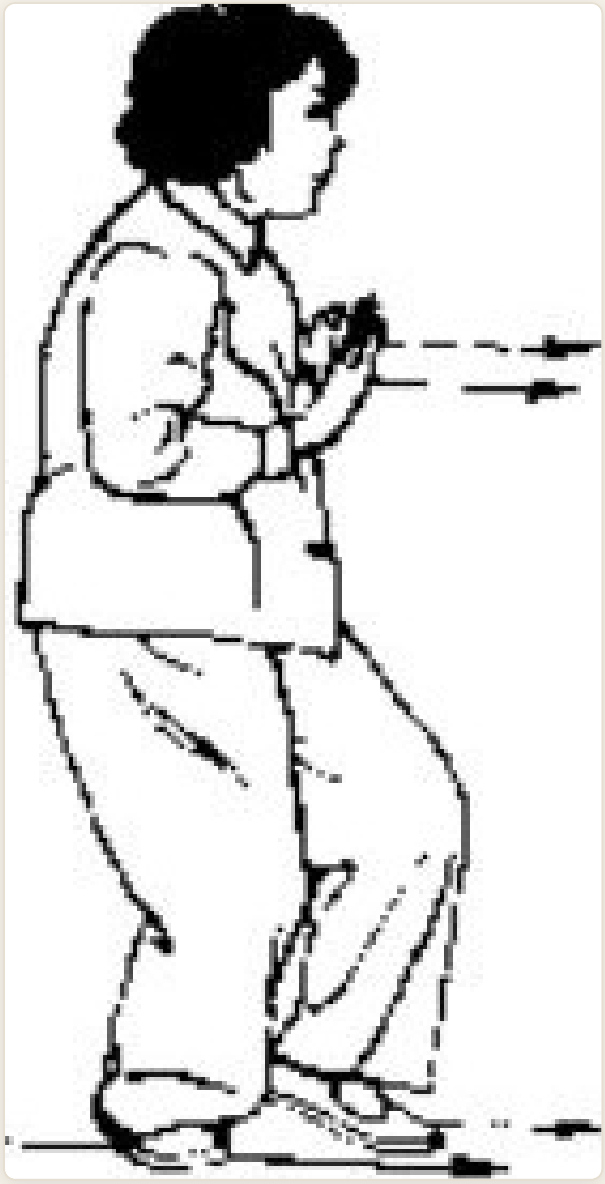
图 94

practitioner in a forward stance seen from behind, the arms extended low at the sides.

图 97

practitioner in a forward stance with one arm extended forward and the other hand held near the chest.

图 98



practitioner standing in a forward stance with both hands raised in front of the chest at about face height.

图 99

practitioner standing with both fists held close in front of the chest and the weight settled on the rear leg.

图 100

practitioner in a forward stance with both arms extended forward at chest height, the body leaning slightly forward.

图 101

practitioner standing with both hands raised in front of the chest at about shoulder height and the feet together.

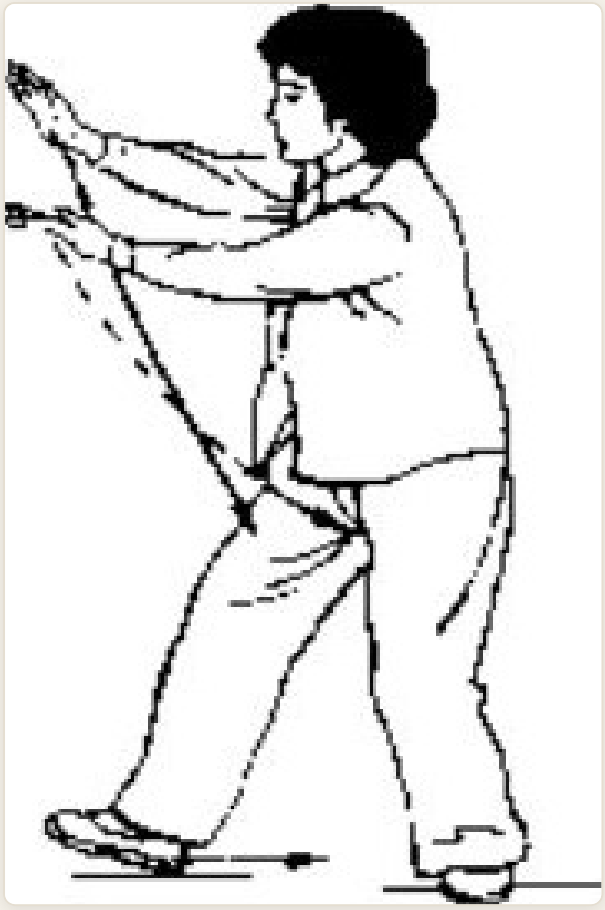
图 104

practitioner standing in a forward stance with both arms extended forward at chest height.

图 107

practitioner standing in a forward stance with both arms extended forward at chest height, seen from the side.

图 102



practitioner standing with both arms curved in front of the chest, the hands clasped together.

图 105

practitioner in a bow stance with both arms extended forward, the body leaning slightly forward.

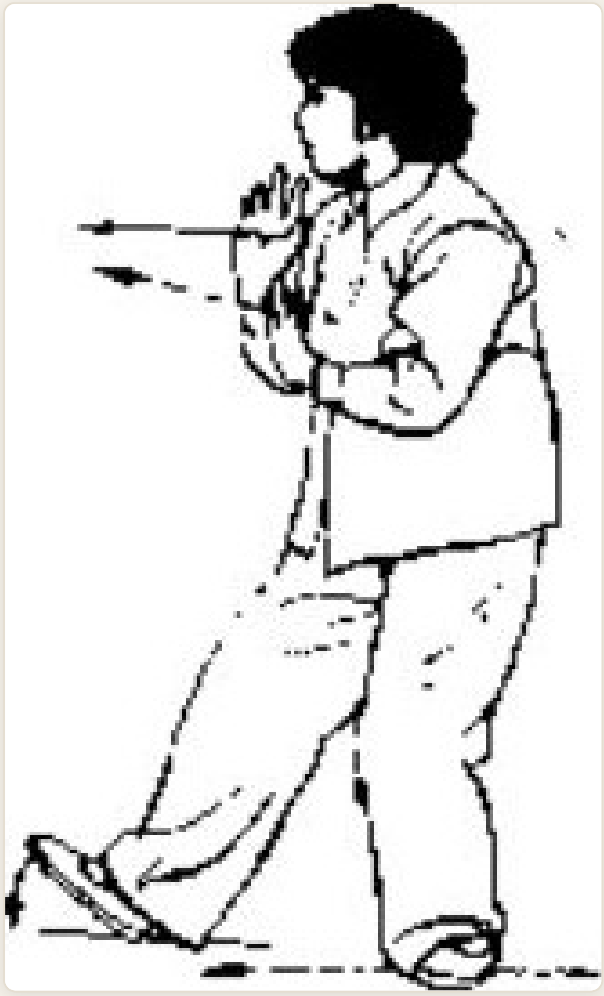
图 108

practitioner in a forward stance with one arm curved in front of the chest and the other arm extended forward on the left side.

图 103

practitioner standing with the weight on the rear leg, the front foot resting on its heel, both hands held close before the chest.

图 106



practitioner in a forward stance with the arms held low in front of the body.

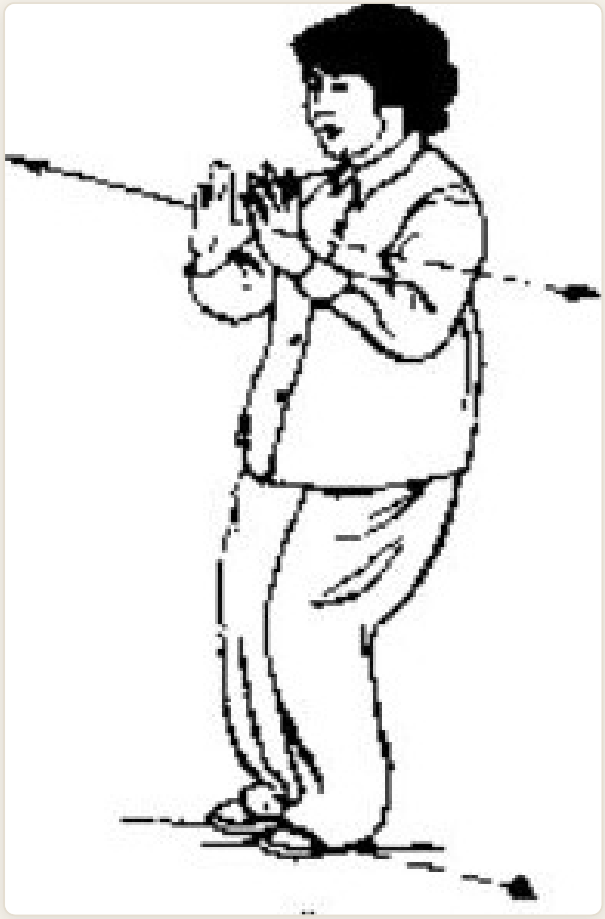
图 109

practitioner in a forward stance with one arm extended forward and the other hand held near the chest.

图 110

practitioner standing in a forward stance, the left hand extended forward at chest height and the right hand raised near the right temple.

图 113



practitioner standing in a forward stance, the left arm extended forward at shoulder height and the right hand held before the chest.

图 111

practitioner standing with both arms curved in front of the chest, the hands held together at about face height.

图 114

practitioner in a wide stance, the arms extended out to the left side at shoulder height, the body turned to the left.

图 112

practitioner in a forward stance, both arms extended forward, the right hand above the left.

图 115

practitioner standing in a forward stance with the left arm extended forward at chest height and the right hand held at the right hip.

"opening the hands", except that the direction is 45° to the right.

Fifty-Fourth Posture: Closing the Hands (合手, Hé Shǒu)

The movement is the same as that of the fourth posture, "closing the hands", except that the direction is 45° to the right. (Fig. 112)

Fifty-Fifth Posture: Diagonal Single Whip (斜单鞭, Xié Dān Biān)

Following the preceding posture, the left foot steps out to the left front, and the two hands separate level. (Fig. 113)

Fifty-Sixth Posture: Parting the Wild Horse's Mane (野马分鬃, Yě Mǎ Fēn Zōng)

- ① Following the preceding posture, the left foot draws in beside the right foot, the whole sole on the ground; at the same time the left hand sweeps downward in an arc to the front of the

abdomen; the eyes look at the right hand. (Fig. 114)

- ② The left hand goes upward past the chest and then sweeps in an arc to the left to the left side of the body; at the same time the left foot steps out to the left, the tip of the foot turned slightly outward; the eyes look at the left hand. (Fig. 115)
- ③ The right hand sweeps downward in an arc to the front of the abdomen, then upward past the face and in an arc to the right to the right side of the body; at the same time the right foot draws in beside the left foot (the tip of the foot touching the ground, the two feet about 10 cm apart), and then steps out one pace to the right; at this point the single-whip posture is resumed, but the weight is biased toward the right leg. (Figs. 116, 117)
- ④ The left foot steps forward in front of the right foot, the tip of the foot turned outward and set down diagonally, the two legs bent; at the same time the two hands go downward and cross in front (the palms turned slightly outward, the left hand above, the right hand below, the two arms slightly curved), and immediately separate to left and right, each drawing a circle to the front of the chest, the right palm facing upward, the left palm facing downward; the eyes look at the lower front. (Figs. 118, 119)

Fifty-Seventh Posture: Lazily Tucking in the Robe (懒扎衣, Lǎn Zhā Yī)

- ① Following the preceding posture, the right foot steps forward; the left foot then follows up behind the right foot, the tip of the foot touching the ground, pausing briefly and then withdrawing; at the same time the weight of the body shifts to the left leg, the tip of the right foot raised; the left hand supports the right wrist and the two push forward together (the right palm facing upward, the left palm facing downward), then wind level to the right and to the rear to the front of the right shoulder, both palms facing outward. (Figs. 120, 121, 122)
- ② The two hands push forward together; the left foot follows up to about 10 cm behind the right foot, the tip of the foot touching the ground; the eyes look at the index finger of the right hand. (Fig. 123)

Fifty-Eighth Posture: Opening the Hands (开手, Kāi Shǒu)

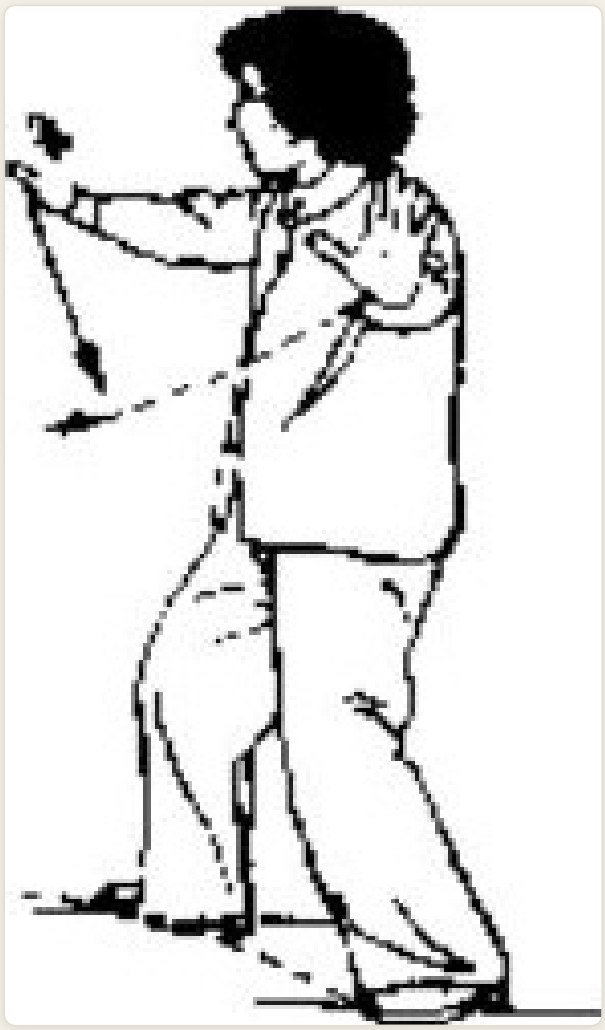
The movement is the same as that of the third posture, "opening the hands". (Fig. 124)

Fifty-Ninth Posture: Closing the Hands (合手, Hé Shǒu)

The movement is the same as that of the fourth posture, "closing the hands". (Fig. 125)

Sixtieth Posture: Single

图 116



practitioner in a forward stance, the left arm extended forward at shoulder height and the right hand held before the chest.

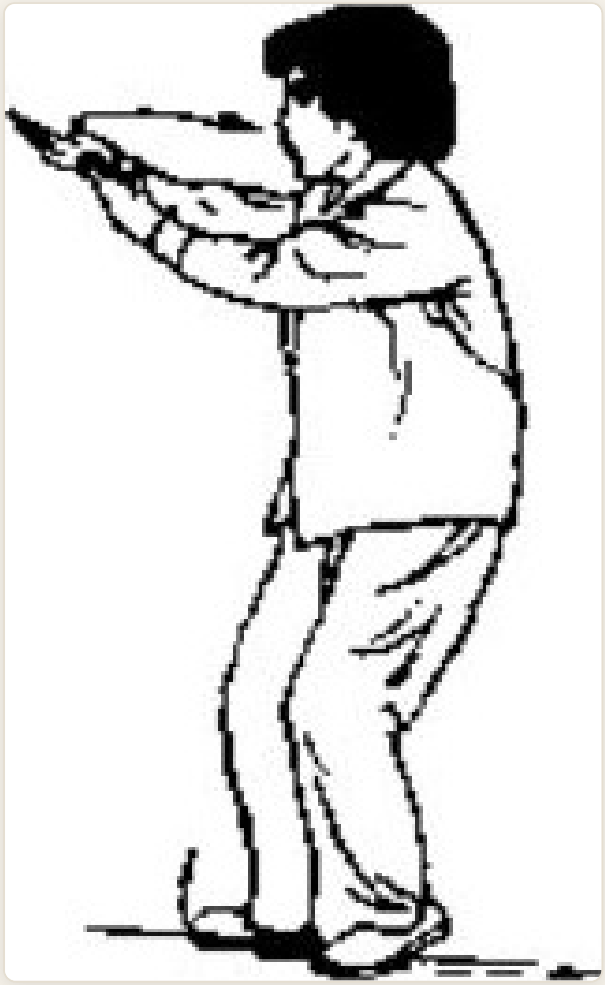
图 119

practitioner in a wide stance, the left hand held low in front of the body and the right hand raised before the chest, the feet wide apart.

图 122

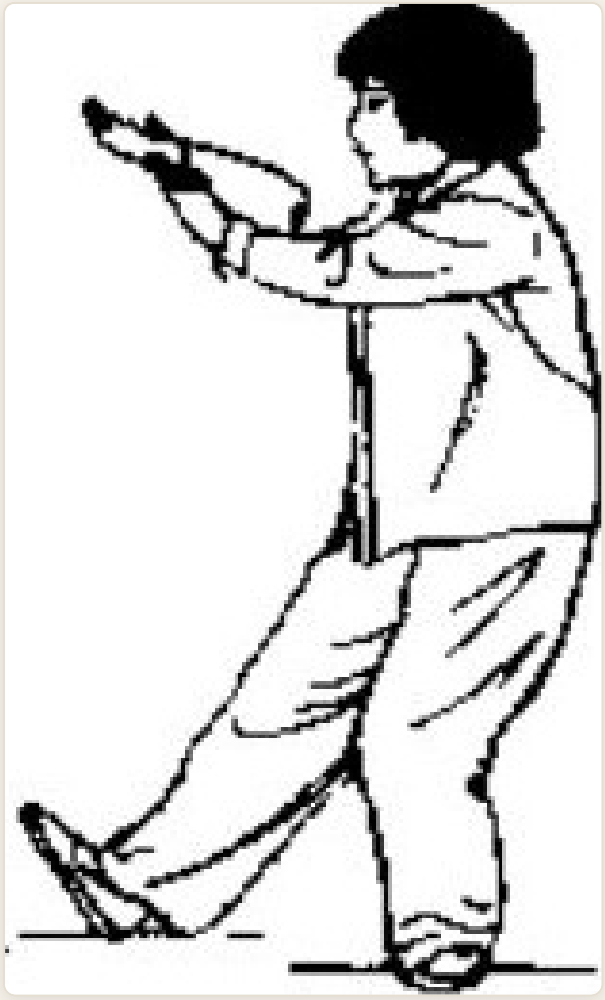
practitioner standing with the weight on the rear leg, both hands held before the right shoulder at shoulder height.

图 117



practitioner in a forward stance, the left hand extended forward and the right hand drawn back near the right side of the body.

图 120

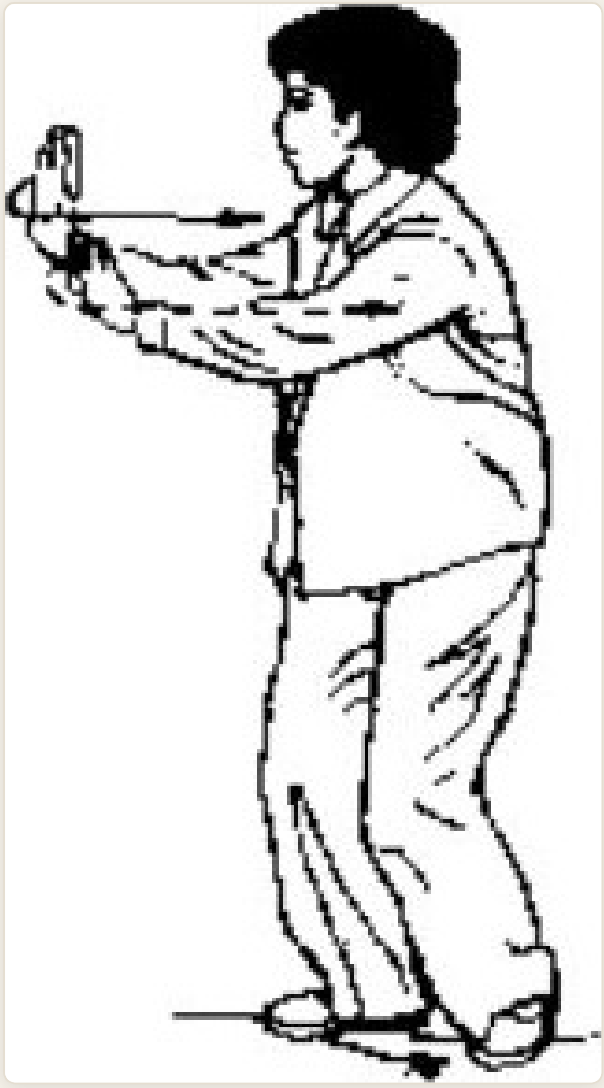


practitioner in a forward stance, both arms curved and held forward in front of the chest.

图 123

practitioner standing with the weight on the rear leg and both arms extended forward at shoulder height.

图 118

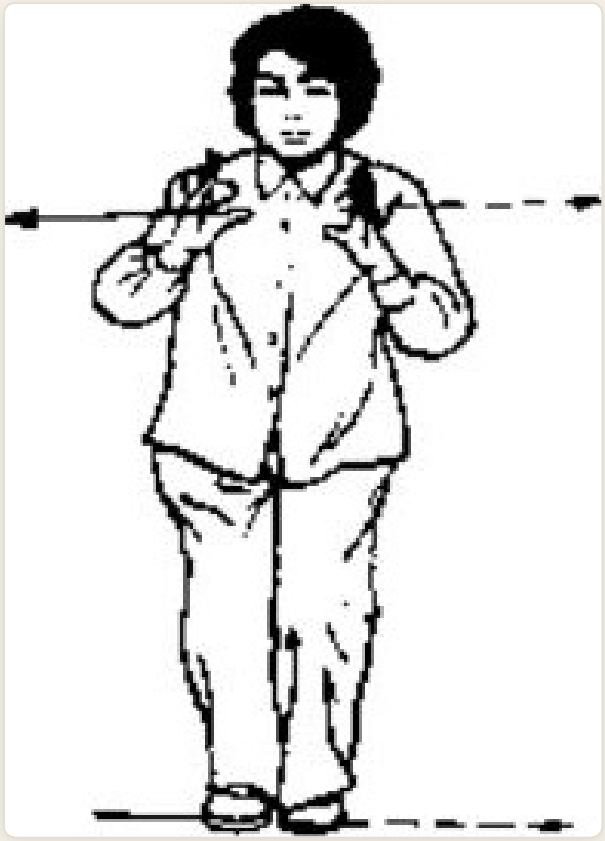


practitioner in a wide stance, both hands held low in front of the body, the body turned to the left.

图 121

practitioner in a wide forward stance with one arm extended forward and the other hand held at the chest.

图 124



practitioner standing with both arms curved in front of the chest, the hands held at about face height, the feet together.

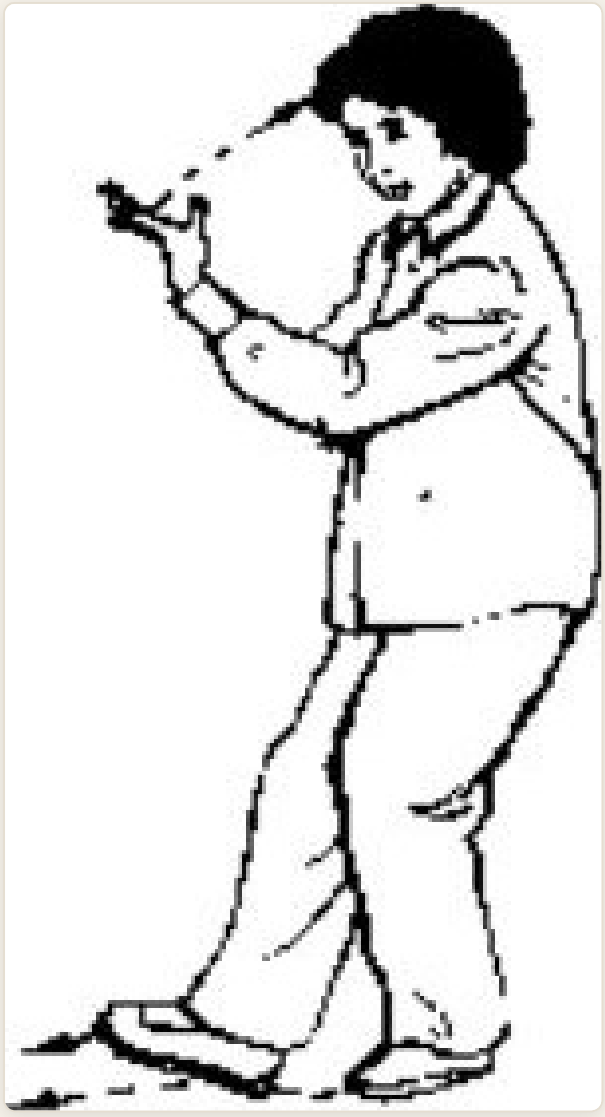
图 127

practitioner standing with the left hand raised above the forehead and the right arm extended forward at shoulder height, the body turned to the right.

图 125

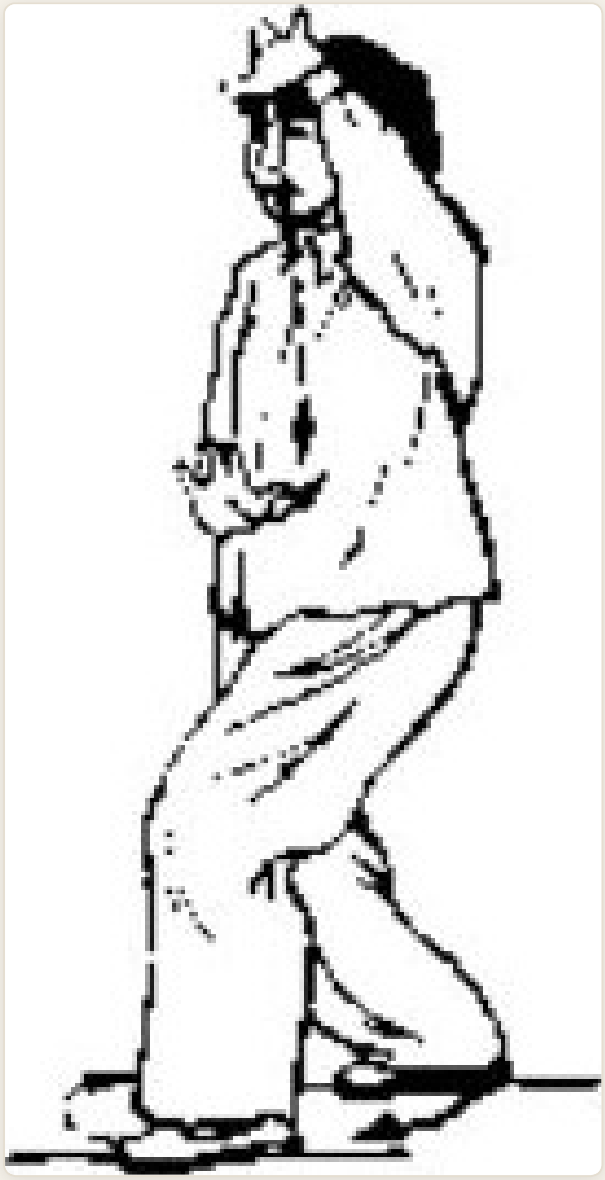
practitioner standing with both arms curved in front of the chest, the forearms held level, the feet together.

图 128



practitioner in a forward stance, the left hand held before the chest and the right hand extended forward low, the knees bent.

图 126



practitioner in a wide stance, both arms extended out to the sides at shoulder height, the body facing forward.

图 129

practitioner in a forward stance, one arm extended forward at shoulder height and the other hand held at the chest.

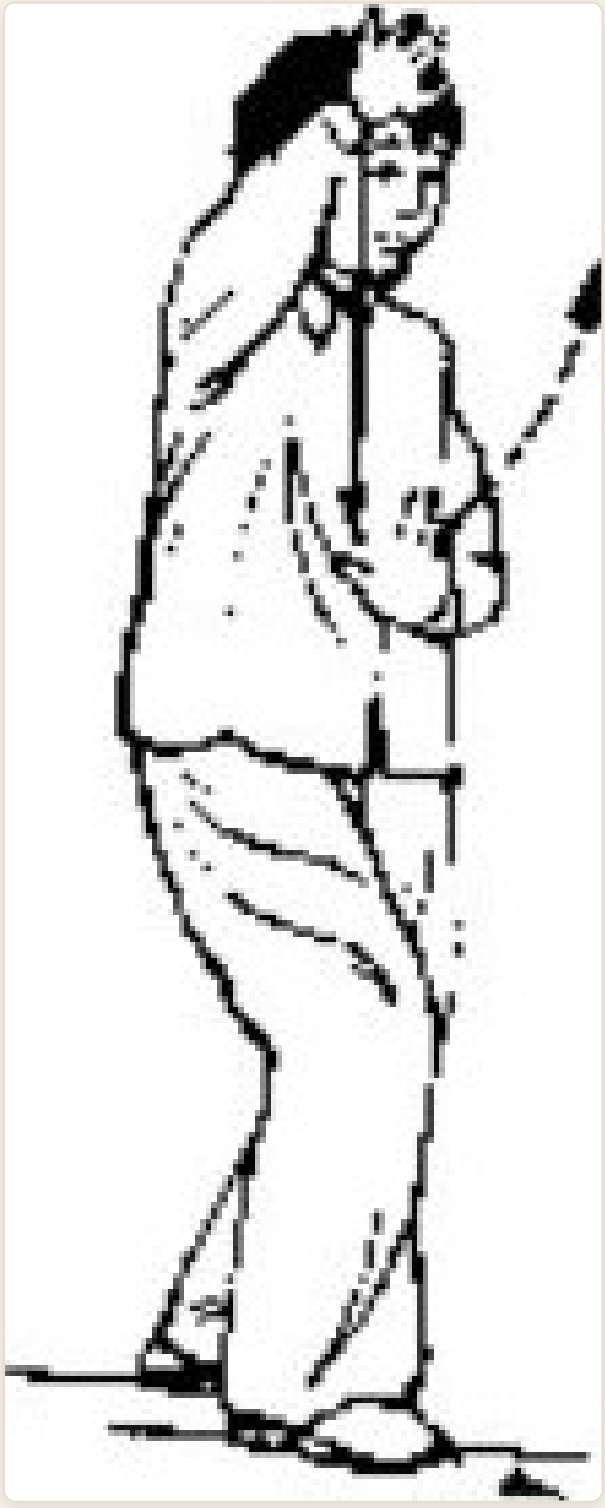
upward until the back of the hand rests against the forehead; the left foot steps out to the left front (facing southwest), and the right foot follows up to about 10 cm behind the left foot; at the same time the right hand is placed before the chest and gently pushes forward (the elbow close to the body). (Fig. 129)

- ③ The left foot turns inward, the body turns about 180° to the right; the left hand goes down to the front of the chest, the palm facing downward; the right hand rotates inward and slightly upward, the palm facing upward (the two elbows close to the body). (Fig. 130)
- ④ The right hand rotates inward and goes upward until the back of the hand rests against the forehead; at the same time the right foot steps out to the right front (facing southeast); the left

foot follows up to about 10 cm behind the right foot; the left hand gently pushes forward from the front of the chest (the two elbows still close to the body). (Fig. 131)

- ⑤ The right foot steps slightly forward, the tip of the foot turned slightly inward; at the same time the right hand drops to the front of the chest, the palm facing downward; the left hand rotates outward and goes upward, the palm facing upward, the two elbows close to the body, the posture the same as in ① but in the opposite direction. (Fig. 132)
- ⑥ The left foot steps out to the left front (facing northeast); the left hand rotates inward and goes down to the front of the forehead, the palm facing forward; the right foot follows up, the posture the same as in section ② but in the opposite direction. (Fig. 133)
- ⑦ The body turns to the right, the course of the hand and foot movements all the same as in section ③, but in the opposite direction. (Fig. 134)
- ⑧ The right foot withdraws a step to the right, the left foot follows up to the inner side of the right foot, the body turns 90° to the right; at the same time the left hand pushes forward

图 130

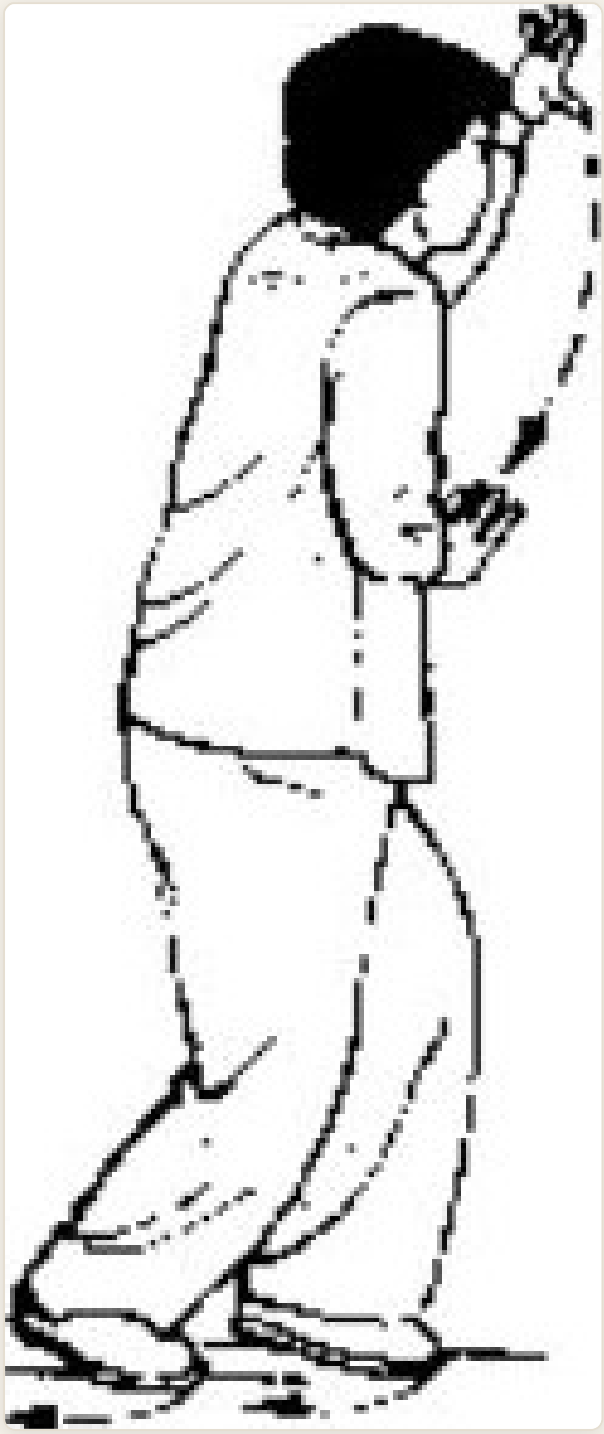


practitioner standing in a wide stance, one hand held before the chest and the other hand extended forward at shoulder height, the body turned.

图 131

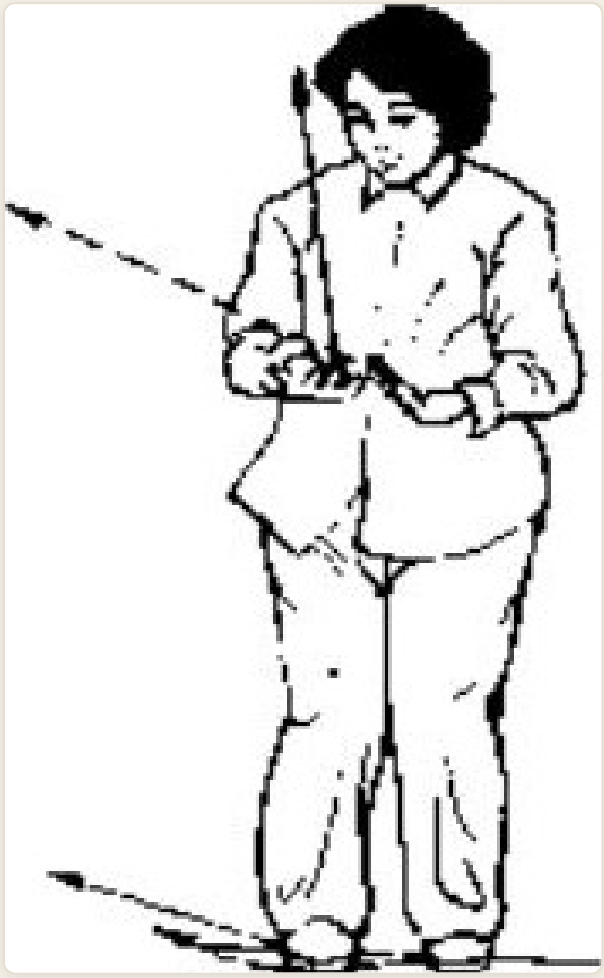
practitioner in a forward stance with one arm extended forward at shoulder height and the other hand held before the chest, the body turned to the side.

图 132



practitioner in a forward stance, one hand raised above the forehead and the other arm extended forward at shoulder height, the body turned to the left.

图 133

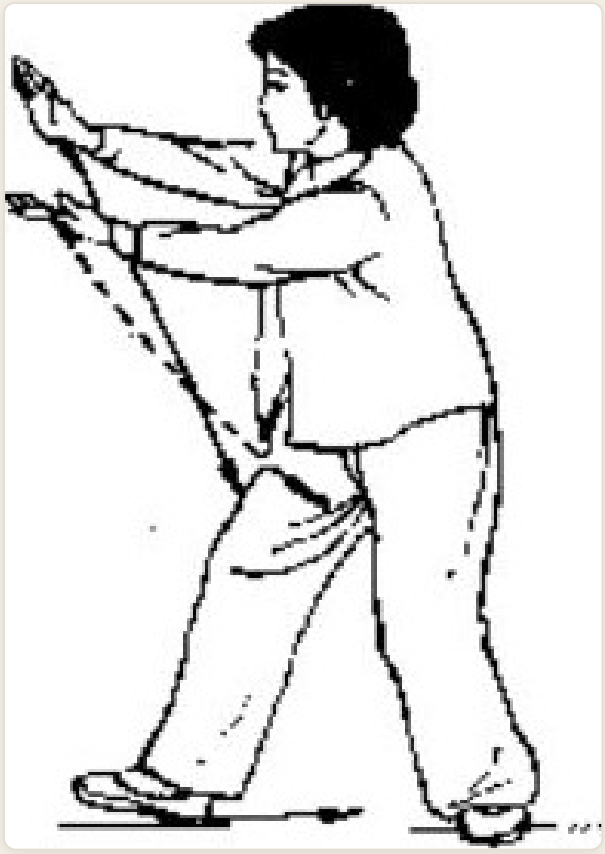


practitioner standing in a narrow stance, the body turned to the side, one hand raised to about face height in front and the other hand held lower before the chest.

图 136

practitioner in a low, wide forward stance, the body leaning forward, both arms extended forward and downward with the hands held low in front.

图 139

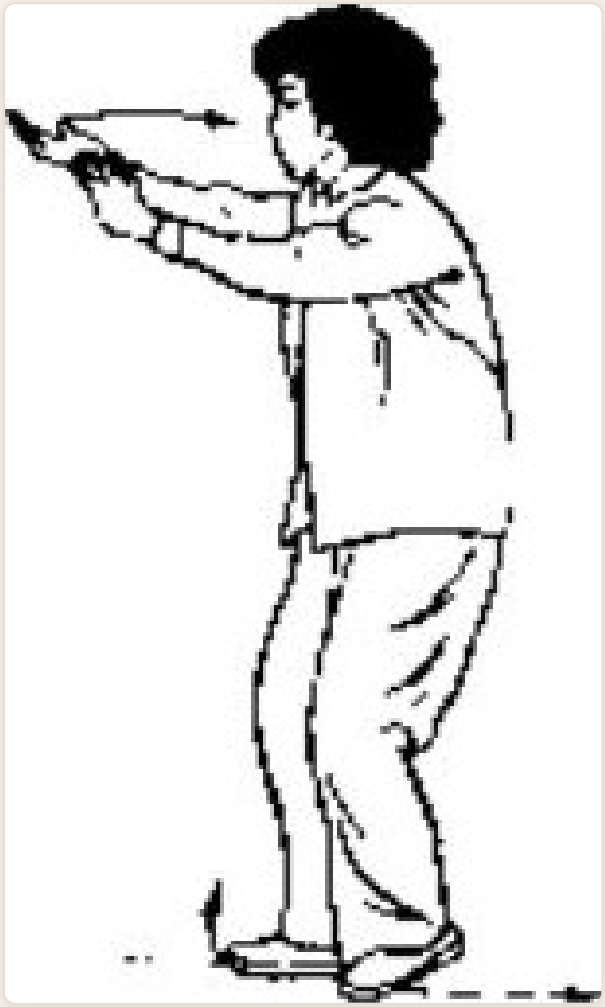


practitioner in a forward stance, one arm extended forward at shoulder height and the other hand held before the chest, the body turned.

图 134

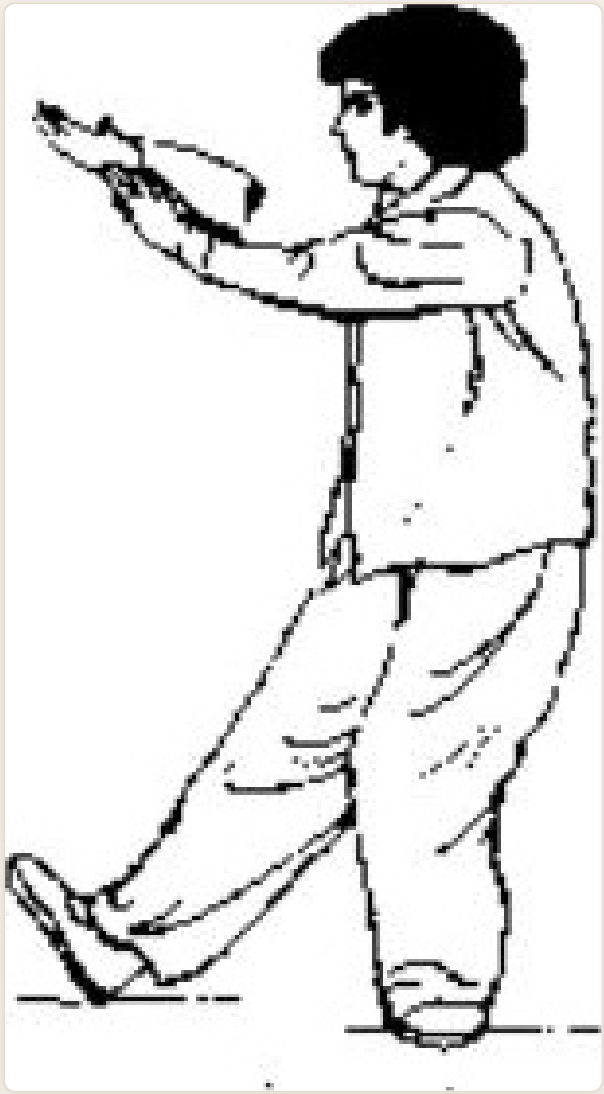
practitioner standing upright with the feet close together, both forearms crossed in front of the chest.

图 137



practitioner in a forward stance, both arms extended forward and downward, the palms turned down, the body leaning forward.

图 140



practitioner in a forward stance, one arm extended forward and the other hand held before the chest, the body turned.

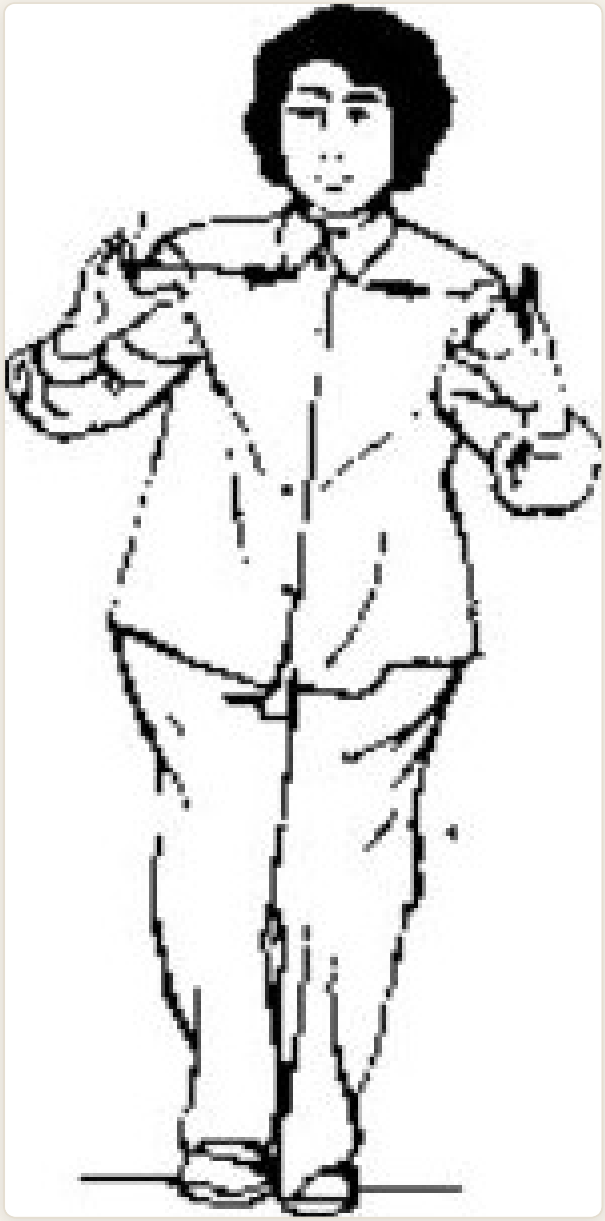
图 135

practitioner in a stance with both arms extended forward at chest height, the palms facing forward.

图 138

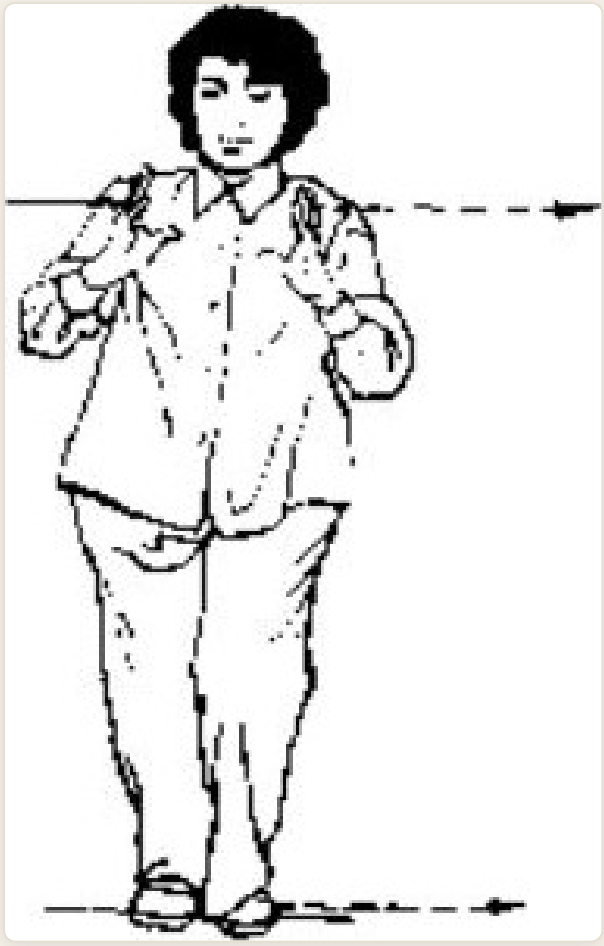
practitioner in a wide stance with both arms extended forward at chest height.

图 141



practitioner standing upright with the feet close together, both hands held together in front of the chest, the elbows bent.

图 142



practitioner standing upright with the feet close together, both hands raised before the chest at shoulder height, the palms facing each other, the elbows held out.

图 145

practitioner standing, one arm extended out to the side at shoulder height and the other arm lowered, the body turned.

图 148

practitioner in a forward stance, one arm extended forward at shoulder height and the other arm lowered, the body turned.

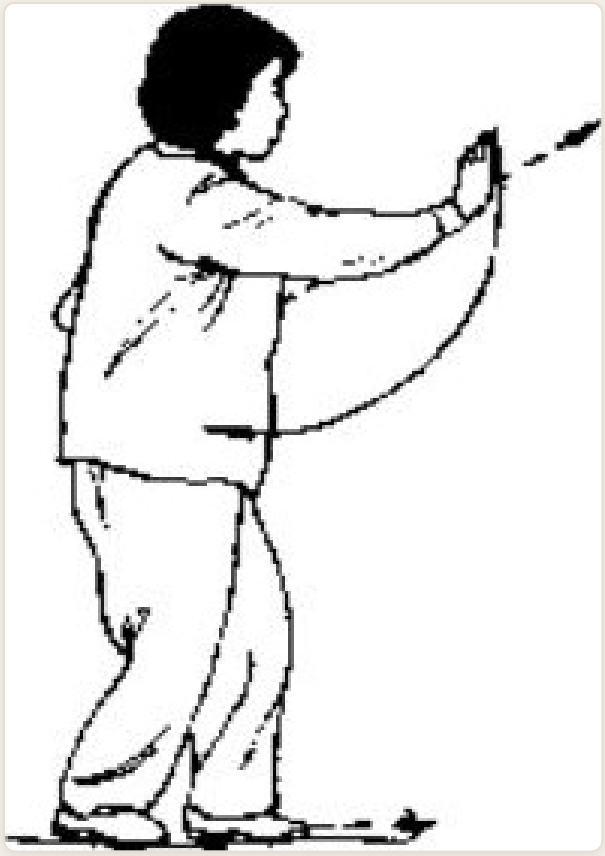
图 143

practitioner standing upright with the feet close together, both arms bent before the chest with the hands held together at chest height.

图 146

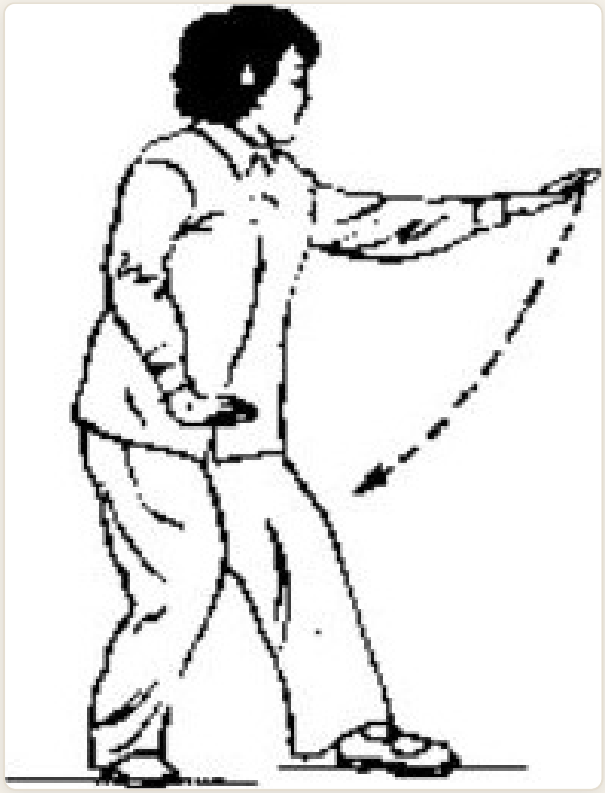
practitioner standing, one arm extended out to the side at shoulder height and the other hand held before the chest, the body turned.

图 149



practitioner in a low forward stance, one arm extended forward and the other hand lowered at the hip, the body turned.

图 144



practitioner in a wide stance with both arms extended out to the sides at shoulder height, the palms turned outward.

图 147

practitioner in a wide stance, both arms extended forward and outward, the body turned.

图 150

practitioner in a low stance, one hand raised beside the head and the other hand lowered in front of the body.

Key point (要点, yào diǎn): the body must be straight, the waist sunk (塌腰, tā yāo), and the right leg still bent.

Seventieth Posture: Step Back and Repulse the Monkey (倒撵猴, Dào Niǎn Hóu)

The movement is the same as in the Twenty-Third Posture, "Step Back and Repulse the Monkey" (倒撵猴). (Fig. 153, 154, 155, 156)

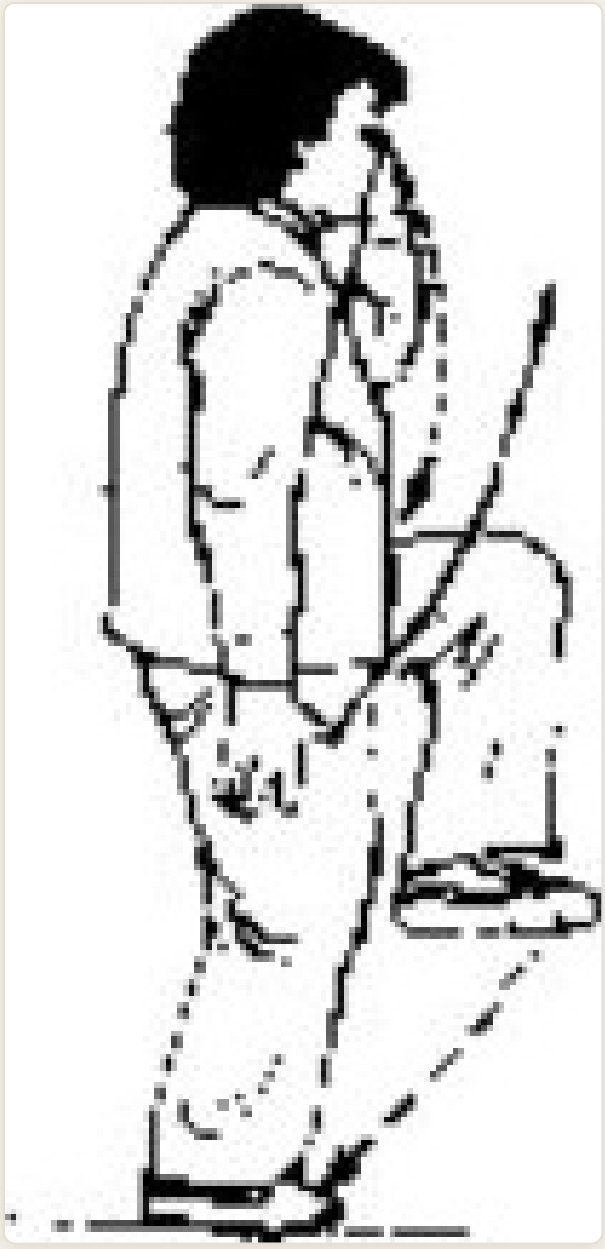
Seventy-First Posture: Hands Play the Pipa, Right Form (手挥琵琶, Shǒu Huī Pí Pá)

The movement is the same as in the Twenty-Fifth Posture, "Hands Play the Pipa" (手挥琵琶). (Fig. 157)

Seventy-Second Posture: White Crane Spreads Its Wings (白鹤亮翅, Bái Hè Liàng Chì)

The movement is the same as in the Seventh Posture, "White Crane Spreads Its Wings" (白鹤亮翅).

图 151



practitioner standing on one leg with the other knee lifted, one hand raised beside the ear and the other hand lowered at the side.

图 152

practitioner standing with one leg lifted, one hand raised beside the head and the other hand lowered, the body upright.

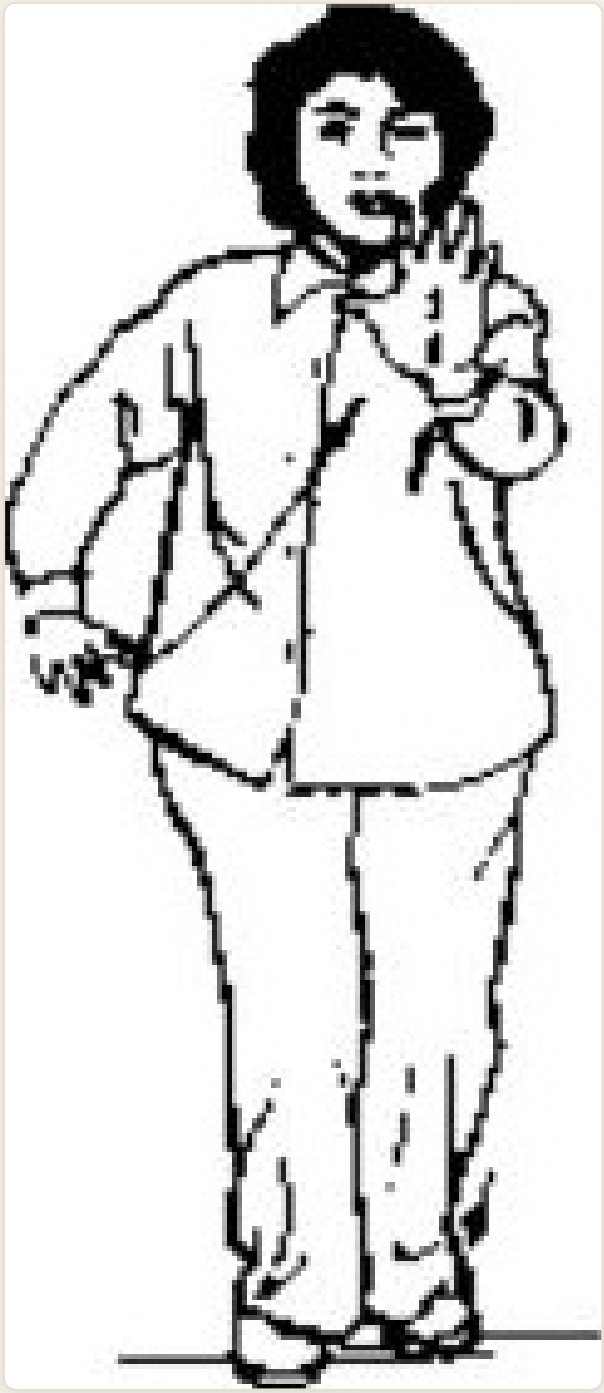
图 155

practitioner in a forward stance, both arms extended forward, the body turned.

图 153

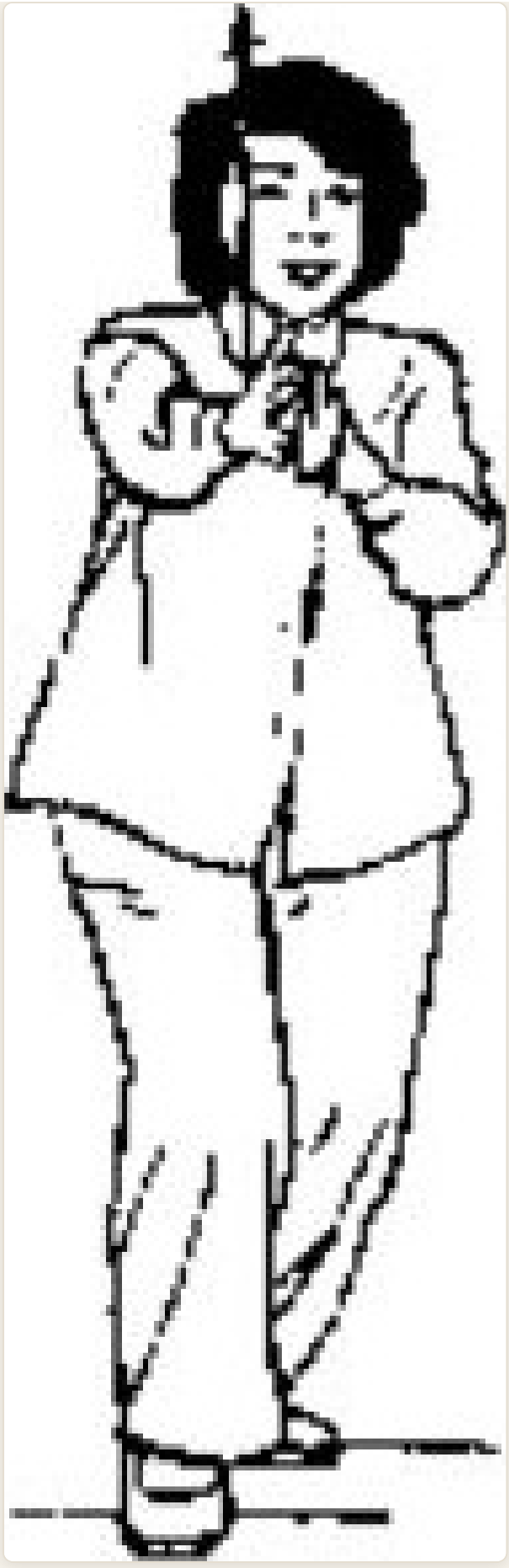
practitioner in a forward stance, both arms extended forward and downward, the body turned.

图 156



practitioner standing upright, both hands held in front of the chest.

图 154



practitioner in a forward stance seen from behind, both arms extended forward and downward.

图 157

practitioner standing upright with the feet close together, both hands held in front of the chest, one hand at the opposite wrist.

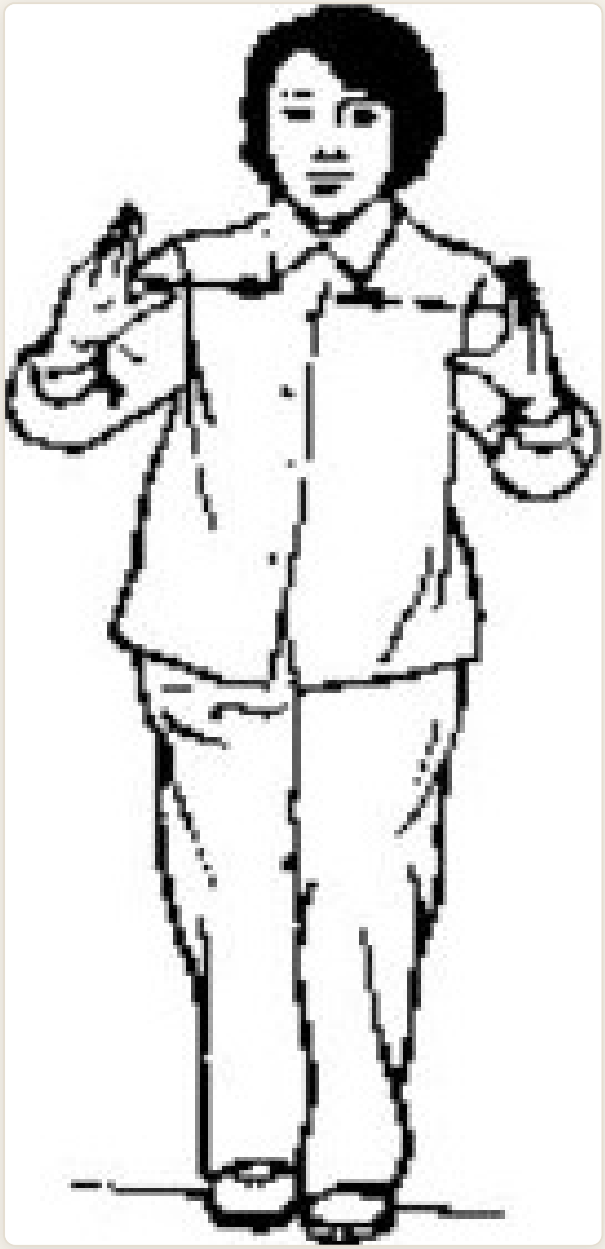
图 158

practitioner standing upright, one hand raised above the head and the other hand lowered in front of the body.

图 161

practitioner standing upright with the feet close together, both hands raised before the chest at shoulder height, the palms facing each other, the elbows held out.

图 159



practitioner standing upright, both hands held in front of the chest.

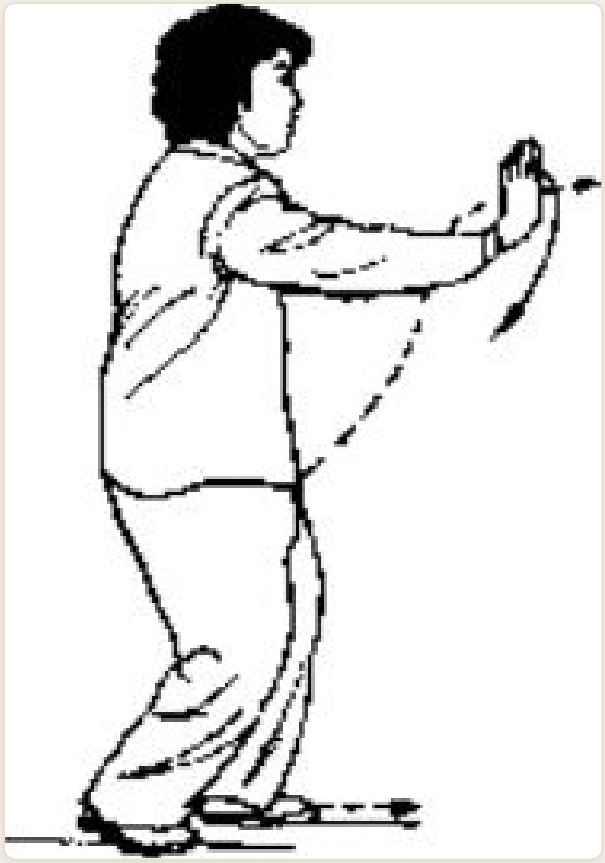
图 162

practitioner standing upright with the feet close together, both forearms crossed before the chest.

图 160

practitioner standing upright, both hands held in front of the chest.

图 163

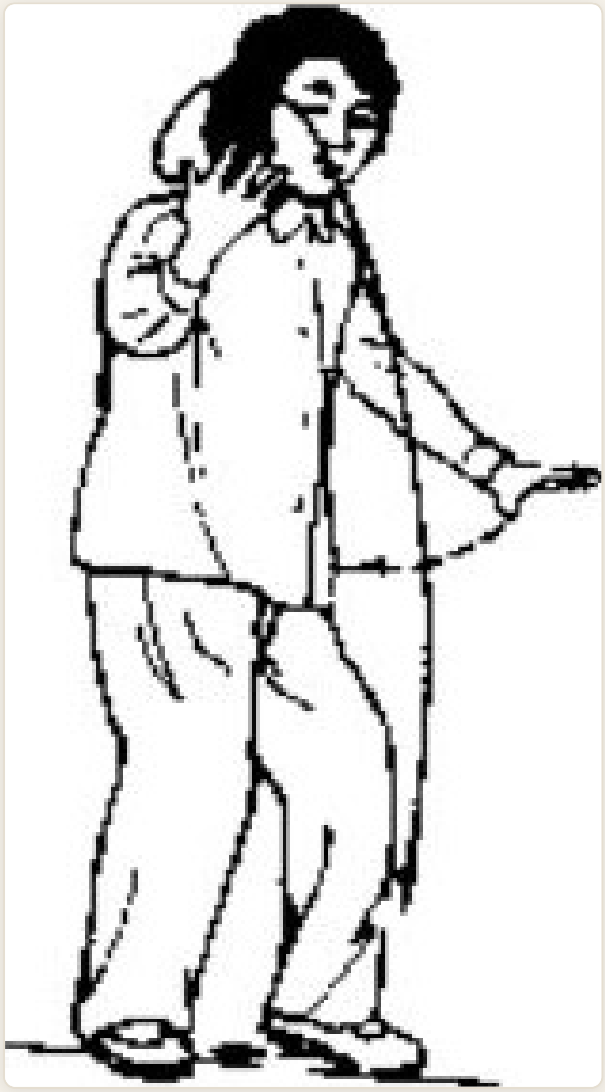


practitioner in a forward stance, one arm extended forward and the other hand lowered in front of the body.

图 164

practitioner standing, both arms extended forward in front of the chest with a curved motion line trailing from the hands, the body turned.

图 167



practitioner bent forward from the waist, the torso lowered, both arms extended downward in front of the body.

图 170

practitioner in a forward stance, both arms extended forward in front of the chest, the body turned.

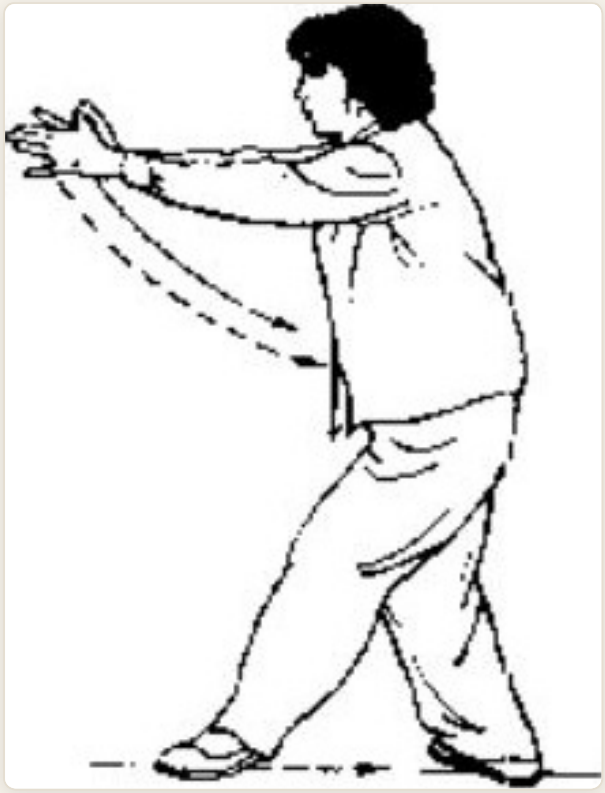
图 165

practitioner in a stance, both arms extended forward in front of the chest with a curved motion line, the hands held close together.

图 168

practitioner in a wide stance, one arm raised above the head and the other arm extended out to the side at shoulder height.

图 171

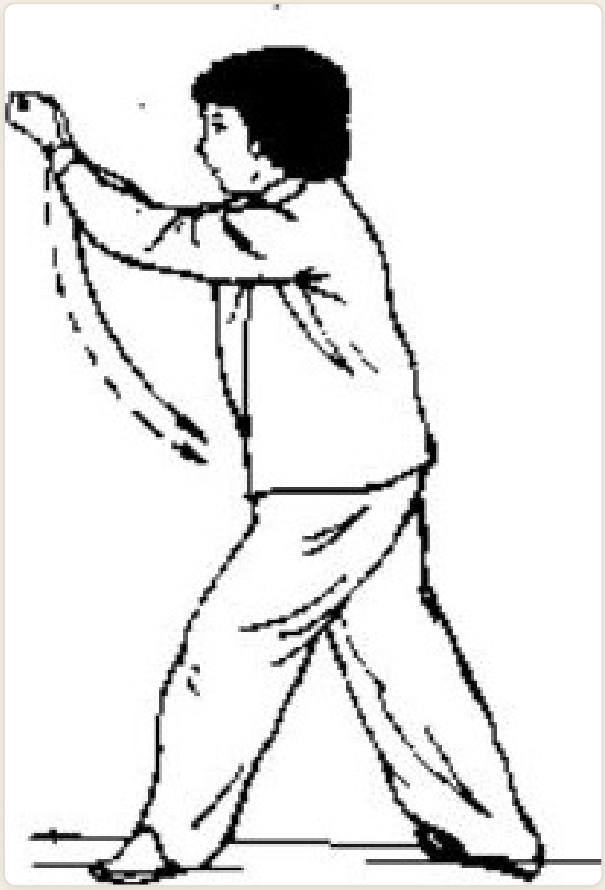


practitioner standing with the feet close together, both hands held in front of the chest with a curved motion line.

图 166

practitioner standing, both hands held in front of the chest with a curved motion line, the body turned.

图 169



practitioner in a forward stance, one arm raised up in front and the other hand held before the chest, the body turned.

图 172

practitioner in a wide stance, both arms extended forward at chest height, the body turned.

图 173

practitioner standing, the body turned to the side, both hands held before the body with a diagonal motion line.

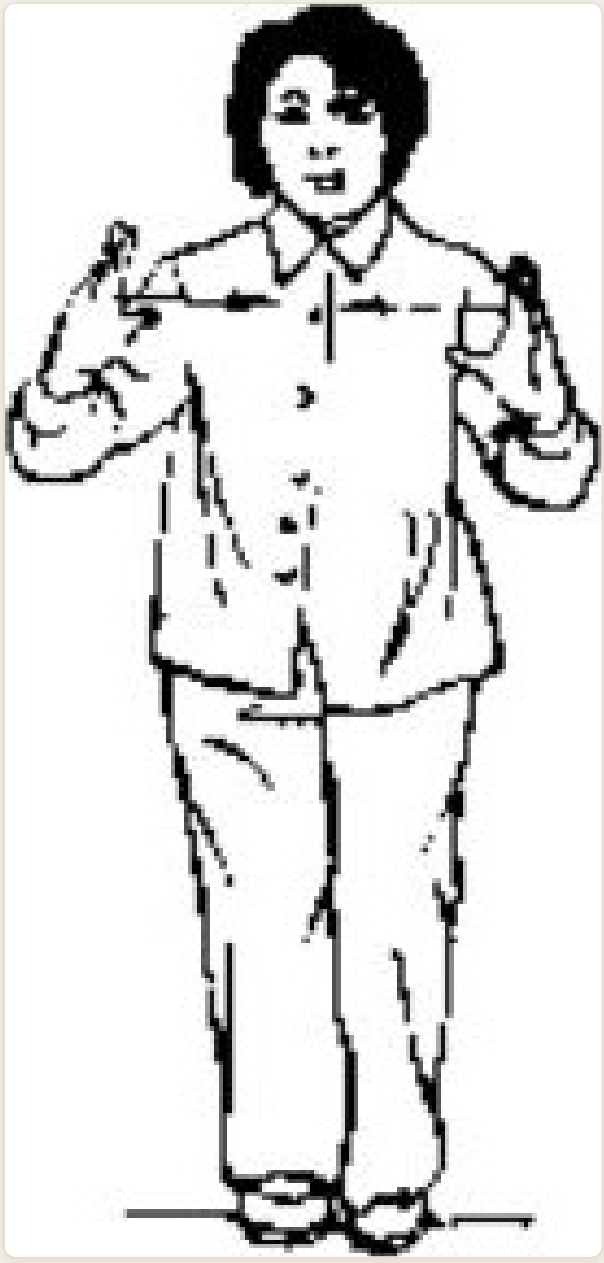
图 176

practitioner standing with the feet close together, both hands raised before the chest at shoulder height, the palms facing each other, the elbows held out.

图 174

practitioner in a stance, both arms extended forward in front of the chest with a curved motion line, the body turned.

图 177



practitioner standing with the feet close together, both hands raised before the chest, the palms facing each other, the elbows held out.

图 175

practitioner in a forward stance, both arms extended forward in front of the chest with a curved motion line, the body turned.

图 178

practitioner standing with the feet close together, both hands held in front of the chest, the elbows held out.

Up to the point where the heel is level with the tip of the left foot; at the same time the left hand rotates outward and inward to the front of the chest with the palm facing up; the right hand rotates inward to the front of the chest with the palm facing down, the two palms facing each other and about 10 cm apart; the eyes look at the right hand. (Fig. 183)

- ② The left foot steps forward, the toe turned inward so as to form a splayed stance (八字步, bā zì bù) with the left foot, and the body turns 90° to the left; the two hands exchange places in front of the chest, the right hand below with the palm facing up and the left hand above with the palm facing down; then the two legs bend slightly and the two hands become upright crossed palms (立掌, lì zhǎng), the right hand outside and the left hand inside, the thumbs lightly against the chest; the eyes look at the two hands. (Fig. 184, 185)
- ③ The right leg lifts at the knee, the knee swinging slightly outward; at the same time the two hands separate to left and right as in the Single Whip posture; the eyes look straight ahead. (Fig. 186)

Eighty-Fifth Posture

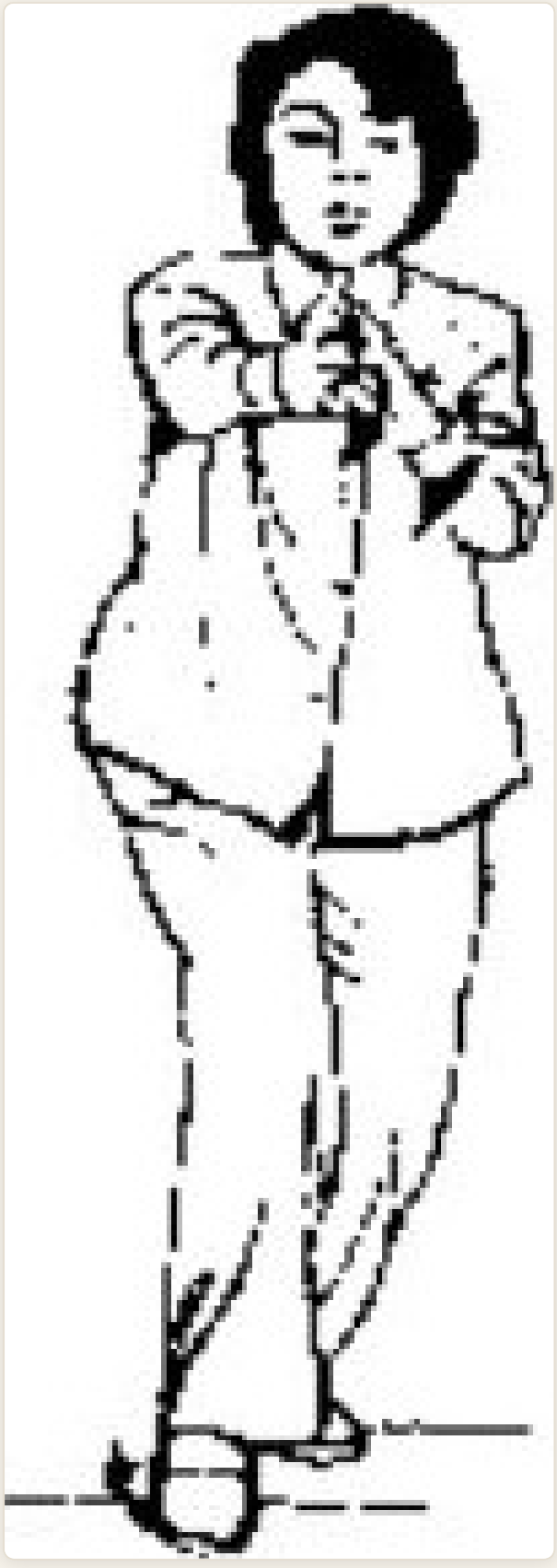
图 179

practitioner in a wide stance, both arms extended out to the sides at shoulder height, the body turned.

图 182

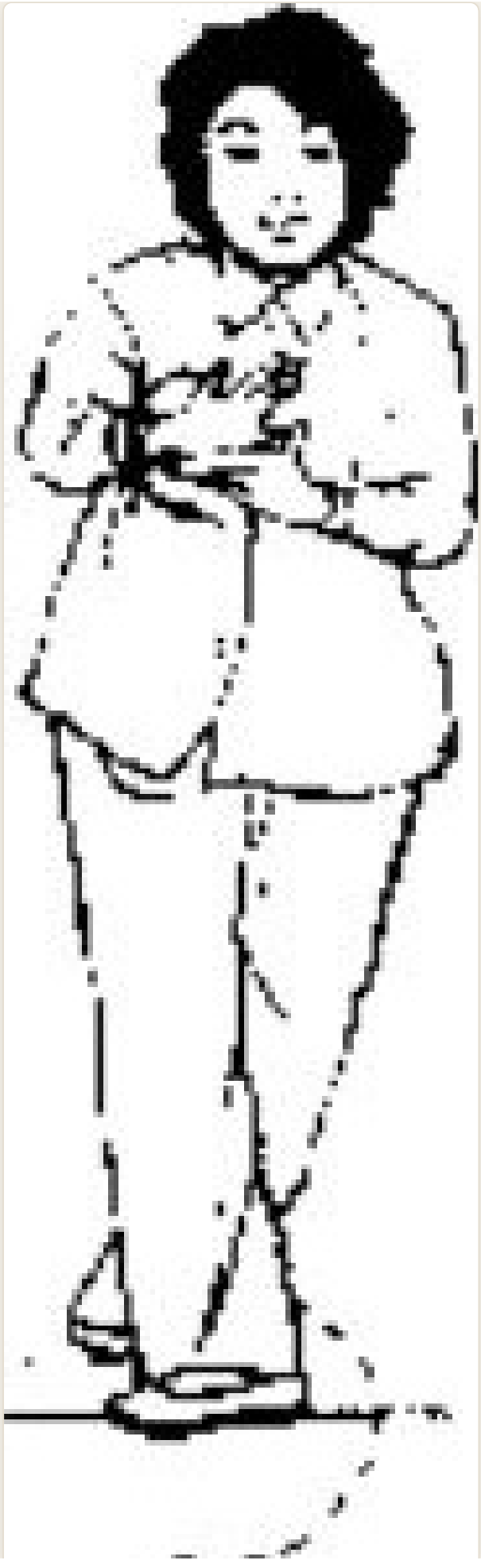
practitioner standing with the feet close together, both hands held together in front of the chest.

图 180



practitioner in a stance, one arm extended forward at shoulder height and the other hand held before the chest, the body turned.

图 183



practitioner standing with the feet close together, both forearms held in front of the chest, the hands close together.

图 181

practitioner in a stance, one arm extended forward at chest height with a curved motion line and the other hand held before the chest.

图 184

practitioner standing with the feet close together, both hands held in front of the chest with a curved motion line.

图 185

practitioner in a low crouched stance with both knees deeply bent, both hands held together in front of the chest.

图 186

practitioner standing on one leg with the other knee lifted, both arms lowered and separated to the sides.

图 187

practitioner in a forward stance, one arm extended forward and downward, the body leaning forward.

图 188

practitioner in a forward stance, both arms extended forward in front of the chest with a curved motion line, the body turned.

图 189

practitioner in a stance, both arms extended forward in front of the chest with a curved motion line, the body turned.

图 192

practitioner standing with the feet close together, both hands raised before the chest at shoulder height, the palms facing each other, the elbows held out.

图 190

practitioner in a stance, both arms extended forward in front of the chest with a curved motion line.

图 193

practitioner in a wide stance, both arms extended out to the sides at shoulder height.

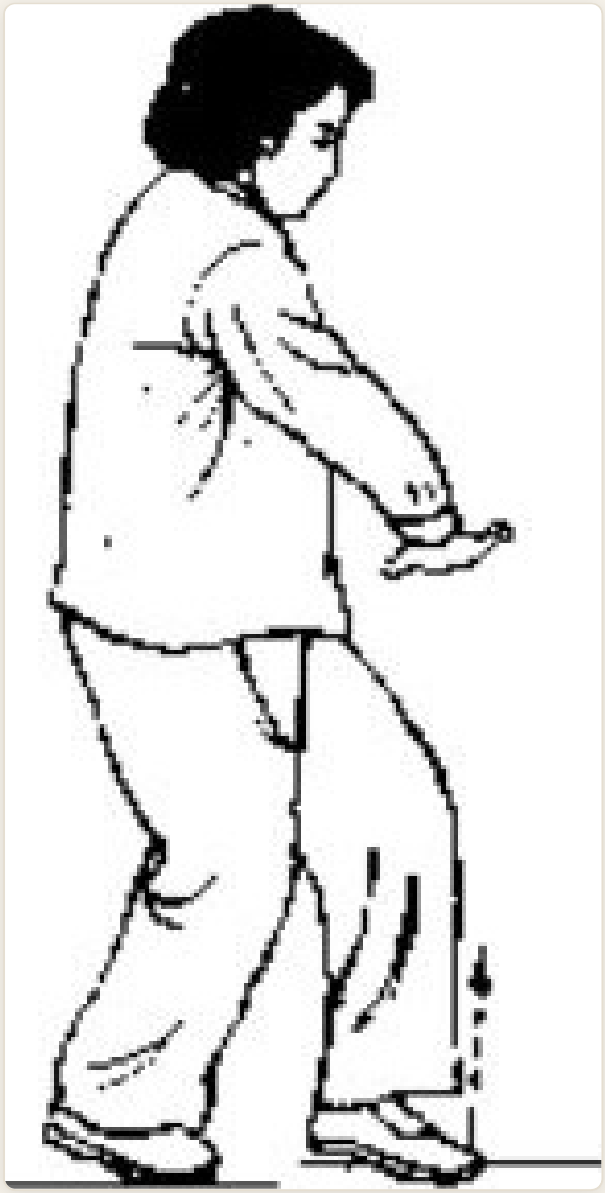
图 191

practitioner standing with the feet close together, both hands held in front of the chest.

图 194

practitioner in a low, wide stance, one arm extended forward and downward with a curved motion line and the other hand lowered at the hip, the body turned.

图 195



practitioner standing upright, the right hand raised above the head, the left hand lowered to the side of the left hip, the left knee lifted with the toe turned up.

图 196

practitioner with the right knee bent in a crouch, the left knee lifted, the two hands one above the other in front of the body with a curved motion line.

图 197

practitioner with the right knee bent in a crouch, the left knee lifted, the right hand raised in front of the forehead, the left hand lowered to the side of the left hip.

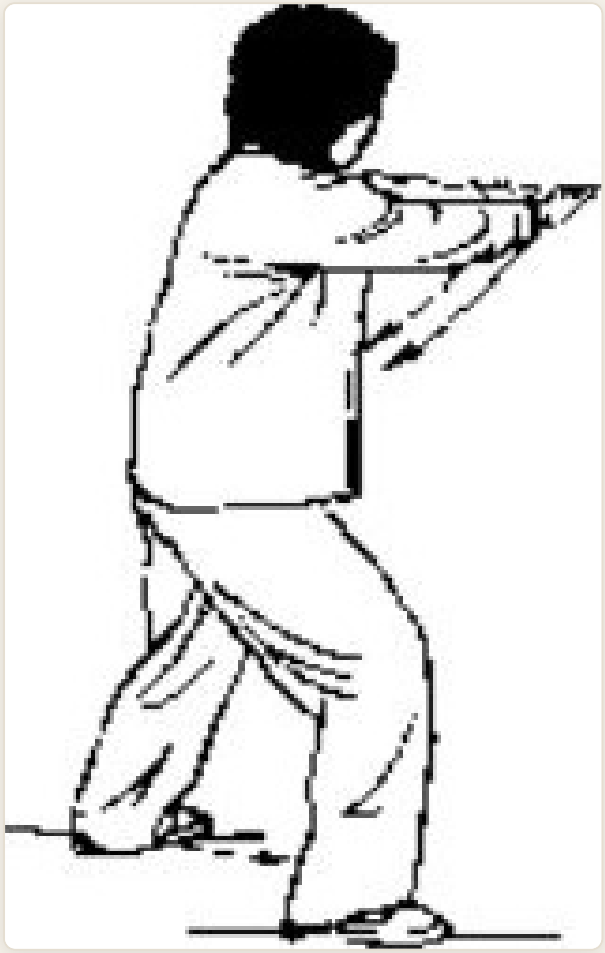
图 198

both arms extended forward and held in front of the chest with a curved motion line, the body leaning forward.

图 199

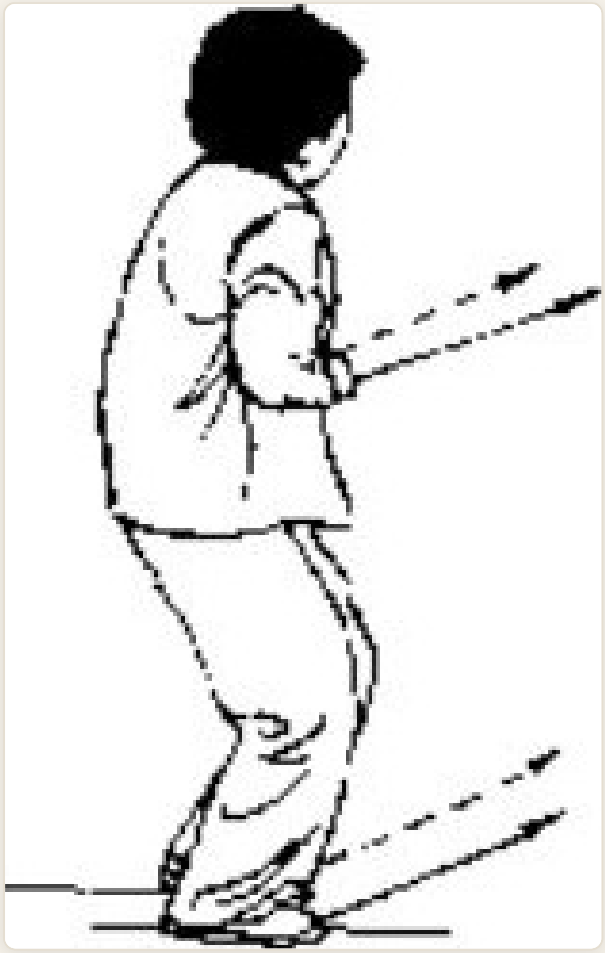
the practitioner supported on one standing leg while the other knee is lifted and swung out, with a curved motion line before the body.

图 200



both arms extended forward level with the shoulders, both hands rotated inward, the body leaning forward.

图 201



both arms extended forward and held in front of the chest level with the shoulders, with a curved motion line, in a forward stance.

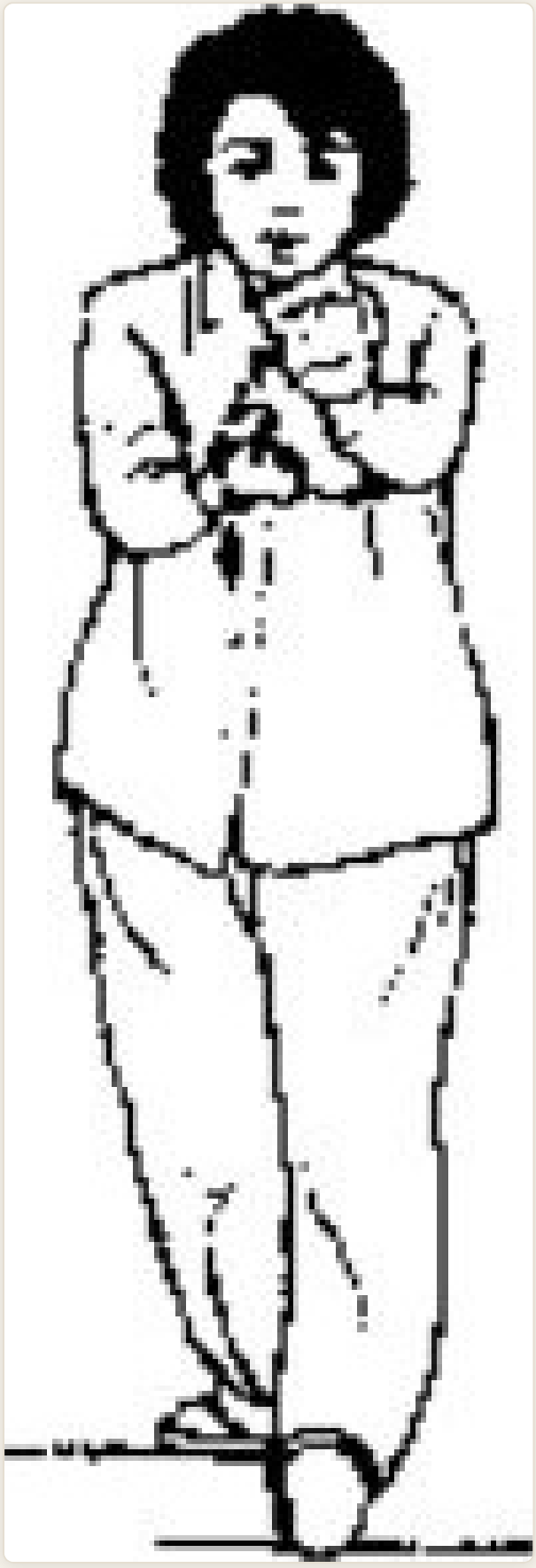
图 204

both hands held as fists in front of the chest with the elbows close to the ribs, the body turning.

图 207

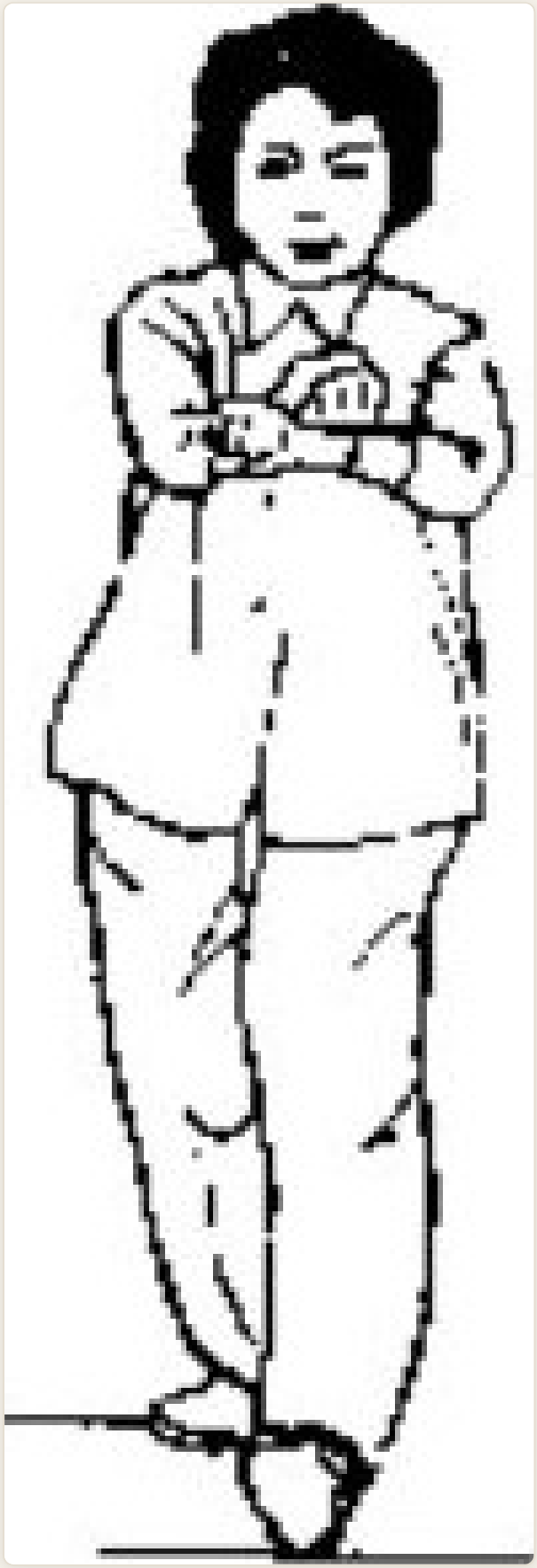
the two fists crossed in front of the chest, the two elbows hanging down, the body upright.

图 202



the two fists thrusting forward, the two arms slightly bent, the body leaning forward.

图 205

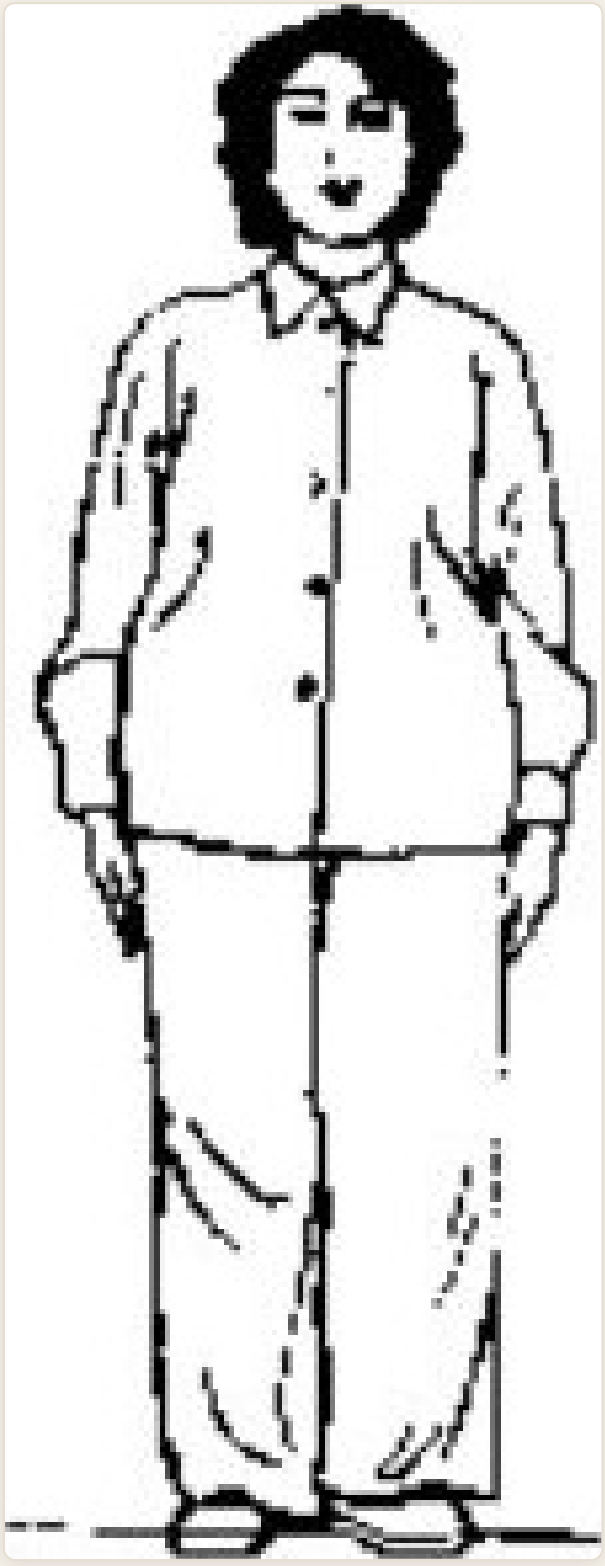


the two fists facing each other in front of the chest, the body turning, the two legs bent.

图 208

practitioner standing upright with the two feet together, the two hands separated and hanging at the sides of the hips, the gaze level.

图 203

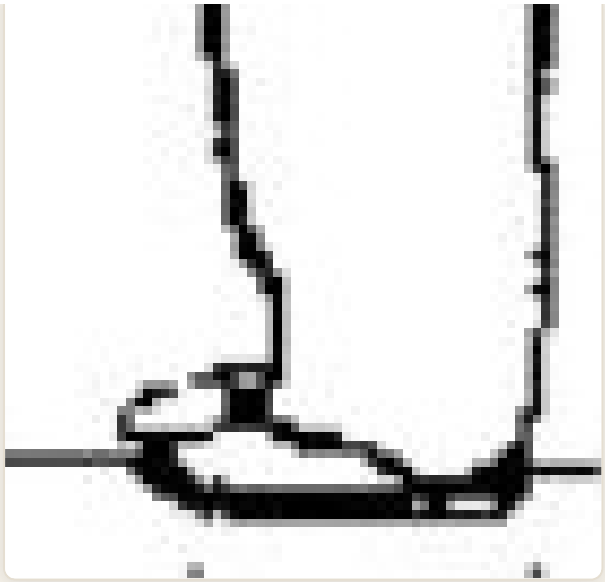


the two fists thrusting forward, the left leg in front in a forward stance, the body leaning forward.

图 206

the two fists crossed in front of the chest, the body upright, the tip of the left foot turned up.

图 209



A and B stand facing each other, about two paces apart. (The book prints this as "Fig. 一".)

图 210

A and B each advance the left foot, left hand in front, the right hand resting on the left forearm. (The book prints this as "Fig. 二".)

图 211

A presses his right hand toward B's face; B's two hands catch A's right wrist and right elbow and thrust diagonally. (The book prints this as "Fig. 三".)

图 212

A and B each advance the left foot, the right hand resting on the left forearm, while B's two hands catch A's right arm. (The book prints this as "Fig. 四".)

图 213

A and B with the right foot in front, joining right hands, the left hand resting on the right forearm. (The book prints this as "Fig. 五".)

图 214

A and B with the right foot in front, the hands crossed, A pressing toward B with the right arm. (The book prints this as "Fig. 六".)

Elbowing (肘, zhǒu) means to drive the elbow against the opponent.

Leaning (靠, kào) means to press and lean against the opponent with the shoulder.

The footwork of the great roll-back is a wide and swift stride; only when the two legs have skill can one be nimble and changeable.

4. The Use of Force and the Listening to Force in Push-Hands (推手的用劲和听劲, Tuī Shǒu de Yòng Jìn hé Tīng Jìn)

In beginning push-hands one must not use clumsy strength, but must seek out the secret within the four words warding-off, rolling-back, pressing and pushing; these four words contain infinite transformations, and the student must experience them deeply.

For example: warding-off has the distinctions of straight warding-off and lateral warding-off, above and below. In rolling back one must stick to the opponent's hand, then immediately change direction and trace a circle, so that the opponent's force cannot issue forth, or if it issues forth is at once dissolved.

Warding-off is divided into upward, downward and level warding-off. In thrusting, one hand must press and hold the opponent's wrist and the other hand press the opponent's elbow, so that the opponent has no room to move and is thrust out along the line of his own force. Again, within the thrust there is also a warding-off force, which should not be used lightly.

Pressing has various methods: straight pressing, slanting pressing, and pressing with the addition of the elbow. If one presses with the arm along a curve, one can change the point of force at any moment and with any configuration, and force may be issued from any place.

Pushing includes lightness and nimbleness or heaviness and solidity, left solid and right empty or right solid and left empty, the two hands opening or closing; in sum, one must change according to the configuration.

When two people drill push-hands together, besides attending to experiencing the methods of using force, one must accomplish bending and extending in accord with the other, neither losing contact nor resisting, not using clumsy strength, calming the mind and listening to force. In time, one can lead the opponent in to fall into emptiness and move a thousand catties with a pull of four ounces.

As for "listening to force" (听劲, tīng jìn), one must on no account mistake it for two parties opposing each other with strength. One commonly sees, in push-hands, two people locking strength against each other, one asking whether the other has force yet, the other answering that he has or has not — this is a great error. "Listening to force" is to sense the magnitude and direction of the opponent's applied force and so change at once; one must on no account lock against it. In beginning practice, train the two arms first; with long practice the whole body can sense it. If one can listen to force, then when the opponent issues force one can dissolve it and

make him fall into emptiness. If one cannot listen to force, one need not measure oneself against others; the student must certainly attend to this.

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2. The Martial Application of Taijiquan (太极拳技击, Tàijíquán Jì Jī)

2. The Martial Application of Taijiquan (太极拳技击, Tàijíquán Jì Jī)

The martial application of Taijiquan is nothing other than the eight methods: warding-off, rolling-back, pressing, pushing, plucking, rending, elbowing and leaning. These eight methods are all contained within the Taijiquan form; push-hands is the practising of these eight methods for use. At present, whether one practises the form or practises push-hands, both are the familiarising of these eight methods, and so it is said that the eight methods are the application of Taijiquan. But to practise the form alone is to have substance without application, and its defect lies in having no change. To practise push-hands alone is to have application without substance, and its defect lies in having no root. If one practises only for the cultivation of body and mind, then practising the form is already sufficient; but if one wishes to obtain its application, one must practise both.

In terms of practising substance, Taijiquan is the art of knowing oneself (知己功夫, zhī jǐ gōng fu); only after long and thoroughly proficient practice can one make the whole body insubstantial and numinous, round and lively without obstruction, heavy and still as Mount Tai, light and nimble as a feather, with spirit (神, shén) and vital energy (气, qì) blended and fused, whereby one may of oneself dispel illness and prolong life. In terms of practising application, it is the art of knowing others (知人功夫, zhī rén gōng fu); only after long practice with pure skill can the hands and feet be nimble and alive, leading the opponent in to fall into emptiness and moving a thousand catties with a pull of four ounces. Hence only by practising both substance and application does one come to know oneself and know others; if one cannot know oneself and know others, one cannot measure oneself against others. One commonly sees those who claim to study only "martial application": using force for the sake of using force, they must apply clumsy strength, and so enter a wrong road. The student is asked to guard against this.

To become proficient in the martial application of Taijiquan, one should take the practice of the form as the main thing and seek skill from the waist and legs. For martial application first demands quick reaction; to react quickly one must have each single hand and each single posture thoroughly proficient, with waist and legs nimble and strong, before one can respond to the opponent with lightness, nimbleness, roundness and liveliness. Further, one must be able to "listen to force", for only thus can one stick to the opponent, respond to the moment and adapt, hear one and know a hundred, and change without limit.

In Part One the methods of use of some of the postures have been outlined, but the student must not memorise them by rote and rigidly. One should make the form proficient and practise push-hands diligently. In beginning the static-step push-hands, the work lies mainly in the waist; when the waist is extremely nimble, one has more than enough for dissolving the opponent's force. Once proficient, one practises the moving-step push-hands, where the work lies mainly in the legs; when the skill is pure, one advances, retreats and changes direction swiftly. Thereafter one goes through the four corners, and after that the free hand (散手, sàn shǒu). The two parties may then disregard the rules and attack and dissolve at will, each against the other.

In sum, the martial application of Taijiquan — that is, free hand — has no fixed rule or method, but changes at any time and in any configuration as the opportunity arises; this is the meaning of the saying that free hand has no fixed forms. A single posture in the art may be used in several ways, and several postures may be used as one, but one must always weigh the time and gauge the configuration before acting. Exactly as the classic says, "When the other does not move, "I do not move; if the opponent moves, I move first." This is what is meant by "the intent (意, yì) precedes the enemy." That is to say: however fierce and swift the opponent's action, one can dissolve it and turn it to one's own use. One must not wait for the opponent's technique to land upon one's own body; nor may one always use a single technique, for without change one is controlled by others. It is hoped that the student will draw inferences from one instance to three, know the applications without being bound by the applications, and diligently practise push-hands; then one may attain the mystery of Taijiquan as a fighting art.

Appendix: Reference Materials

I. Wang Zongyue: A Treatise on Taijiquan

Taiji (太极, Tàijí) is born of Wuji (无极, Wújí); it is the mechanism of movement and stillness, the mother of yin and yang (阴阳, yīn yáng). When moved, they separate; when still, they unite. Neither excess nor deficiency — follow the bend and yield the extension. When the opponent is hard and I am soft, this is called "yielding" (走); when I am favourable and the opponent adverse, this is called "sticking" (黏). If he moves quickly, respond quickly; if he moves slowly, follow slowly. Though the transformations are countless, the principle is one throughout. From familiarity with the techniques one gradually awakens to "understanding energy" (懂劲, dǒng jìn); from understanding energy one ascends step by step to spiritual clarity (神明, shén míng). Yet without long effort one cannot suddenly penetrate it. With an insubstantial and numinous uplifting of the crown (虚灵顶劲, xū líng dǐng jìn), the qi (气) sinks to the elixir field (丹田, dāntián). Neither leaning nor inclining, now hidden, now appearing. Where the left is heavy, the left is made empty; where the right is heavy, the right is made obscure. Raise it and it becomes higher still; lower it and it becomes deeper still. Advance upon it and it grows longer; retreat from it and it grows more urgent. Not a feather may be added, not a fly may alight. Others do not know me; I alone know others. The hero who meets no match wherever he turns attains this through nothing else. There are many side doors to this art; though the postures differ, they come to no more than the strong bullying the weak and the slow yielding to the fast. Strength beating weakness, a slow hand yielding to a fast hand — all of these are inborn natural abilities, and have nothing to

do with what is achieved by study. Consider the saying "four ounces deflect a thousand catties": it is plain that this is not a victory of force. Observe the form whereby the aged can hold off a crowd: what can speed do there? Stand like a balance, move like a wheel. Lean to one side and you follow; double-weight (双重, shuāng zhòng) and you stagnate. One often sees those whose pure effort of many years cannot transform — all are controlled by others and in the end cannot control others; this is simply that the fault of double-weighting has not been understood. To avoid this fault one must know yin and yang. Sticking is yielding, and yielding is sticking. Yin does not depart from yang, yang does not depart from yin; only when yin and yang aid each other is there understanding of energy. After understanding energy, the more one practises the finer one becomes; silently recognizing and pondering, one gradually arrives at "doing as the heart desires." The root is to "give up oneself and follow others" (舍己从人, shě jǐ cóng rén); most mistake it by giving up the near to seek the far. As it is said, "a hairsbreadth's difference, and the error is a thousand li" — the student must not fail to examine this with care.

Long Boxing (长拳, cháng quán) is like the great Yangtze and Yellow Rivers, flowing on without cease. The Thirteen Postures (十三势, shísān shì) are: warding-off (掤, bēng), roll-back (捋, lǚ), press (挤, jǐ), push (按, àn), pluck (采, cǎi), rend (挒, liè), elbow (肘, zhǒu), lean (靠, kào) — these are the eight trigrams; and advancing step, retreating step, leftward looking, rightward glancing and central equilibrium — these are the five phases. Taken together they make the Thirteen Postures. Warding-off, roll-back, press and push correspond to Kan, Li, Zhen and Dui — the four cardinal directions; pluck, rend, elbow and lean correspond to Qian, Gen, Xun and Kun — the four diagonal corners; advance, retreat, look, glance and settle correspond to metal, wood, water, fire and earth.

II. Wu Yuxiang: A Treatise on Taijiquan

Before heaven and earth existed, within the infinite void, there was one undifferentiated qi — this is Wuji, and Wuji gives rise to Taiji. Taiji is the root of heaven and earth, the origin of all things. In Taijiquan, as soon as there is the slightest movement, the whole body must be light and nimble, and above all threaded through. The qi should be stirred and agitated; the spirit (神, shén) should be gathered inward. Let there be no place of defect, no place of bulge or hollow, no place of break or interruption. The root is in the feet, issued through the legs, commanded by the waist (腰, yāo), and expressed in the fingers. From foot to leg to waist, there must always be one complete qi. Only then, advancing and retreating, can one seize the moment and the configuration. If there is any place where one fails to seize the moment and configuration, the body becomes scattered. The fault for this must be sought in the waist and legs. This holds above and below, before and behind, left and right. All of this lies in the intent (意), not outside but within. Where there is above there is below; where there is front there is back; where there is left there is right — if the intent is to rise, then a downward intent is lodged within it. It is like lifting up an object while adding to it the intent of filing it down. Then its root is severed of itself, and one may push it and hasten it without obstruction. Empty and full (虚实, xū shí) must be clearly distinguished. Each place has its own empty and full; every place is altogether this one empty and full. The whole body is threaded joint by joint, with not the slightest hair's-breadth of

interruption permitted. (Original note: these were the bequeathed teachings of the venerated Master Zhang Sanfeng of Wudang Mountain, wishing that heroes under heaven might prolong their years and increase their longevity, and not merely make of it the least of the martial arts.)

III. An Explanation of the Heart of Practice in the Thirteen Postures Use the heart to move the qi (以心行气, yǐ xīn xíng qì); one must make it sink and settle, for only then can it be gathered and drawn into the bones. Use the qi to move the body; one must make it smooth and compliant, for only then can it be convenient and follow the heart. If the spirit of vitality can be raised, there is no fear of sluggishness and heaviness — this is what is called the suspended crown (顶头悬, dǐng tóu xuán). The intent and the qi must be changed with nimbleness, for only then is there the delight of roundness and liveliness — this is what is called the transformation of empty and full. In issuing energy (发劲, fā jìn) one must sink and settle, be relaxed and still, and concentrate upon one direction. In standing the body one must be centred, upright, at ease and comfortable, supporting the eight directions; in moving the qi, be like a pearl of nine turnings, with no minute place unreached; in moving, be like steel a hundred times refined, with no hardness it cannot break. In form, like a falcon striking a rabbit; in spirit, like a cat catching a mouse. Still, like a mountain; moving, like a river. Storing energy (蓄劲, is like drawing a bow; issuing energy is like loosing an arrow. Seek the straight within the curved; store and then issue. Force issues from the spine (脊, jǐ); the step changes with the body. Gathering is issuing, and issuing is gathering; broken and then reconnected, going and returning must have folding, advancing and retreating must have conversion. Utterly soft, and thereafter utterly hard; able to breathe, and thereafter able to be nimble. The qi is nourished by straightness and so does no harm; energy is stored by curving and so has surplus. The heart is the command, the qi the banner, the waist the great standard. First seek expansion, then seek compactness, and only then does one arrive at fine closeness.

It is also said: first in the heart, afterward in the body; the belly is relaxed and clean, the qi is gathered into the marrow of the bones. The spirit at ease, the body still — this must be in the heart at every moment. Remember firmly: when one thing moves, there is nothing that does not move; when one thing is still, there is nothing that is not still. In pulling and moving to and fro, the qi clings to the back and is gathered into the spinal bones. Inwardly consolidate the spirit; outwardly show ease and rest. Step like a cat walking; move energy like drawing silk. In the whole body the intent lies in the spirit, not in the qi; to be in the qi is to stagnate. Where there is qi it drags force along; where there is no qi it is purely hard — qi is like the wheel, the waist is like the axle.

IV. Verse of the Thirteen Postures

Do not lightly regard the thirteen general postures; The source of life and intent lies in the hollow of the waist. In changing and turning empty and full, take care; Let the qi pervade the body without the least stagnation. In stillness, touched, one moves, yet moving is still as before; Changing according to the opponent, one shows the marvellous. In every posture keep the heart, weigh and use intent; What is attained is won without noticing the effort spent. At every moment

keep the heart upon the waist; Within the belly, relaxed and clean, the qi rises up. With the tailbone centred, the spirit runs through the crown; The whole body light and nimble, the crown suspended. Attend with care and seek it out in push-hands; Bending and extending, opening and closing, follow what is natural. To enter the gate and find the road, an oral transmission is needed; The exercise never ceases, and the method is self-cultivated. If you ask what standard governs substance and function: Intent and qi are the ruler, bone and flesh the minister. Consider what the use of intent finally comes to — Prolonging life and lengthening years, a spring that does not age. Sing it, sing it — a hundred and forty words; Every word is true and exact, the meaning leaves nothing out. If you do not seek it out in this direction, Your effort is wasted, and you will be left lamenting.

V. Verse of Push-Hands

Warding-off, roll-back, press and push must be taken in earnest; Above and below following one another, the opponent finds it hard to enter.

Let him come at me with giant force; A pull of four ounces deflects a thousand catties. Draw him in to fall into emptiness, and issue as he closes; Stick, connect, continue, follow — neither losing contact nor butting.

VI. Li Yiyu: The Five-Word Formula

Stillness of Heart

If the heart is not still, it is not single-minded: as soon as one raises a hand, front and back, left and right, there is no fixed direction at all — hence the need for stillness of heart. At first one's movements cannot be governed by oneself; one must calm the heart and experience it in the body, moving as the other moves, following the bend and yielding the extension, neither losing contact nor butting, and not shortening or lengthening of oneself. If he has force, I also have force, and my force is first; if he has no force, I also have force, and my intent is still first. One must keep watch at every moment: wherever contact is made, the heart must be applied there, and one must seek the news within "neither losing contact nor butting." Working on from this, with days and months accumulated, one can then apply it in the body; this is entirely the use of intent, not the use of strength, and in time others are controlled by me, and I am not controlled by others.

Nimbleness of Body

If the body is sluggish, one cannot advance and retreat freely — hence the need for nimbleness of body. In raising a hand there must be no appearance of dullness; no sooner does his force begin to intrude upon my skin than my intent has already entered into his bones. The two hands prop each other up, one qi threaded through. When the left is heavy, the left is made empty, and the right has already gone; when the right is heavy, the right is made empty, and the left has already gone. The qi is like a wheel, and the whole body must follow along with it. Where there is any place that does not follow, the body becomes scattered and loses its power; the fault is to be sought in the waist and legs. First use the heart to command the body, following others and not

oneself; afterward bring the body to follow the heart, so that although from oneself it still follows others. From oneself, one stagnates; following others, one lives. If one can follow others, the hands have measure. Measure the size of his energy, and not a fraction is mistaken; weigh the length of his coming, and not a hair's-breadth is off. Advancing and retreating, every place fits exactly. The longer the practice, the finer the skill. Gathering of Qi If the qi's force is scattered and diffuse, there is no containment; the body is easily disordered — one must make the qi gather into the spinal bones. Breathing becomes penetrating and numinous, with no gap anywhere in the body. The in-breath is closing (合, hé) and storing (蓄, xù); the out-breath is opening (开, kāi) and issuing (发, fā). For the in-breath can naturally lift up, and can also lift a person up; the out-breath can naturally sink down, and can also send a person out. This is to move the qi by intent, not to move the qi by strength.

Whole Energy

The energy of the whole body is trained into a single family. Distinguish clearly between empty and full, and the issuing of energy must have a root. Energy rises from the heels, is governed at the waist, takes form in the fingers, and issues from the spine. Further, one must raise up the whole of one's spirit: at the moment when his energy is about to come out but has not yet issued, my energy has already joined his energy, exactly neither after nor before — like skin catching fire, like a spring gushing forth. Advancing and retreating, there is not the slightest scattering or disorder. Seek the straight within the curved; store and then issue — only thus does it take effect as the hand moves. This is called borrowing force to strike the man, four ounces deflecting a thousand catties.

Gathering of Spirit

When the preceding four are all complete, they return altogether to the gathering of spirit (神聚, shén jù). When the spirit is gathered, then the one qi is forged and smelted. Train the qi to return to the spirit, and the momentum of the qi shifts and manoeuvres. The spirit is poured in continuously; opening and closing have their proper order, and empty and full are clear. When the left is empty, the right is full; when the right is empty, the left is full. Empty is not being wholly without force — the momentum of the qi must be able to shift and manoeuvre. Full is not occupying everything to the death — the spirit must value continuous pouring in. The essential point lies entirely in the chest and the waist; the application is not on the outside. Force is borrowed from the other; qi issues from the spine. How can qi issue from the spine? The qi sinks downward, and from the two shoulders is gathered into the spinal bones and poured into the waist — this is the qi going from above to below, and is called closing (合, hé). From the waist it takes form in the spinal bones, spreads to the two arms, and is applied at the fingers — this is the qi going from below to above, and is called opening (开, kāi). Closing is gathering; opening is issuing. If one can understand opening and closing, one knows yin and yang. On reaching this stage, one day of practice brings one day of refinement in skill, until gradually one follows the heart's desire and nothing fails to accord with one's intent.

VII. Secret Formula of Release and Discharge

The Four Words: Lifting, Drawing, Loosening, Releasing

Lifting opens his energy and borrows his force — within it is the word *ling* (灵, numinous). Drawing him to the front of the body, his energy then begins to store — within it is the word *lian* (敛, gathering). Loosening my own energy, do not let it bend — within it is the word *jing* (静, stillness). At the release, the waist and feet must recognize the target — within it is the word *zheng* (整, wholeness).

VIII. Essential Words on Practising the Form and Practising the Hands The men of old said: if one can draw the other in to fall into emptiness, one can then four ounces deflect a thousand catties; if one cannot draw the other in to fall into emptiness, one cannot four ounces deflect a thousand catties. The saying is very summary; the beginner has no way to grasp it. I add several phrases to explain it, so that those who have the will for this art may have a point of entry, and so advance a little each day in achievement. If one wishes to draw [the other] in to fall into emptiness and four ounces deflect a thousand catties, one must first know oneself and know the other. If one wishes to know oneself and know the other, one must first give up oneself and follow the other. If one wishes to give up oneself and follow the other, one must first gain the opportunity and gain the position. If one wishes to gain the opportunity and gain the position, one must first make the whole body one family. If one wishes to make the whole body one family, one must first have no flaw anywhere in the whole body. If one wishes to have no flaw anywhere in the whole body, one must first have spirit and qi drumming and surging. If one wishes to have spirit and qi drumming and surging, one must first raise up the spirit. If one wishes to raise up the spirit, one must first keep the spirit from scattering outward. If one wishes to keep the spirit from scattering outward, one must first gather spirit and qi into the bones. If one wishes to gather spirit and qi into the bones, one must first have strength in the front section of the two legs. The two shoulders loosen and open, the qi sinks downward, energy rises from the heels, exchanges in the legs, is contained in the chest, moves in the two shoulders, and is governed in the waist; above it connects with the two arms, below it follows the two legs, and energy changes from within. Gathering is closing; issuing is opening. When still, all is still; stillness is closing, and within closing is lodged opening. When moving, all moves; movement is opening, and within opening is lodged closing. Touch it, and it revolves freely, with nothing that does not gain force — only then can one draw the other in to fall into emptiness and four ounces deflect a thousand catties. Practice of the form on ordinary days is the work of knowing oneself. At each movement one must first ask oneself whether the whole body accords with these several items. If it accords only slightly not, change it at once. This is why in practising the form one wants slowness, not speed. Push-hands is the work of knowing others; stillness and movement are indeed knowing others, yet it is still a question of asking oneself. If one has arranged oneself well, then when the other touches me, I do not move him the least bit, but enter along his tendency, join and fix his energy, and he falls out of himself. If one has a place where one does not gain force, that is double-weighting not yet transformed, and it must be sought in the opening and closing of yin and yang. This is what is called knowing oneself and knowing the other, and in a hundred battles a hundred victories.

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